

Custom Islands: the guide

A picture-by-picture guide to **Custom Islands** (DynamicIslands), a [Raft](#) mod for the [Raft Mod Loader](#). It is for players who want new islands in their worlds, and for builders who want to make islands and whole adventures of their own. You don't need to know anything about modding: everything is done with buttons in the game. The [README](#) has the full reference (every setting, file and command); this guide shows you around.

The guide follows the heart of the mod first: **meeting custom islands** while you sail (sections 2-3), **building your own** in the editor (4-5), giving them **stories** - quests, doors and keys, story items, islands in Raft's story (6) - and **world plans** that decide which islands a world gets, when and where (7). Section 8 is about playing together. The **optional systems** that change a whole world - world rules, the world randomizer, the extra options, the island list and the level up system - are gathered in section 9, followed by the files, the console commands, help, and how to report a problem (section 15). **Before playing a shared world over several days, or building an adventure, read chapter 12:** the known issues of this alpha and how to avoid them (chapter 13 lists what can't be changed).



A custom island met while sailing: made by the mod's island generator, with Raft's own palms, rocks and reef.

Quick start

Pick what you want to do; each line leads to the part of the guide you need.

I want to...	Do this	Read
Just play with new islands	Install the mod, click NEW WORLD , leave everything as it is, Create , and sail	1 , 2 , 3
Play an adventure someone made	ISLAND LIBRARY in the main menu → World plans → Download ; then NEW WORLD → choose it as the Custom Islands plan	4.7 , 7.6
Build my own island	EDITOR → Generate an island → shape it, add objects → Save	4.8
Give my island a quest or a secret	Island tab → Edit quest... ; an object → Behaviour + events...	5 , 6
Make my own adventure across several islands	EDITOR → WORLD PLANS → New... → one rule per island → Save ; choose it in NEW WORLD	7.2
Play with friends	Everyone installs the mod; the host creates the world; friends join through Steam	8 , 12.1
Change how a world plays (tougher monsters, levels, a randomized world)	NEW WORLD → WORLD SETTINGS...	9
Report a bug or ask a question	Main menu alpha box → Report a problem (or Discord)	15

Words used in this guide

Word	Meaning
Custom island	An island of this mod, as opposed to Raft's own islands. You meet them while sailing, like Raft's
Island file	A saved island, <code><name>.island</code> in <code>Mods\DynamicIslands\</code> . Made in the editor, downloaded, or sent by a host
Map type	A kind of island the mod makes new for each world: a camp, a volcano, a wreck, a sky island... (4.6). No file needed
Generated island	An island made by the island generator from a style and a size (4.5)
Spawn pool	The islands that may turn up by chance while you sail (<code>spawnpool1.txt</code> , 10)
Quest	An island's list of steps (go there, read that, open this...) with a reward at the end (6.1)
Story item	A key, a map, a log... that the crew carries and the journal (J) shows (6.3)
Journal	The crew's book of the custom islands (J): their story items and every note read, shared by everyone in the world. Not Raft's notebook (T) (3)

Word	Meaning
World plan	A list of rules for a world: which islands it gets, when and where (7)
Rule	One line of a plan: <i>when</i> something happens, bring <i>this island</i> , <i>there</i> , and tell the players <i>this</i>
Raft's story / the Receiver chain	Raft's own story islands (Radio Tower ... Utopia), found by tuning the Receiver. A plan can change it (6.5)
World settings	Optional switches for one world: monster difficulty, build cost, randomizer, extra options, levels (9)
Pack	A .zip made with Export... : a plan or island with every island it needs, to share (4.7)
Island library	The public collection of plans and islands others made, downloaded in the game (4.7)
Host	The player whose PC runs the world in multiplayer. The host's islands, plan and settings count (8)

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1. Installing

Experimental Alpha Release: this is the mod's first release, an early alpha. Things are likely to change, some systems might be unstable, and progress is not guaranteed to be saved - back up the worlds you care about (Raft keeps them in %USERPROFILE%\AppData\LocalLow\Redbeet Interactive\Raft\User). The main menu shows this in the **EXPERIMENTAL ALPHA RELEASE** box right of the middle, with the mod's version and three buttons: **Discord** (the Custom Islands Discord server), **Guide (PDF)** (this guide, which comes with the mod) and **Report a problem** ([section 15](#)). Drag the box anywhere you like; it stays where you put it. It steps aside while another window of the main menu is open (New Game, Load World, Settings, the island library...) and comes back when you close it. **Got it** folds it into a slim bar with the same buttons (its **Show** opens it again); the mod remembers that for this version only (in notice.txt), so a new version shows the whole box again.

1. Install the **Raft Mod Loader** (RML) from raftmodding.com and start Raft through it.
2. Put `DynamicIslands.rmod` into Raft's `mods` folder (for example `...\steamapps\common\Raft\mods\`), or install the mod from its raftmodding.com page.
3. Start Raft with RML's **Play** button. The first start takes a little longer: RML compiles the mod.

The mod keeps its files in `<Raft>\Mods\DynamicIslands\`: your islands (`*.island`), the settings files (`spawnpool.txt` and others, see [section 10](#)) and the world plans (`plans\`).

Playing together? Every player needs the mod. The host's islands, files and settings are sent to everyone who joins (see [section 8](#)).

2. Starting a new world

Click **NEW WORLD** in Raft's main menu. Raft's box looks as it always does, with two things of the mod at the bottom right: the **Custom Islands plan** and the **WORLD SETTINGS...** button, which says how many settings differ from plain Raft.



Raft's New Game box with the Custom Islands plan (Random islands) and the World settings button.

Part	What it does
Custom Islands plan	A ▼ list: click it to see every plan with a line on what it does, and click one to choose it. Which custom islands the world gets: Random islands (they appear by chance while you sail), No custom islands , or a plan such as Adventure (a story from island to island; see section 7). A plan can mix random islands, side trips and main quest islands: the three kinds . Get more... opens the island library to download plans others made; a plan you download there is chosen here (4.7)
World settings...	Opens the World settings window: the world's rules, the world randomizer, the extra options and which islands turn up while sailing (section 9). The button reads <code>Raft's own</code> while nothing differs from plain Raft, otherwise how many settings you changed (<code>3 changed</code>)

Then click Raft's **Create** as usual. Your choices are remembered for the next new world. They belong to the world: saved with it, the same for every player, and every new world gets its own.

Just want new islands? Leave the plan on **Random islands**, leave World settings as they are (`Raft's own`) and create the world: islands turn up while you sail ([section 3](#)), and the rest of Raft plays as it always does.

The World settings are optional extras for players who know Raft well; they are described together near the end of this guide.



The whole main menu. The EDITOR button opens the island editor ([section 4](#)), ISLAND LIBRARY the island library; the EXPERIMENTAL ALPHA RELEASE box (drag it anywhere), here folded with Got it, keeps its Discord, Guide and Report a problem buttons (Show opens it again). It steps aside while New World or any other window is open.

3. Sailing: custom islands in your world

Islands appear while you sail

Random islands, side trips and main quest islands - the three kinds of islands you meet, and how each is set up - are explained side by side in [section 7](#).

With the **Random islands** plan, now and then an island appears **250-350 m ahead of the raft** (about one island every 4 km). It can be:

- one of **your own islands** (every saved island takes part unless `spawnpool.txt` says otherwise),
- a **brand-new generated island**: a random size and style (tropical, snowy, desert, forest or volcanic), sometimes flying; it is saved as `gen-<style>-<seed>.island`, so it stays in that world,
- a **map type**: a sandbar, a wreck of raft blocks, an atoll or a sunken island (more in [4.6](#)).

Which of these a world may meet can be chosen when it is created ([9.5](#)). The optional world settings add more things to meet at sea: the randomizer's odd islands, large islands and boss lairs ([9.3](#)) and ghost rafts ([9.4](#)).

Islands keep clear of Raft's own islands and of each other, and Raft won't put its islands on top of them later. Islands far behind the raft are unloaded (after 800 m) and come back when you return.

Islands you still need come back. Raft's current carries the raft one way, so an island can drift out of reach - and without a Receiver nothing shows the way back. An island the players still need comes back on its own: about **12 minutes** after the raft left it behind (800 m and more), it turns up ahead of the raft again just as you left it - its quest where it was, opened chests still open - and a banner says "Back in sight". That is:

- an island whose quest you began and didn't finish: it comes back up to **three times** (an island you left on purpose stops coming back);
- an island a world plan still waits for - one that leads to the next island, like The Abyss Expedition's sunken island: it comes back every time, until you've done there what the plan waits for.

An island found with a Receiver frequency stays where it is (the Receiver shows the way), and so do islands nobody needs. With several players the host decides, and the island moves for everyone. (`returnMinutes` in `spawnpool.txt`, `10`; 0 = never.)

On the Receiver: once you have built Raft's Receiver, custom islands show as **green dots** with their distance, even far ones. An island a rule brought (a quest reward, a plan) carries its name on its dot.

Arriving

An island with a name shows it as a **banner** when you come near (once per island per session), with its author and a short welcome if the builder wrote them. Banners and messages (an island's, a zone's, a lever's) come **one after another**: one that arrives while another is on screen waits until that one has shown for at least 3 seconds.



Arriving at "Van Island", one of the world randomizer's oddity islands.

What you can do on an island

Custom islands work like Raft's own: you can **walk** on them, the **raft runs aground** on them, and you can **chop** palms, pines, birches and mango trees and **pick up** rocks, ores, clay, sand, berries, pineapples, flowers and more. What you took **stays taken** (also after saving, loading and sailing away), and it **grows back** after 3 in-game days (the island's builder or `spawnpool1.txt` can change that).



On a generated tropical island: Raft's bamboo, palms and plants, placed where Raft's own islands have them.



A generated island with the Nature setting on "Jungle": you have to squeeze between the trees.

Diving: generated islands rise from a deep sea floor like Raft's own: a sandy shelf about 10 m deep with corals and sea plants, then a drop-off. Giant clams, silver algae, stones, ores, scrap and the seaweed on sea vines can be picked up.



Under water around a generated island: the shelf, the reef, the drop-off and the slope further down.

Flying and sunken islands: some islands float high in the sky (build stairs or pillars up from the raft), others lie under the surface for divers.

Notes, chests, zones and creatures

The builder of an island can give it much more than land (see [section 5](#)). In a world:

- **Notes:** look at a readable object (a sign, a paper, a bottle...) and press the interact key (**E**) to read it. Close it with E, Tab, Esc or the button.
- **Chests:** look at one and press **E**: the items go into your inventory. The chest is then empty for everyone until it fills up again (after the regrow days, or never). Some chests are **locked** until you have their key.
- **Trigger zones:** invisible areas that fire when a player walks in: a message, items, or an **ambush** (animals that appear the moment you step in). Under water, a zone can be an **air pocket**: inside it your breath fills up again, as in Raft's air pockets under Caravan Town.
- **Creatures:** Raft's own animals at the island's creature spots, with the builder's toughness, size and colour. Warthogs and bears fight you; chickens, goats and llamas can be caught with Raft's net launcher and kept on the raft. Killed and caught animals come back after the regrow days unless the builder said never.



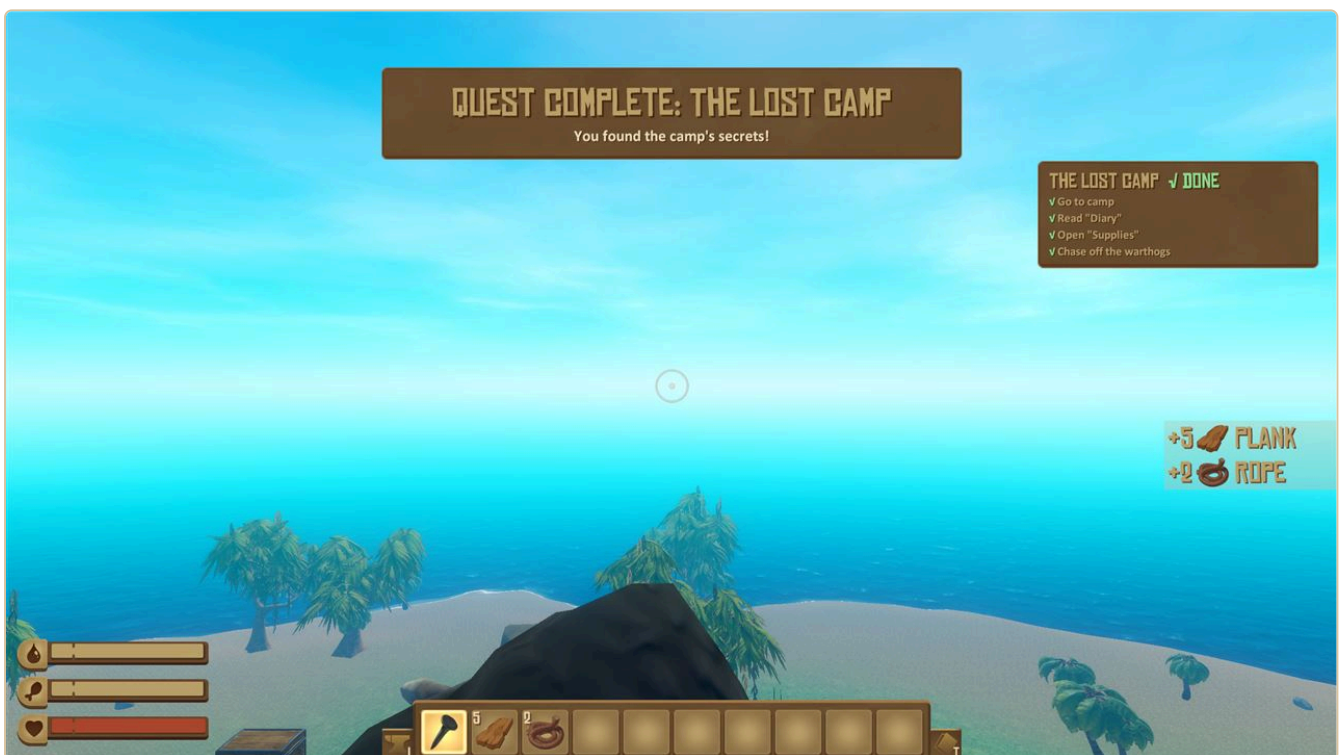
A note found on an island ("Warthogs live here. Bring a spear."), its title in Raft's lettering and its text on Raft's light tan, as the journal shows its pages. Press E, Tab or Esc to close it.

Quests

An island with a quest shows a **quest panel** on the right when you arrive, with its steps: go somewhere, read a note, open a chest, defeat or catch animals, collect story items, find journal pages. Each step done shows what's next; the last one gives the reward to every player near the island. The panel shows **five steps at a time**: the one just done, the one you're on and what comes after. A longer quest scrolls - to your step by itself whenever it changes, and with the mouse wheel over the panel while the cursor is free (the inventory, the journal, the Esc menu).



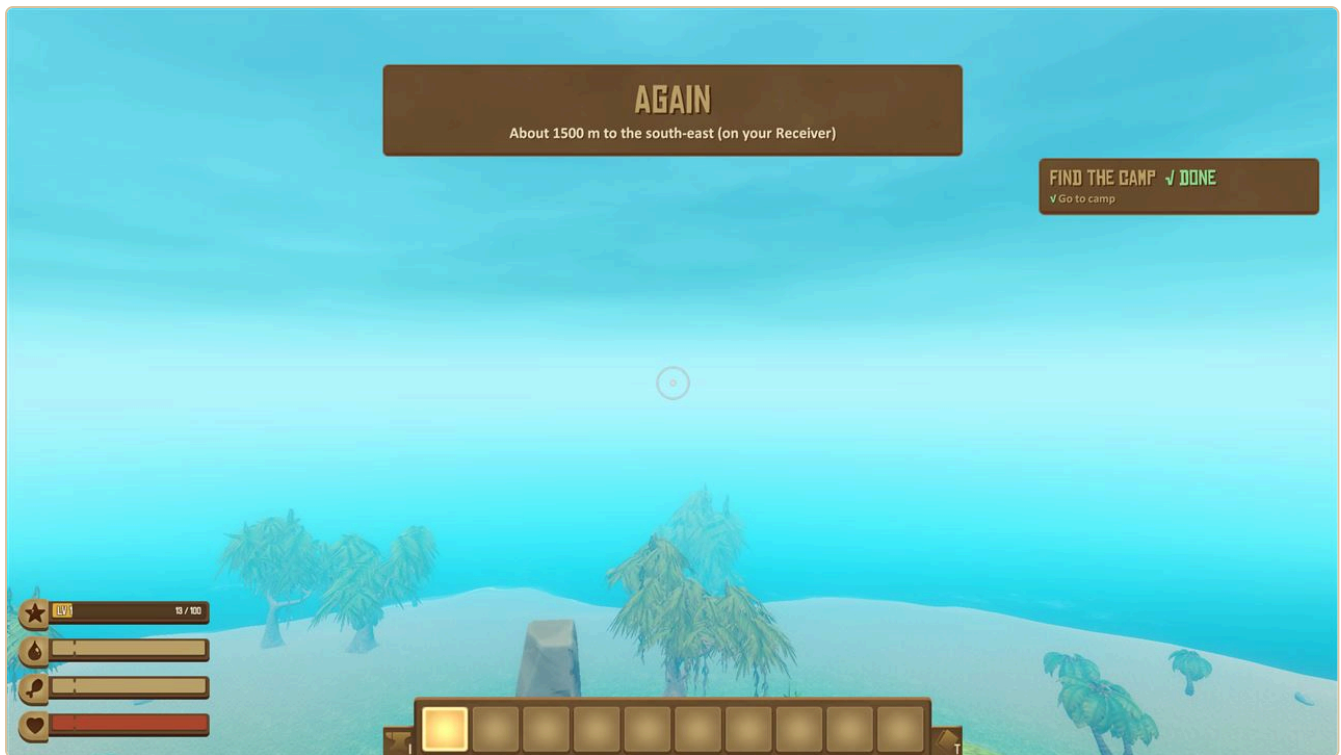
The quest panel of "The lost camp" on the right: the first step is "Go to camp".



Quest complete: the banner, every step ticked in the panel, and the reward (planks and rope) in the inventory.

New islands from quests and rules

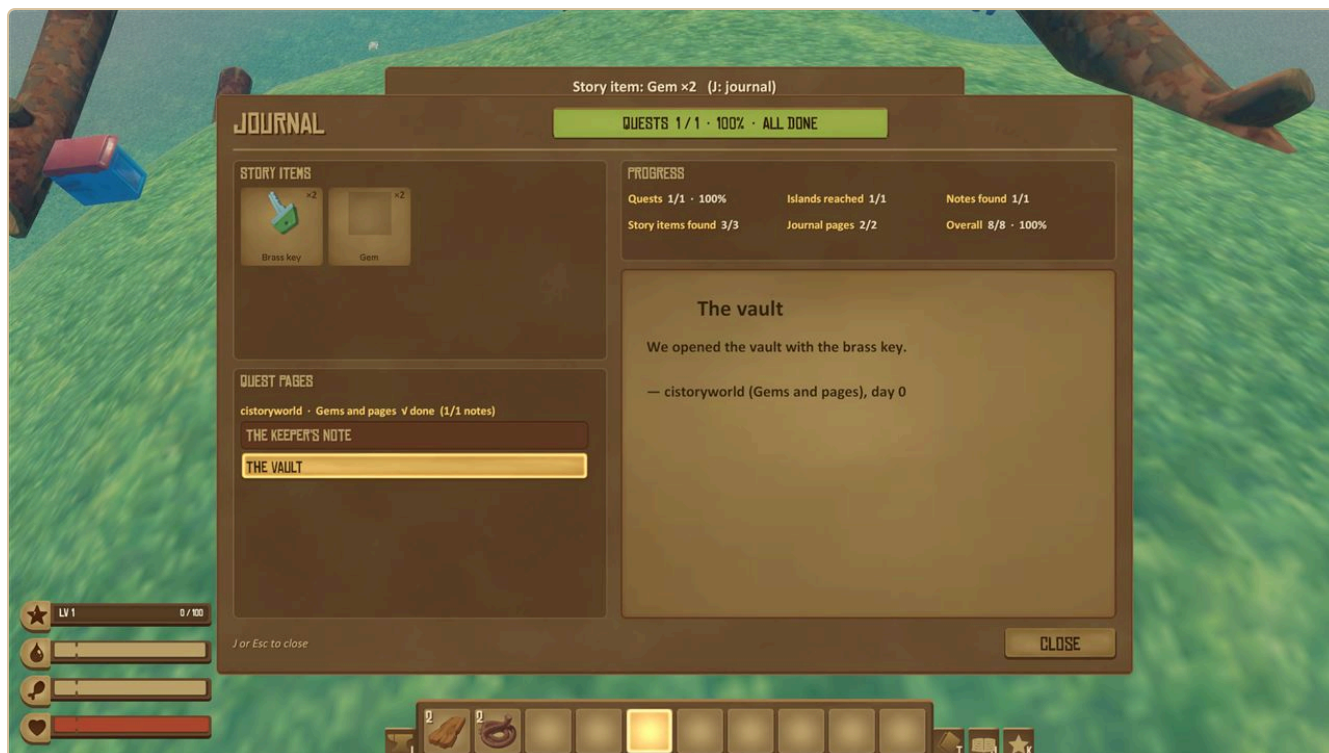
A finished quest (or a plan's rule) can **bring a new island**: every player sees a banner with a message and how far and which way it is, and the island's dot on the Receiver carries its name.



A rule brought a new island: "About 970 m to the south-east (on your Receiver)". The quest panel shows the finished step.

The journal (J)

The **journal** is the crew's book of the custom islands' story: what you found on them and what you carry for them. Press **J** in a world to open it; **J**, **Esc** or **Close** closes it. (J does nothing while you type in the chat or console, while a note is open, or in the editor.) Its key is also shown at the hotbar: after Raft's notebook tab (**T**) come the journal's tab (**J**, an open book) and, while the level up system is on in the world, the stats page's (**K**, a star).



The journal: the custom quests done at the top, the Progress panel (quests, islands reached, notes, story items, journal pages, overall - hover a line for what it counts), the story items at the top left, the pages under Quest Pages by island with its quest and its notes found ("1/1 notes"), and the page "The vault" open, signed with the island, its quest and the day.

What's in it

- **Story items** (top left): keys, map pieces, logs... that the islands' builders made. Each shows its picture and name, with **x2**, **x3**... when the crew has more than one. Past eight, the list scrolls (the mouse wheel or its bar). Click one to see its picture and description on the paper. They come from chests, trigger zones, quest rewards and island events; a message tells you ("Story item: Old key (J: journal)"). An item that is **used up** (say a key a locked door takes) leaves the journal.
- **Quest Pages** (bottom left), **by island** - each island's quest line: each island's pages under its name and its quest's title (✓ **done** once the quest is done) and how many of its notes you have found, **(5/7 notes)** - so you know if some are still left on it - the island you were at last first, its newest page first - so notes of several islands don't get mixed up. They are every note you read on a custom island - the first time anyone reads it, once, with its title - pages an island writes when something happens (an island event "write a journal page"), and, under **Other pages**, the frequencies a world plan gives out ("Tune the Receiver to #4821"). Click a page to read it on the paper, signed with the island, its quest and the day it was found.
- **QUESTS 7 / 20 · 35%** (top, next to the title): how many of this world's **custom islands' quests** are done, with a green bar that fills as you go. Raft's own story (Radio Tower ... Utopia) isn't counted - the journal is the custom islands' book. It counts:
 - **a world plan's own islands in the story** (the main quest islands, such as Wreckers' Cove after the Radio Tower in The Long Voyage): done as the story counts them - by default when their quest is done;
 - **the plan's other islands that have a quest** (side trips, a quest chain...): counted **from the start of the world**, even before they come, so the total shows how much there is to do. One that comes as a new island of a map type or from a list counts once it has come (until then nobody knows what it is);
 - **every other island with a quest** that has come to the world: by chance while sailing, brought by another island's rule, the world randomizer's treasure hunts. These add to the total as you meet

them.

An island counts once, however many rules name it. **Click the count** for the whole list on the paper, by kind: ✓ done, – still to do. The count is the same for every player and is worked out again every 2 seconds while the journal is open, so a quest another player finishes shows at once.

The end in sight. When **90%** of the world's quests are done, every player gets a banner: "*Nearing the end - You are nearing the end: 18 of 20 quests done (90%). The journal (J) lists what is left.*" At **100%** it says "*The whole quest line is done - You have completed the whole quest line: all 20 quests of this world are done!*", and the count reads **ALL DONE**. Each banner comes once per world (it is remembered with the world, for every host), and a world that gets to 100% in one go shows only the second. A world with fewer than 5 quests has no banners: there, one island's quest isn't a quest line. Islands with quests that come later (by chance while sailing) add to the count again, but the banners don't come twice.



A click on the count: the custom quests by kind, done and still to do.

- **Progress** (top right, over the page): how far the crew has come in this world, each as found / total - hover a line to see what it counts:
 - **Quests** - quests done, and the per cent (the same as the bar at the top);
 - **Islands reached** - custom islands someone has set foot on, of those in the world and those its plan will bring;
 - **Notes found** - notes read of the notes with a text on those islands (each island's line under Quest Pages has its own, "(5/7 notes)");
 - **Story items found** - of those the islands have; one used up since (a key a door took) still counts;
 - **Journal pages** - pages in the journal of all the islands can give: their notes and the pages their events write;
 - **Overall** - all of it together, with the per cent.

What counts is what this world has: the custom islands in it and the saved islands its plan brings, counted from the start of the world (also those still to come). An island made new from a map type counts once it

has come, and an island that comes by chance adds to every line when it comes. Raft's own islands count only in Quests (their notes are in Raft's notebook, T). An empty journal says where to look.

One journal for the whole crew. Everyone in the world shares it: a note one player reads is in everyone's journal, and a key one player finds opens the door for all. The host keeps it, a player who joins gets it, it is saved with the world, and it goes back with an older save (8).

The journal and quests. Besides the count and its list (above), the journal doesn't show a quest's steps: an island's quest is shown in the **quest panel** on the right while you are **at that island** (Quests), and it leaves when you sail away. But the journal is what some steps count:

- **Find (a number of) a story item** counts that story item in the journal - so an item found before the quest counts too, and one used up no longer does.
- **Find pages on this island** counts the journal's pages from that island's notes and events; **on any island** counts every page.

So when a quest step waits for items or pages, press J to see what the crew has.

The journal and Raft's notebook. Raft's own notebook (T) stays as it always was, and the two don't mix:

	Raft's notebook (T)	The journal (J)
Pages	The notes of Raft's story islands (Radio Tower, Vasagatan, Balboa...)	The notes of custom islands, pages their events write, and frequencies a world plan gives out
Items	Raft's quest items (Raft's keys, key cards...)	The custom islands' story items
The Receiver	The frequencies of Raft's story; when a plan changes Raft's story, the notebook follows it (6.5)	A page with each frequency a plan's rule unlocks for its own island, and with a Raft story island's frequency when one of the plan's islands unlocked it (no Raft note gives it then)
Quests	- (Raft's story goes by its notes and the Receiver)	- (the quest panel shows the quest of the island you're at)
Without the mod	Always there	Kept in the mod's file of the world: the world still loads without the mod, and the journal comes back with it

How the two books look when a plan keeps all, some or none of Raft's story, with or without its own islands in it: [Raft's notebook and the journal in each kind of plan](#).

Why two books? Raft's notebook has a fixed set of pages and quest items, made for Raft's story. New pages or items put into it would be lost, or break the world's save when it is opened without the mod. So custom islands write into their own book, kept with the mod's state of the world. For the same reason story items aren't in your inventory: the crew holds them in the journal, like Raft holds its quest items outside the inventory.

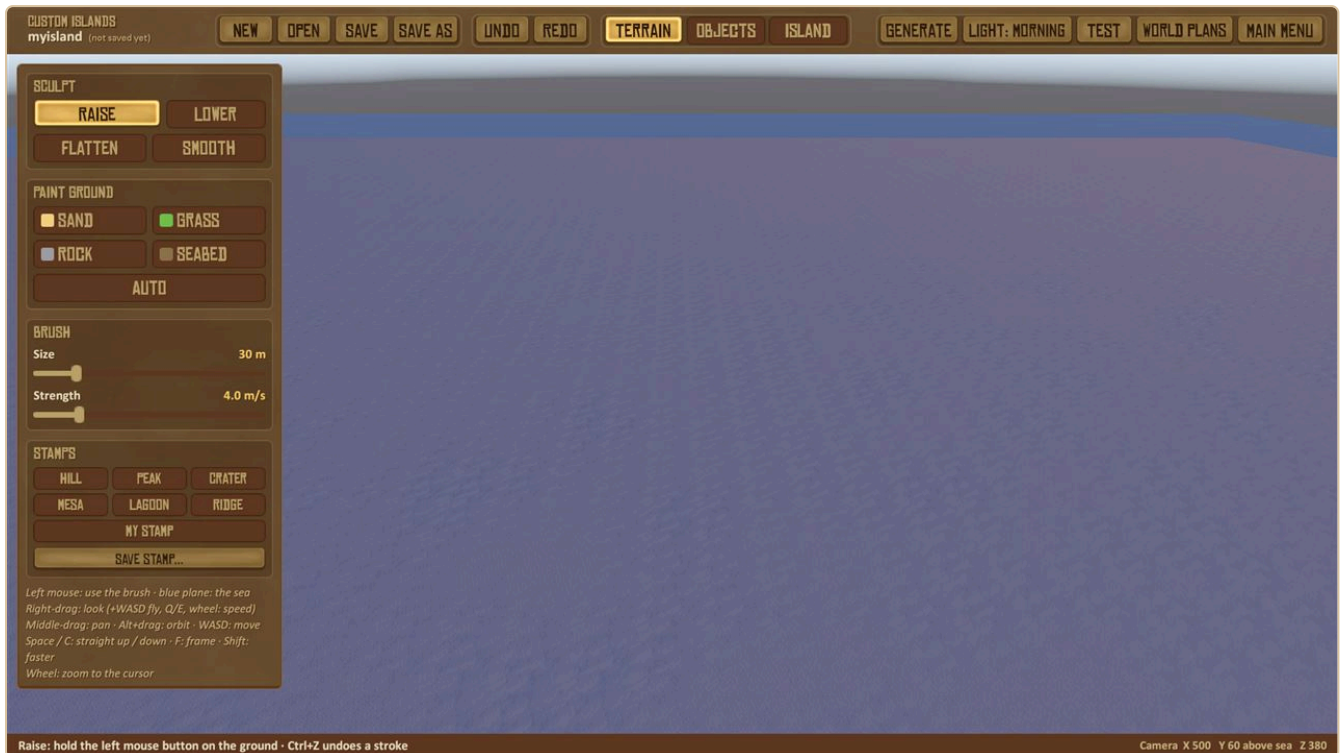
4. Building your own island: the editor

Click **EDITOR** in the main menu. A loading box shows what it is doing ("Opening the editor", then "Loading Raft's objects from its islands" with a bar) until the editor is ready: a few seconds the first time after starting Raft, less after that. The editor opens on the sea with an empty build area.



The box that covers the screen while the editor opens.

4.1 The screen



The editor on the Terrain tab.

- **Top bar:** New, Open, Save, Save as · Undo, Redo · the three tabs **Terrain**, **Objects**, **Island** (F1, F2, F3) · **Generate** (the island generator), **Light** (the time of day, below), **Test** (try the island in a world, [4.9](#)), **World plans**, **Main menu**. The island's name is at the top left.
- **Tool panel** (left): the tab's tools in bordered groups. The lit button is the one in use.
- **Status bar** (bottom): explains the tool, or the button under the mouse. On the right: where the camera is.
- **The blue plane is the sea.** Everything below it is under water in the game.

Moving the camera (like Unity's scene view):

Do this	To
Right-drag	look around (dragging up tilts the view down, as if you dragged the scene); while held, WASD flies where you look, Q/E go down and up, the wheel sets the speed
WASD or arrows	move over the island at the same height
Space / C	go straight up / straight down, whichever way the camera looks (the Terrain and Objects tabs' tips say so too)
Middle-drag	pan (the ground follows the cursor)
Alt + left-drag	orbit around the selection, or the middle of the view
Wheel	zoom towards what is under the cursor
F	frame the selection, or the whole island

Do this	To
Shift	three times faster

Undo and redo everything with **Ctrl+Z** / **Ctrl+Y**; save with **Ctrl+S**, open with **Ctrl+O**.

Light: the time of day. The top bar's **Light** list has **Morning, Noon, Evening, Night** and **Overcast** (click it and pick one): the sun's height, colour and shadows, the sky's light on everything and a haze far out change, so you can see how the island will look at that time in Raft (a dark cave mouth at night, a beach in the evening sun). It is only how the editor shows the island - nothing is saved in the island. Your choice is kept for the next time you open the editor (Noon the first time).



The same island at Morning, Noon, Evening and Night.

4.2 Shaping the land (Terrain tab)

- **Sculpt: Raise, Lower, Flatten, Smooth.** Hold the left mouse button on the ground; the white ring shows the brush. Objects standing on the ground you sculpt **go up and down with it** (trees, rocks, huts: lowering the ground no longer leaves them in the air, raising it no longer buries them); what stands higher, on a deck or a roof, stays. **Ctrl+Z** undoes the stroke and the objects' moves together.
- **Paint ground:** the style's four textures (for a tropical island Sand, Grass, Rock, Seabed). **Auto** textures an area by its height and slope again.
- **Brush:** size and strength.
- **Stamps:** click the ground to put down a **Hill, Peak, Crater, Mesa, Lagoon** or **Ridge**, as big as the brush (Q/E turn it). **Save stamp...** keeps the land under the brush as a stamp of your own.

Island styles. On the Island tab, **Style** ◀ ▶ steps through Tropical, Snowy, Desert, Forest and Volcanic (or click the name for the list): the ground takes the style's textures, the paint buttons get its names, and the generator uses its plants and animals.



The same kind of island in four styles, as the generator makes them: tropical palms, snowy pines, desert red rock, forest birches.

4.3 Placing objects (Objects tab)



The Objects tab: the tools on the left, the object browser on the right (713 of 1,947 objects loaded).

The **object browser** on the right has **every object of Raft**, about 1,900, each with a picture: nature, harvestable trees and rocks, Raft's 88 building blocks (to build huts or your own abandoned rafts), everything else you can build on a raft, and the objects of Raft's story islands (they load the first time you open their category). **Search** finds objects in every category.

Objects from Raft's islands are placed **standing straight**: one that leant a little where Raft has it (a ladder against a wall) stands up straight; a bigger lean - more than 25°, a boulder lying on its side - is its look and stays.

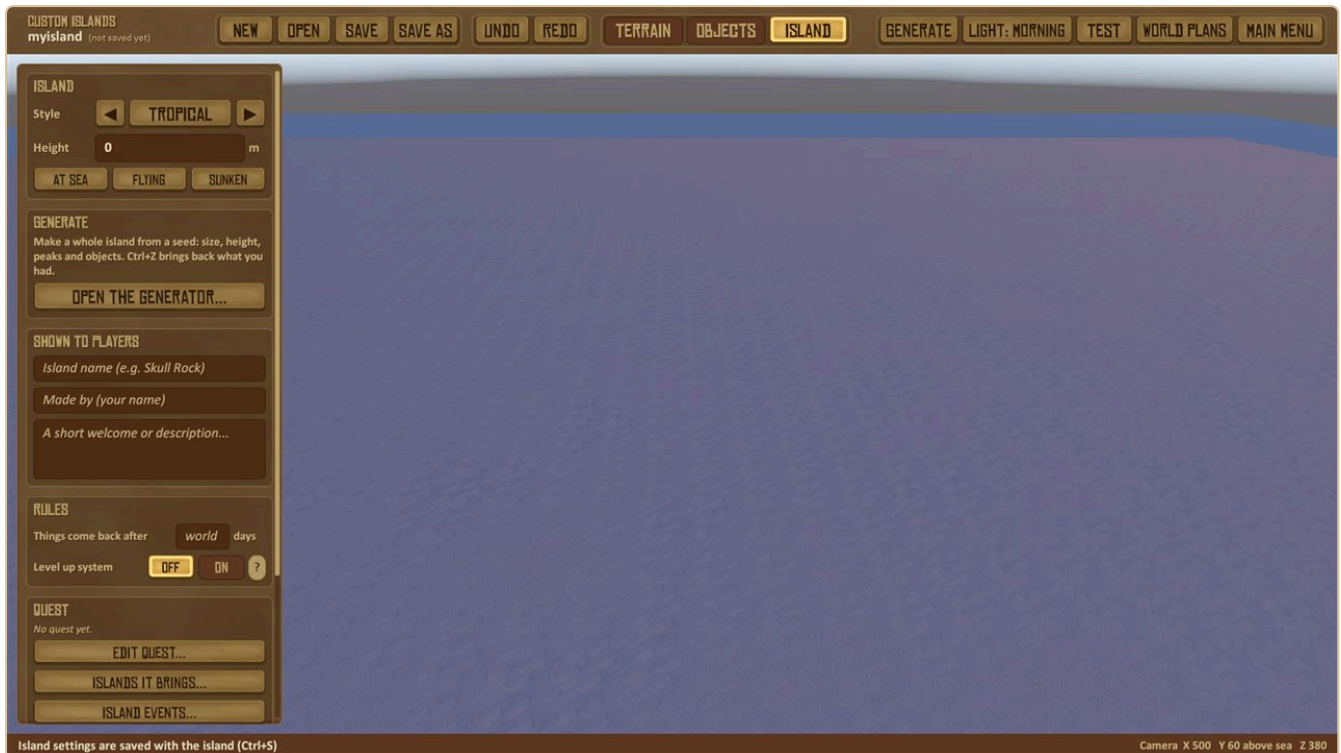
- **Place**: click an object in the browser, then click the ground. **Q/E** turn it, **[** and **]** resize it, **Shift+click** keeps placing, **Esc** stops. On a slope an object goes down to the **lowest ground under its base**, so a house on legs or a van stands on all of its legs and wheels instead of its high side (with **Slope** on, it leans with the ground instead).
- **Select**: click a placed object; **Shift+click** adds more.
- **Transform** (keys 1-4): Move, Turn, Scale or All, with the coloured handles. **X** switches the arrows between the world's directions and the object's own turn; **P** turns and scales around each object's own point or the middle of the selection; hold **Ctrl** while dragging to snap (0.25 m, 15°). An island holds at most 100 000 objects (the editor says so past 12 000: big islands take longer to appear in a world).
- **Selection: Ground** puts the selection down on the terrain - by its base: on a slope down to the lowest ground under it, so nothing of it stands in the air - **Duplicate** (Ctrl+D), **Deselect**, **Delete**.
- **Placing: Random** gives each placed object a random turn and size, **Slope** leans it with the ground, **Grid** snaps to Raft's 1.5 m building grid (Q/E then turn in 90° steps).
- **Groups**: select several objects and click **Save as group....** The group appears under **My groups** at the top of the browser, to place on any island.



A herd of two warthogs (the pink marker) and a sign. "My groups" in the browser holds two saved groups.

Selecting a single object shows its **inspector** in the tool panel: creature settings, a note, loot, a zone, a colour, behaviours (see [section 5](#)).

4.4 The Island tab



The Island tab: style, height in the world, the generator, the name players see, the island's rules and its quest.

- **Style** and **Height** in the world: **At sea** (0), **Flying** (60 m up) or **Sunken** (30 m under water), or any number. The editor always shows the island at sea level; the height applies in the game.
- **Shown to players:** the island's **name**, your name and a short welcome. Players see them as a banner.
- **Rules:** how many in-game days until chopped trees, picked items, killed animals, looted chests and fired zones come back on this island (empty = the world's setting, 0 = never). **Level up system** Off / On: see [section 9.6](#).
- **Quest, Islands it brings, Island events, Story items:** see [section 6](#).

4.5 The island generator

Generate (top bar) makes a whole island for you to start from. The **preview** map on the right follows every change; the line under it says how big the island is and how many objects it will get. The **seed** picks one island of all possible ones: the same seed and settings always give the same island. Every setting has a **?** to hover. Generating replaces the island you have; **Ctrl+Z** brings it back. After **Generate** the window steps aside so you see the new island at once (a message says what it made); **Generate** in the top bar opens it again, with your settings.



The Normal tab: your presets, the style and layout, the size and height (with buttons for the size and height of Raft's own small island, large island and Balboa), peaks, hills and the coast.

- **Island:** the **style** and the **layout**: round, atoll, archipelago, sea stacks, plateau, marsh, crescent, twin peaks.
- **Size and height, coast and outline, land features:** peaks and their shape, hills, coast, bays, beach, cliffs, stretch, valleys, lakes, terraces, erosion.
- **Under water:** a **deep sea floor like Raft's** (a shelf about 10 m deep, then a drop-off) or a **shallow** one (a flat seabed 20 m down), the width of the shallow water, how steep the drop-off is, and the seabed (sand, rocky, or a reef ring).
- **Nature:** trees, bushes, rocks, beach things and harvestables, with quick buttons **None**, **Sparse**, **Like Raft**, **Dense** and **Jungle**. "Like Raft" places everything where Raft's own islands have it: a nearly bare beach, palms inland on grass, boulders on steep ground - and as thick on the land as there, kind by kind, measured on Raft's islands of the style: a big island like Raft's big ones (sparse, few things to pick up on the land), a small one like its small ones (bamboo, bushes and flowers close together, green nearly down to the water). Each slider's word says how it stands against Raft ("less than Raft", "like Raft", "dense"...). Thicker than Like Raft (**Dense**, **Jungle**) thickens the island's higher ground: its low beach and flats - under 4 m above the sea, where Raft's islands grow bamboo - stay as thick as Raft's, so a jungle island's beaches don't become fields of bamboo. And at Like Raft no kind is ever thicker on the land than on Raft's own islands of the style and size: a cluster of little islets, all shore, would otherwise get twice the bushes of Raft's small islands. Everything stands with **all of its base on the ground**: on a slope a rock, a bush or a log goes down to the lowest ground under it (its high side a little in the slope, as Raft's own are), and flat things such as snow drifts lie along gentle slopes and are left off steep ones. They are set down on the terrain's own surface (its triangles), so nothing hangs in the air over a steep, uneven slope.
- **Life under water:** corals, sea vines, kelp, rocks, stones, ores, giant clams and sunken barrels, placed like around Raft's own islands: each kind as close to the shore as there (boulders by the shore, rock formations on the drop-off) and as thick. The corals grow in **reefs** as Raft's do: a few tight patches some 15 m across (one per 250 corals or so), 2-20 m down and 6-45 m out from the land, more on the slopes than on flat sand, with bare sand and rock between them - sea vines and kelp round them - never a

carpet of coral over the whole sea floor. At Like Raft there are never more corals and plants per m² of sea floor than around Raft's own islands, nor more rocks than half as many again - an island with a wide shallow shelf gets more sea floor, not more rocks crowded along its beaches. Raft's resources stay where Raft has them: metal and copper ore, scrap, giant clams and silver algae only under water, never on the land - and every island with sea floor around it gets at least one of each that Raft's islands of its style have, so even a small island has its ore. **Like Raft** is as dense as Raft's own reefs (about 160 corals and plants per 1000 m² 2-10 m down, with sand between the reef patches); **Teeming**, the top of the sliders, is twice that. More than that carpets a shallow lagoon's floor - nothing like Raft. **Groups** (under Nature) makes the reefs tighter (or looser).

- **Animals:** hostile creatures (the style's own, or the kinds you click), how tough (Easy, Normal, Hard, Boss), friendly animals to catch, sea creatures.
- **Loot:** how many loot boxes, their lowest and highest **tier** (1: planks and plastic ... 5: titanium, explosive goo, batteries), in the open or hidden.
- **Buildings and caves** (the last group):
 - **Buildings: Off / On** - buildings on the island's open, level land, each with a chest (most with a note too, which counts in the journal's notes).
 - **Kind** (a ▼ list, or the arrows):
 - **Mixed** - a bit of everything that suits the island's style;
 - **Castaway huts** - Raft's thatch walls and roof on Raft's foundations, a hammock and a chest inside;
 - **Wooden cabins** - the same in Raft's wooden walls and roof, with a bed, a chest and a cabin log;
 - the quest islands' **scenes**, made of their own props, each with a chest and a note: **Castaways' camp**, **Caravan outpost**, **Radio outpost**, **Scrapyard**, **Old market**, **Bear country** (with a bear nearby), **Frozen camp** and **Hotel garden**.

A hut or cabin is 3 x 2 or 2 x 2 cells of Raft's building grid, open on one side. It stands level on the highest ground under it, with the ground built up under it (blended over 3 m, so nothing hangs in the air on a slope), and its roof rests on its walls and corner pillars as Raft's own building puts one.

- **How many** - 1 to 6, at least 22 m apart. A small or steep island has room for fewer: the line under the preview after **Generate** says how many found a spot ("2 building(s) found no level spot").
- **Caves: Off / On** - one of Raft's own cave pieces (Balboa's) set into the land, its mouth towards open, level ground, with a guard inside (a polar bear on a snowy island, a bear in a forest, a hyena in the desert, else a warthog or a rat) and a hoard. It needs a hill next to open, level land; if none fits, the line says so.

The scenes and the cave use objects of Raft's own islands: the first **Generate** with them loads those islands (a few seconds; the line says "Loading Raft's islands for the buildings and caves...") and then generates. The same settings and seed always give the same buildings in the same places. A preset keeps these settings too.

- **Quest** (the very last group): **Quest steps**, 0 to 8 - a quest made together with the island, and everything it needs put on the island:
 - first a **castaway's note** to read where players come ashore;
 - then, chosen by the seed: a **lookout** to climb to (a trigger zone up high), **monsters** to defeat (the style's own: warthogs or rats, a bear in a forest, a polar bear on snow, hyenas in the desert), **map pieces** to collect from three small chests (a story item, in the journal), a **torn page** to read, a **supply crate** to open, **animals** to catch with Raft's net launcher;

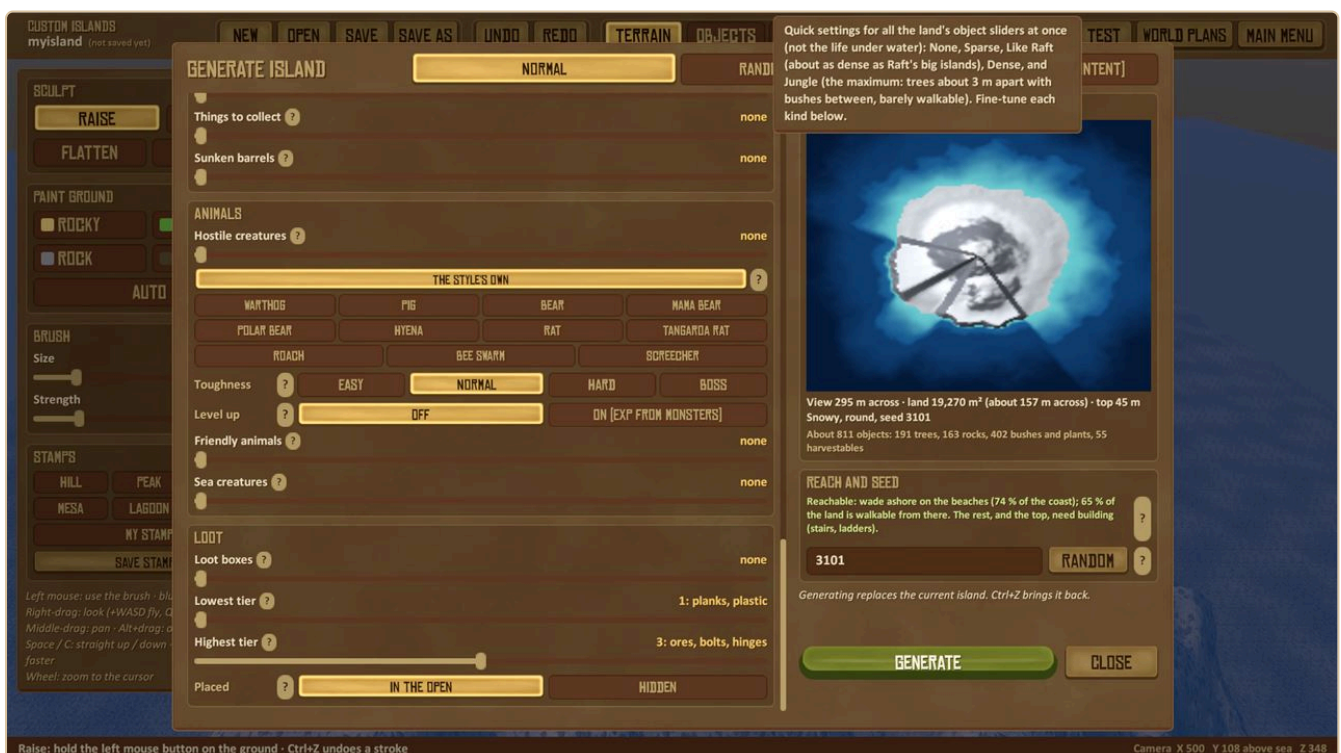
- last the **castaway's hoard** to open at the top of the island. With 1 step there is only a hidden hoard.

It replaces the island's quest (Ctrl+Z brings the old one back): the Island tab's **Quest** shows it, and you can change it there like any quest. On a small island a step whose place doesn't fit is left out; the message says how many steps it got. 0 leaves the island's quest as it is.

- **My presets: Save these settings...** keeps them under a name; **Defaults** starts over.



Further down the Normal tab: the land features, the Under water group (Deep, like Raft) and the Nature quick buttons. Hovering a ? shows its help (here Stretch).



The bottom of the Normal tab: things to collect, sunken barrels, animals (the kinds to click, the toughness) and loot.

Can players reach it? Above the seed, a coloured line says whether a player arriving by raft can get onto the island: **Easy** (beaches, walk to the top), **Reachable**, **Possible but tricky** (a jump onto a low ledge), **Possible but unlikely**, or **Not from the raft without building** (cliffs all around: players need stairs, a ladder or foundations). It is worked out with Raft's own player: how steep it can walk, how high it jumps.



A cliff island: "Not from the raft without building: cliffs all around (the lowest ledge is 17 m above the water)."

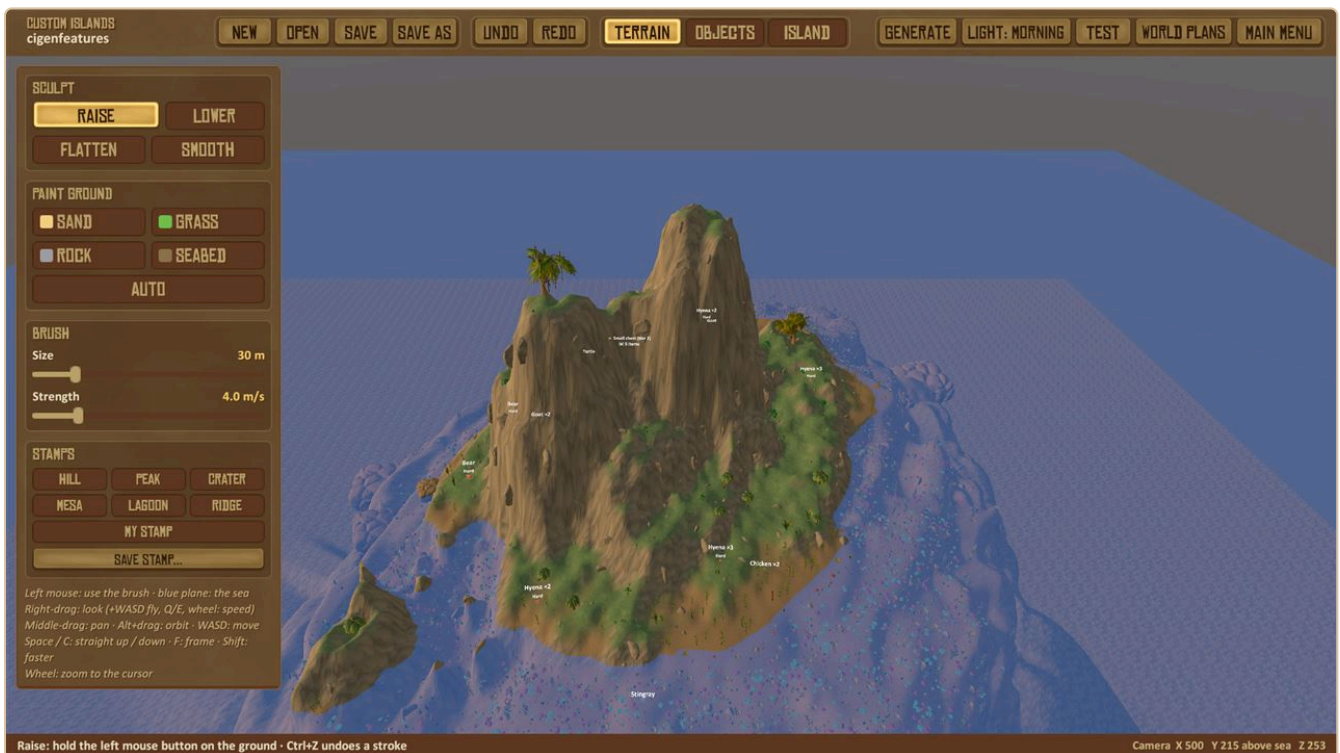
Randomize existing: click one of Raft's 33 islands (each has a picture). **Something new like it** makes a new island with its size, height and look; **A variation of it** starts from the island's own ground and reshapes it (stretch, mirror, roughen, coast, valleys...). This tab shows only what remakes the chosen island - and a **Quest** group - not the Normal tab's other groups (its buildings and caves aren't used here). It remakes the island's **ground and nature**, and for a story island with designs also **what is built on it**:

- **Rebuild it** (shown for the Radio Tower; more of Raft's story islands to come): **Design** - something like the island built anew from **its own pieces** on the new ground, different with every seed (how high, how many storeys and decks, which walls have windows, which way it faces):
 - **A radio tower** - a station on the ground (its door, a power box, a locker), legs 6 to 18 m up to the radio room (the radio on its table, a chair, the radar screen, a locker), a roof with the dish, the windmill, a floodlight and a mast with a lamp; a ladder all the way up;
 - **An oil rig** - over the open sea off the island (water at least 4 m deep under all of it): four of the tower's floors on legs down to the sea floor, railings, a control room with the dish on its roof, a lit flare stack, the windmill, supplies, and ladders down to a moored boat;
 - **A lighthouse under construction** - on a headland (high ground with the sea close by): 4 to 6 storeys of the tower's walls and floors with a ladder up the outside, the top ones still being built - poles round it, the lamp's parts waiting by the door - or finished, with a lantern room of windows, lamps facing out and a lit mast;
 - **Random design** (picked by the seed), or **None** (only ground and nature).

Its furniture stands on the floors and its legs reach the ground or the sea floor: nothing of it floats. The pieces come from Raft's own island: the first Generate loads it (a few seconds).



Randomize existing: Raft's islands, measured, with a picture each. Here a variation of "Big Island OG".



A variation made from one of Raft's big islands, opened in the editor.



A generated island in the editor, ready to change: its trees and bushes are ordinary objects you can move or delete.

The editor's view under water shows what a deep sea floor looks like:



A generated island on the deep sea floor: the shelf and drop-off from above, the slope, the reef, the drop-off.

4.6 Ready-made islands (map types)

The generator's **Ready-made (with content)** tab makes whole islands with a story: chests, notes, creatures, zones and a quest, from a seed. Click a card, then **Make** (click twice): the island is saved as `gen-<type>-<seed>` and opened for you to change.



The Ready-made tab: plain islands of each style, and the map types with their content.



Some map types: an archipelago (a castaway's caches), an atoll, sea stacks (a chest on the tallest), a boss island, an old camp, and a treasure island in a world, its quest panel saying "Find the map on the beach".

Map type	What it is
Sandbar	A tiny island with a few palms and a small chest: a rest stop
Atoll	A ring of land around a shallow lagoon
Archipelago	Several islets; a castaway's note and three caches
Sea stacks	Steep rock pillars; a chest on top of the tallest (build your way up)
Boss island	A plateau with cliffs and a ramp; the arena wakes a boss bear
Volcano, swamp, frozen spire	A tall volcano with embers; low land with pools and mist; a snowy peak with a cache on top
Treasure island	A map in a bottle on the beach leads to the X and a treasure chest

Map type	What it is
Old camp	An abandoned camp with a notice board and supplies: a good first island of a story
Sunken island, sky island	Under water, with corals, sunken barrels and puffer fish; floating 45-90 m up with a cache
Wreck, ghost raft	No land: an abandoned raft of Raft's own blocks, floating like a real raft (the deck just above the water). A wreck has barrels to loot; a ghost raft is small, medium or large with a note, and the large ones are guarded by rats and screechers (9.4)
Oddities, boss lair, large island	The world randomizer's islands (section 9.3)

4.7 Saving and sharing

Save (Ctrl+S) saves straight away once the island has its own name (a new island asks for one first: until then it is only "myisland"); **Save as** and **Open** show the **Islands** window: a name, the height in the world, and your saved islands (click = pick, double-click = open, Delete asks first and says which saved worlds, plans and other islands' rules use the island). A deleted island isn't erased: it is moved to `Mods\DynamicIslands\deleted` - move the file back into `Mods\DynamicIslands` to get it back. Copies kept for saved worlds (<name>_<hash>) aren't in the list: the island library's **Tidy up** clears the ones nothing uses.

Nothing unsaved is lost: opening another island, **New**, or a map type's **Make** while the island has unsaved changes keeps them as its autosave first (the editor says so, and offers them back the next time it opens).



The Islands window: the name and height, and the saved islands with their date and size.

Islands are files in `<Raft>\Mods\DynamicIslands\` (<name>.island). In multiplayer the host's island files are sent to players who don't have them, so nobody needs to share files just to play together (section 8).

Autosave. While the island has changes you haven't saved, the editor keeps a copy every 3 minutes, and when you leave to the main menu or quit Raft (`Mods\DynamicIslands\autosave\<name>.island` - not an

island of yours, it never turns up anywhere). If Raft closes before you saved (a crash, the power going), the next time the editor opens it offers the unsaved work: **Open** it (then **Save** to keep it), **Throw them away**, or **Not now** (asked again next time). Saving the island removes its autosave. Every change counts - the land, objects, their settings, and the island's own settings on the Island tab (name, texts, style, height, rules, quest, events, story items), which Undo and Redo also take back and forth; save before you close Raft all the same. Selecting objects isn't a change.

Objects this Raft version doesn't have. After a Raft update an object an island uses may be gone or renamed. In the editor it shows as a **red box** in its place (the island says how many when it opens): it keeps its name, place, size and settings, and saving writes it back unchanged, so a later version of Raft or the mod can show it again. Delete the box if you don't want it. In a world such an object is left out, and the player is told once.

Saving an island your saved worlds have. A saved world remembers what was used on the island - trees chopped, things picked up, chests looted, zones fired, doors opened - by the order of the island's objects. So:

- changes that keep that order reach those worlds the next time they load: moving objects, changing their settings, the ground, the island's settings, and **new objects** (they come after the others). The first time you save over such an island, the editor says which worlds have it. If you moved its ground, anything built on it there may no longer fit;
- changes that would mix it up - **deleting objects**, changing their order, or making an object a chest - don't reach them: those worlds keep playing the version they started with (the editor says so; a copy `<name>_<code>.island` is kept for them), and new worlds get your new version. To give a world the new version anyway, save your changes under a new name (**Save as**) and bring that island into the world.

Sharing an island or a plan: Export. In the Islands window, pick an island and click **Export...**; in the World plan window (a plan open) click **Export....** The **Share** window says what goes along:

- an island takes the islands its rules bring with it ("Palm Cove + 1 island it brings: Treasure Cove"), and theirs, so its quest chain still works for whoever gets it;
- a plan takes every island it needs. Rules of the kind "a new island of a map type" need no file (every player's mod makes those), and islands from the spawn pool come from each player's own islands;
- if one of those islands isn't saved, the export stops and names it.

Fill in the **title**, **author** (your Steam name to start with), a one-line **summary**, a **description** (what players find, how long it takes, what you had in mind, e.g. "best with Fierce monsters" - a pack never sets difficulty or other World settings; the player's own choices always apply), **tags**, **players** and **length**, and whether **others may change it and share their version** (they must credit you either way). The **picture** is what the editor's camera shows: close the window, move the view, open it again, or click **Take picture**; its middle becomes the icon. **Export** writes a pack, `Mods\DynamicIslands\exports\<name>.zip`; **Open folder** shows it; **Share...** opens the island library's page to send it in. Export the same island or plan again later and the pack is the next version of the same entry (so whoever has it can update it).



The Share window: what goes along, the entry's info on the left, the picture of the editor's view on the right.

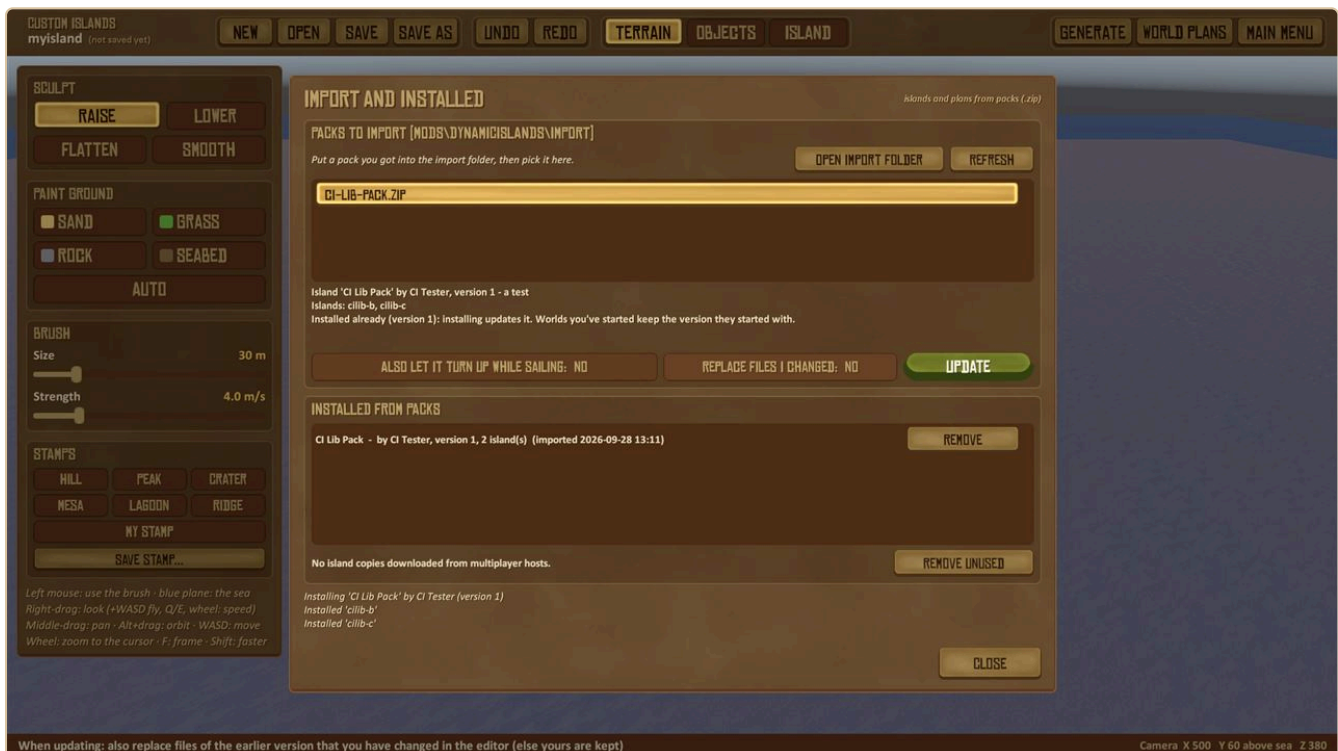
Getting islands from a pack: Import. Put a pack (.zip) you got into `Mods\DynamicIslands\import` (**Open import folder**), click **Import...** in the Islands window or the World plan window, and pick it: the window says what it holds, who made it and its version. **Install** puts it in place:

- **Your own files are never overwritten.** If you have a different island with the same name, the pack's is installed as `Name (Pack title)` and the pack's plan and islands are changed to use that name. The same island (the very same file) is shared, not copied. A plan whose name you already use gets the author added: `First Voyage (Author)` - and your very own plan (the same file) stays yours: removing the pack later leaves it.
- A plan may bring only new islands of map types: such a pack holds no island files at all, and that's fine.
- **Story items with the same id:** a world's crew holds one of each story item id for all its islands. If the pack's islands use an id another installed pack uses too (two packs' `key`), Install says so - in a world with both, the key found for one would open the other's door. Fine if the packs are never played in one world.
- An **island** from a pack only turns up by chance while sailing if you tick **Also let it turn up while sailing** - then also in worlds you've already started with random islands (you can untick it for a new world in World settings, 9.5). A **plan's** islands never turn up at random: they come when the plan brings them.
- A pack made with a **newer version** of the mod says so: "Install anyway" may leave out things this version doesn't know, and a quest that needs them may not be finishable. An island file of a newer *format* can't be read at all and is refused ("update the mod").
- A broken or harmful pack (too big, too many files, a file that would land outside the mod's folder, a program, not an island file) is refused with the reason, and nothing is written.
- Installing a newer version of something you installed **updates** it. Worlds you've already started get the new version when its objects keep their order (a fixed quest, new ground, objects added), as with your own saves (4.7); when objects were removed or reordered they keep the version they started with (the old file stays for them, and the install says which). If you changed one of its islands in the editor, yours is kept unless you tick **Replace files I changed**.

Installed from packs lists everything you installed, with **Remove** (click twice). Remove deletes what the entry installed but keeps anything a saved world still uses (it says which world), and never touches your own islands and plans. Under it, **Tidy up** (click twice) says what has piled up and clears it:

- copies of islands you got from multiplayer hosts (<name>_<code>) that no saved world on this PC uses - also none of Raft's older saves of a world (a host sends them again if needed);
- generated islands (gen- . . . : made while sailing, or with **Make** and never given a name) that no saved world, plan, island rule or library entry uses - moved to `Mods\DynamicIslands\deleted` , so they can be got back;
- the mod's files of worlds you deleted in Raft (only worlds you hosted: the copies of worlds you joined are kept, so you can host them later) - moved to `Mods\DynamicIslands\worlds\removed` .

An entry whose files you deleted since (in the editor, or by hand) shows as not installed again, so it can be downloaded again.



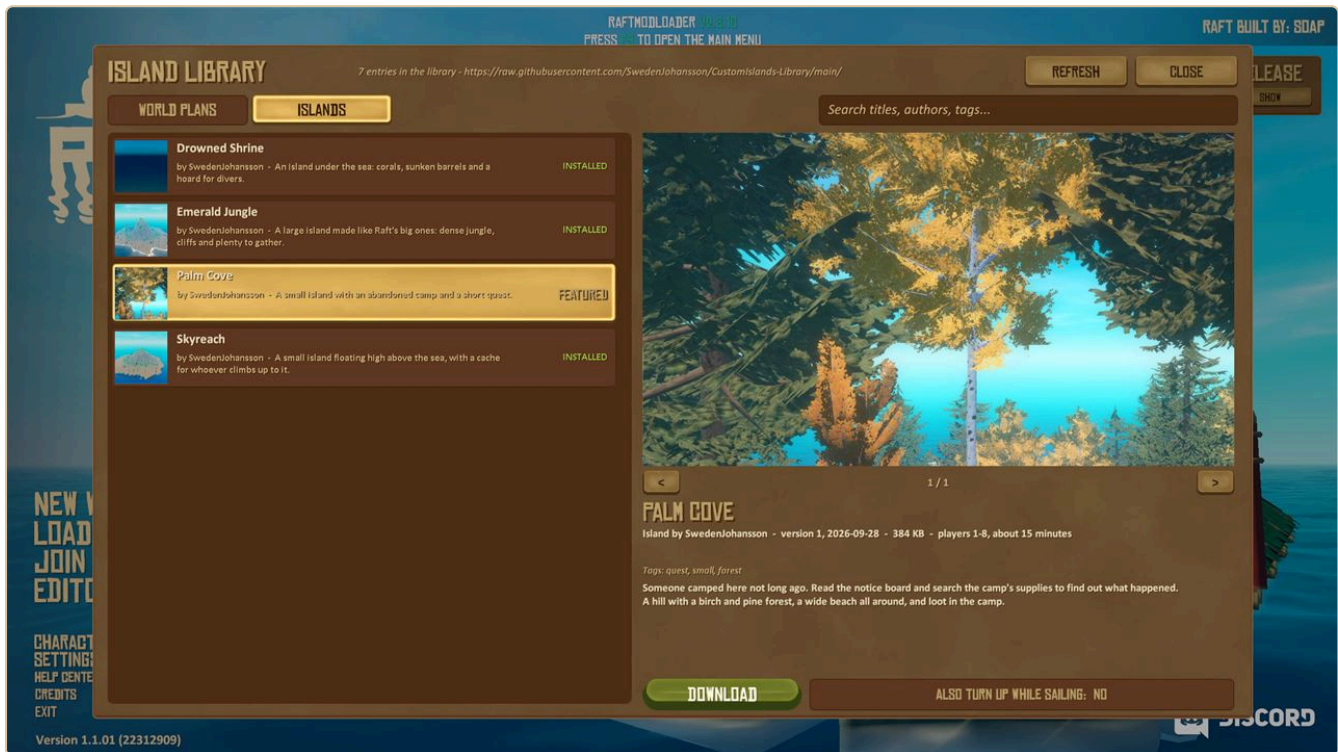
The Import window: packs in the import folder, what the picked one holds, and what's installed.

Import is offered in the island editor (the Islands and World plan windows), never inside a running world.

The island library: download plans and islands others made. ISLAND LIBRARY in Raft's main menu (also **Get more...** in the New Game box and **Library...** in the Islands window) opens the library: a public collection on GitHub ([SwedenJohansson/CustomIslands-Library](https://github.com/SwedenJohansson/CustomIslands-Library)) where every entry is looked at before it goes in.

- **World plans** and **Islands** tabs, a **search** (titles, authors, summaries, tags), featured entries first. Each row has the entry's icon, title, author and summary, and says **INSTALLED** or **UPDATE** when that applies.
- The picked entry shows its pictures (< >), description, author, version, date, size, how many islands, players and length, and one button:
 - **Download** - downloads it and installs it the same way as Import (your own files are never overwritten, a plan's islands never turn up at random, an island only if you tick **Also turn up while sailing**);

- **Update** - the library has a newer version than the one you have: installs it (worlds you've already started get it when its objects keep their order, else keep the version they started with). It replaces the entry's files, also ones you changed in the editor or World plans since: then the first click names them and **Sure? Update** goes ahead. To keep your changes, open the island (or plan) and **Save as** a new name first;
- **Installed** - you have the newest version. **Remove** (click twice) takes it away again, keeping what a saved world uses.
- An entry made with a newer version of the mod says **Download anyway**, with the warning.



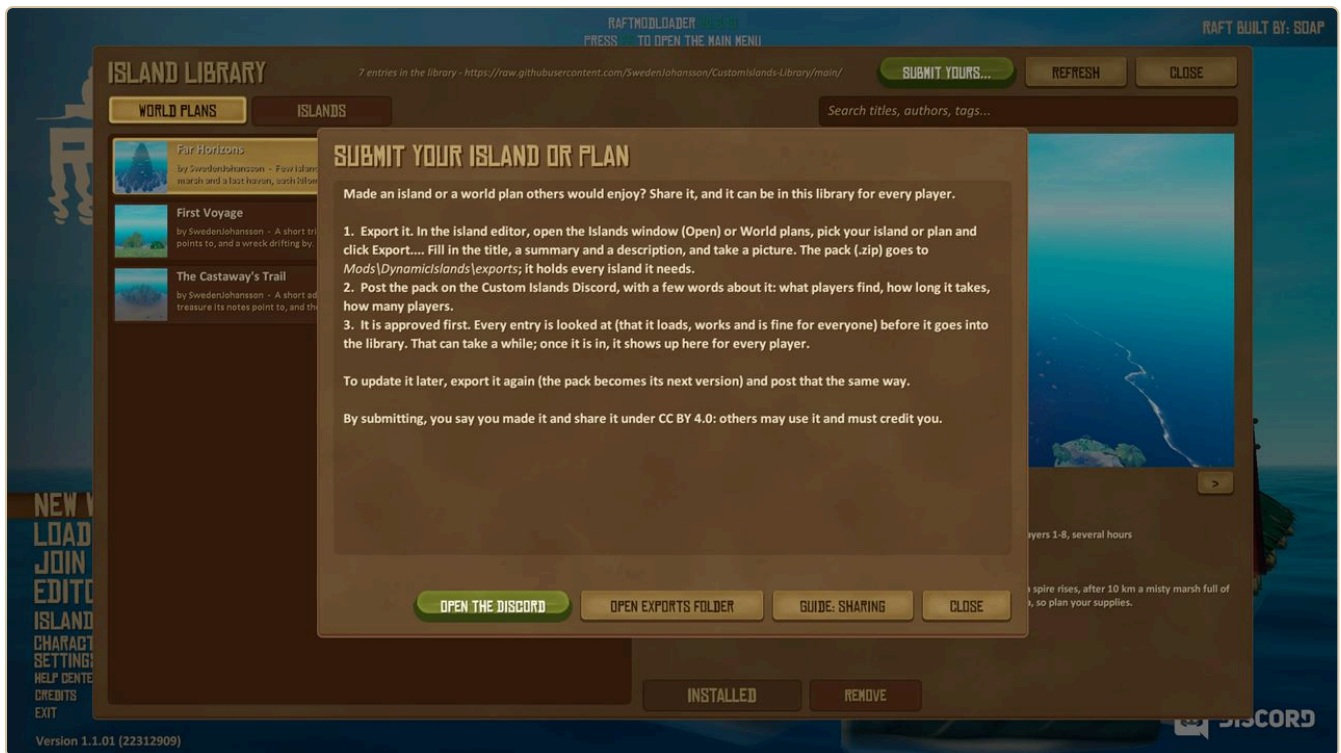
The island library: the islands tab with three installed and Palm Cove picked; its picture, description and Download.

- Every downloaded file is checked against the library's list (its size and a fingerprint); if one doesn't match, nothing is installed. A plan downloaded from the New Game box's **Get more...** is chosen there right away.
- The mod goes online only while this window is open, and sends nothing but the downloads - no account, no Steam id. Without internet it says "Can't reach the island library"; packs someone sent you still install with **Import....** `Mods\DynamicIslands\library.txt` can switch it off (`online = off`).

Sharing yours in the library: click **Submit yours...** at the top of the island library. It explains the three steps:

1. **Export** your island or plan in the editor (above), with a title, summary, description and picture;
2. **post the pack** (.zip) on the [Custom Islands Discord](#) with a few words about it;
3. it is **approved first**: every entry is looked at before it goes into the library, so it can take a while. Once it is in, every player sees it in the library.

Its buttons open the Discord, your exports folder and this section of the guide. By submitting, you say you made it and share it under CC BY 4.0 (others may use it and must credit you).



Submit yours... in the island library: export, post it on the Discord, approved first.

Or with GitHub: after an export, **Share...** in the Share window opens the library's [Submit an island or plan](#) form (a free GitHub account is needed) and the folder with your pack: drag the **.zip** in, tick the box (you made it and share it under CC BY 4.0: others may use it and must credit you), send. To update it later, export it again (it keeps its entry) and send that the same way.

4.8 Your first island, step by step

1. Main menu → **EDITOR**.
2. **Generate** → Normal tab: Style **Tropical**, click **Small island**, Nature **Like Raft** → **Generate**.
3. **Terrain** tab: raise a hill, paint a sandy path, stamp a **Lagoon**.
4. **Objects** tab: search "chest", place a **Chest**, click **Add items...** and pick some loot.
5. Place a **Sign** from "Notes & signs", click **Edit note...**, write a welcome.
6. **Island** tab: give it a name ("Skull Rock") and your name.
7. **Save** (Ctrl+S), type a name, Enter.
8. **Test** in the top bar: the island is tried in a world at once, and **Back to the editor** brings you back (4.9).
9. Main menu → **NEW WORLD** → create a world. Your island takes part in the Random islands plan, or press F10 and type `SpawnIsland <name> 250` to have it appear 250 m ahead right away.

Next: give the island a quest (6.1), then make a world plan that brings it into a world at the right moment, with other islands after it (7.2).

4.9 Trying the island in a world (Test)

Test in the editor's top bar tries the island you are making in a real world, without leaving it by hand:

1. The island is saved (it needs a name: Save as first for a new one).
2. The mod goes to the main menu and loads the world **Custom Islands test** - it makes it the first time, as a normal world with the plan **No custom islands**, so nothing else turns up.

3. Your island is put beside the raft and you stand on it. Islands tried there before are taken away first.
4. Walk around, open the chests, read the notes, meet the creatures, try the quest.
5. **Esc** → **Custom Islands** → **Back to the editor**: the test world is left **without saving** and the editor opens again with your island, where you left it.

The test world is made with your last World settings choices (monsters, randomizer, extra options...); change them there with **Esc** → **Custom Islands** if you want to try the island another way. It never counts as a saved world that uses your islands (no kept copies or warnings for it).

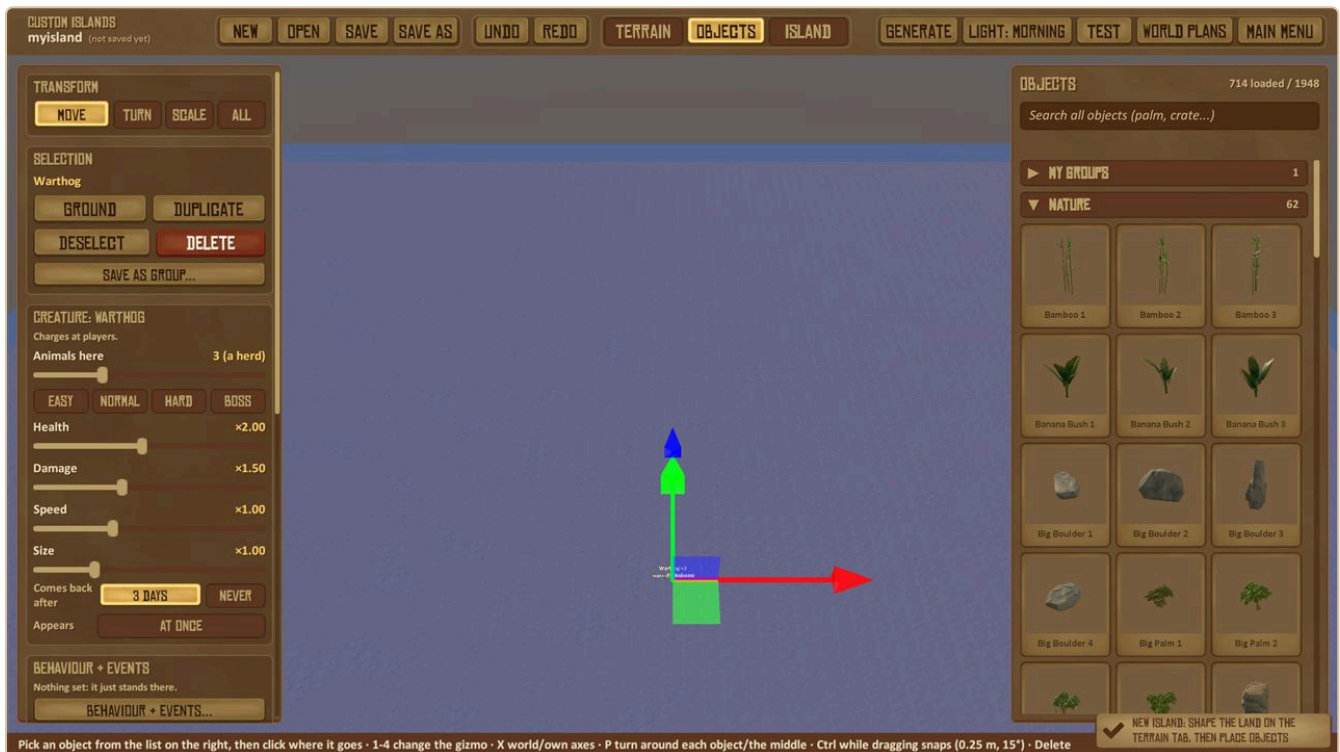
Change something, **Test** again. The test world is a world like any other in Raft's Load Game list: you can load it yourself too, and delete it from there when you no longer want it. (Trying an island in one of your own worlds is still possible with F10 → `SpawnIsland <name> 250.`)

5. Making islands come alive

Select an object to see its **inspector** in the tool panel. Everything here can be undone.

5.1 Creatures

Open **Animals: hostile**, **Animals: catchable** or **Sea creatures** in the browser and place an animal: warthog, pig, bear, polar bear, hyena, rats, roach, bee swarm, screecher; chicken, goat, llama; puffer fish, angler fish, turtle, stingray, dolphin, whale.



A warthog spot: a herd of 3, health $\times 2$, damage $\times 1.5$, comes back after 3 days, appears at once.

- **Animals here:** 1 to 8 (a herd).
- **Easy / Normal / Hard / Boss**, or set **health**, **damage**, **speed** and **size** yourself.
- **Comes back after** the regrow days, or **Never**.
- **Appears** at once, or **when a zone fires** (an ambush, see 5.4).
- **Colour** (every object): a swatch, the strength, or your own mix.

Angler fish swim rounds around their spot, through the open water near it (in Raft they follow a route of their island's; here the mod lays one out in a ring around the spot, clear of the ground and of objects). Give them room: a spot a few metres from walls and the sea floor, in water deeper than they are long.

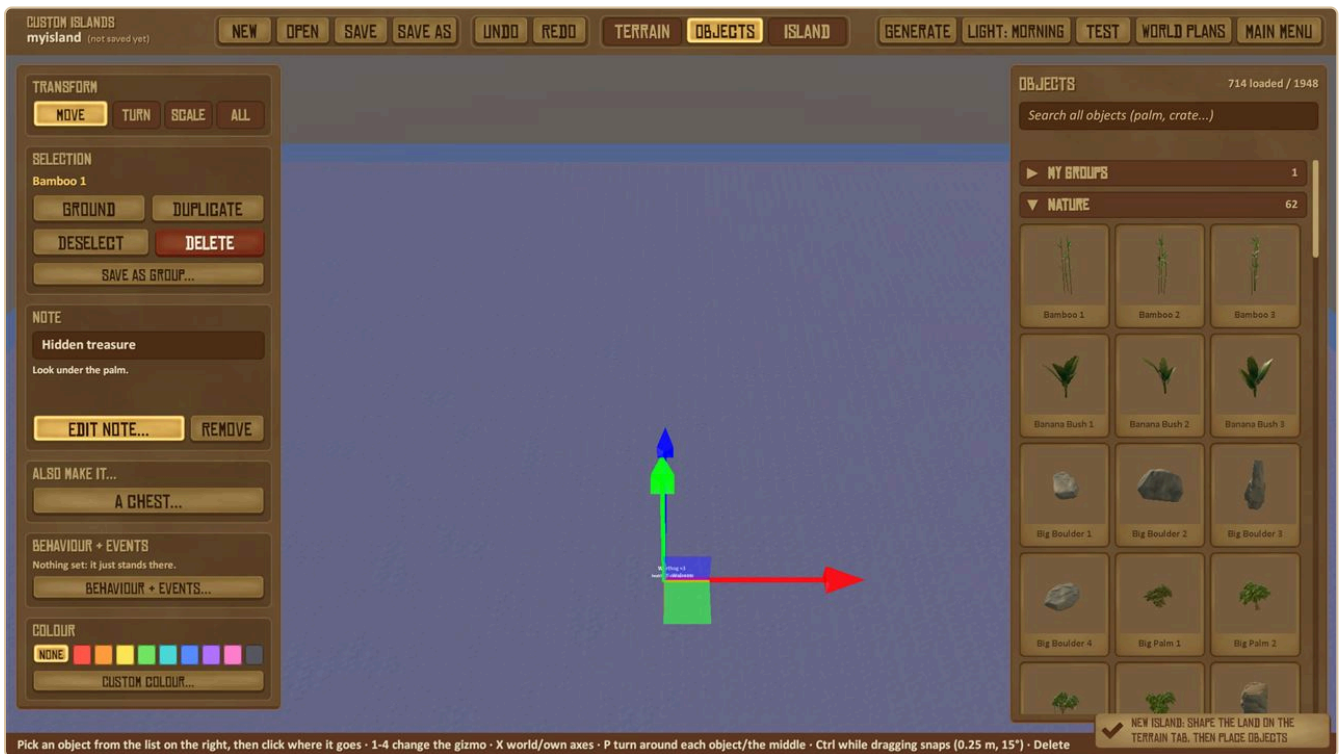
In the editor a creature is a coloured marker with its name, or Raft's real model once you have been in a world since starting Raft:



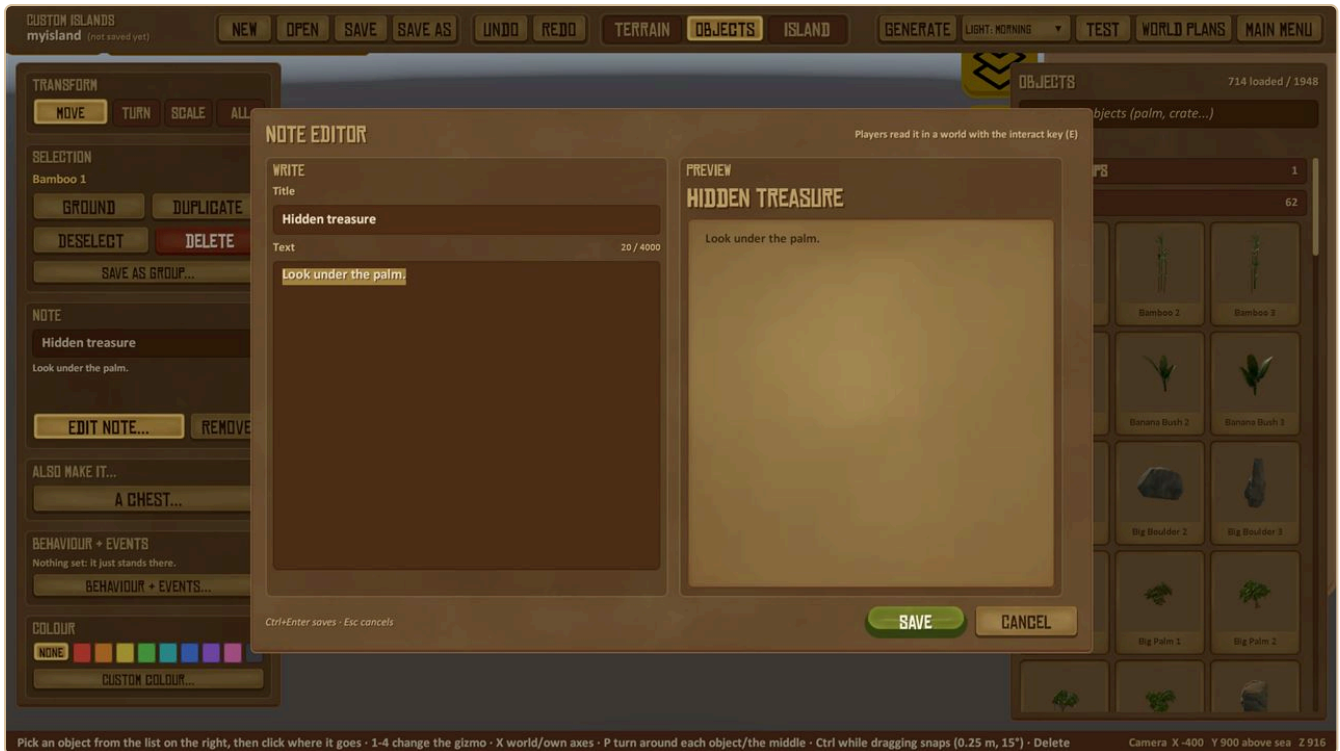
Creature spots with Raft's own models: a warthog, a llama, a bear, a chicken.

5.2 Notes and signs

"Notes & signs" has a paper, a bundle of papers, an open book, a sign, a notice board and a message in a bottle, and **any object can be made readable (Add a note to it...)**. A sign shows its note's title on its board.



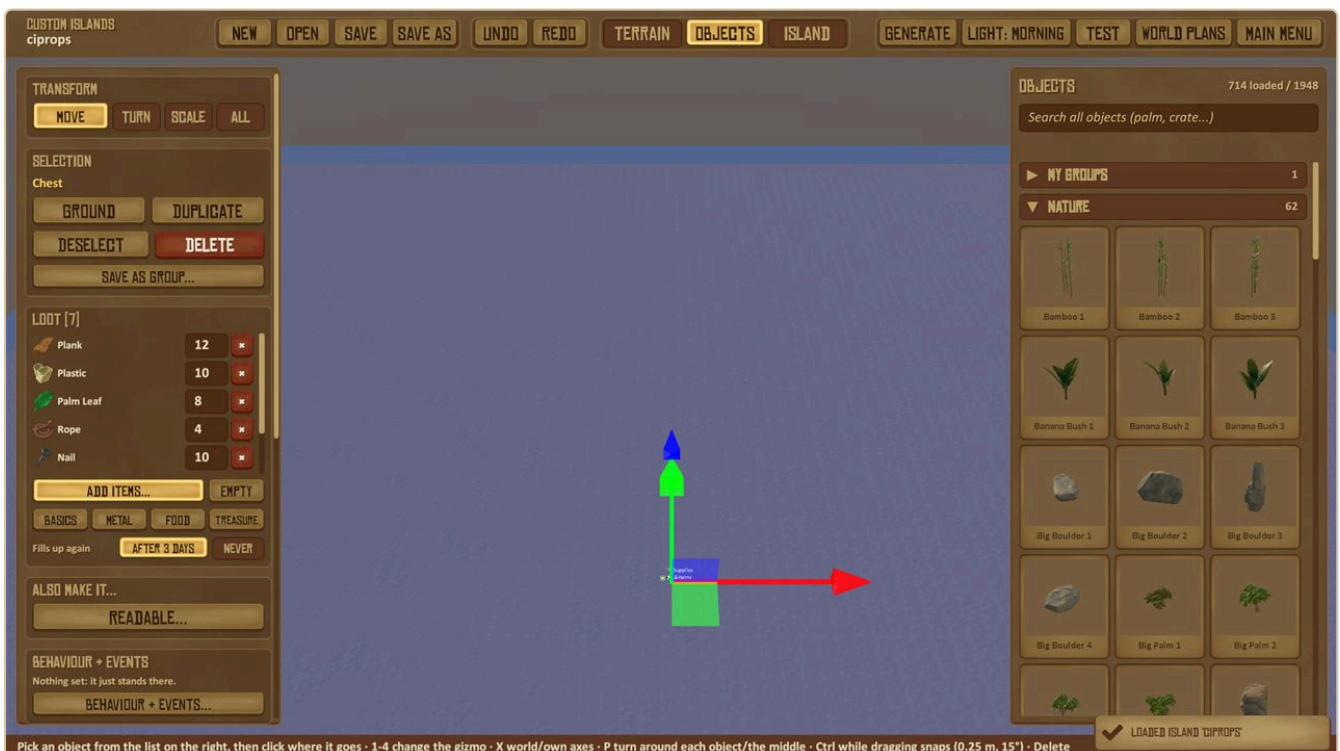
An object with a note: its title "Hidden treasure" and the start of the text.



The note editor: the title, the text (Enter starts a new line), and a preview of the paper players will see.

5.3 Chests and loot

"Loot & chests" has chests, a crate, a wooden box and barrels, and **any object can hold loot (A chest...)**. **Fills up again** sets whether a looted chest is full again after the island's regrow days or never. A chest that holds a **story item** never fills up again, whatever is chosen (the story's key or log comes once - the panel says so).



A chest's loot: planks, plastic, palm leaves, rope and nails. The Basics, Metal, Food and Treasure sets fill it quickly; it fills up again after 3 days, or never.

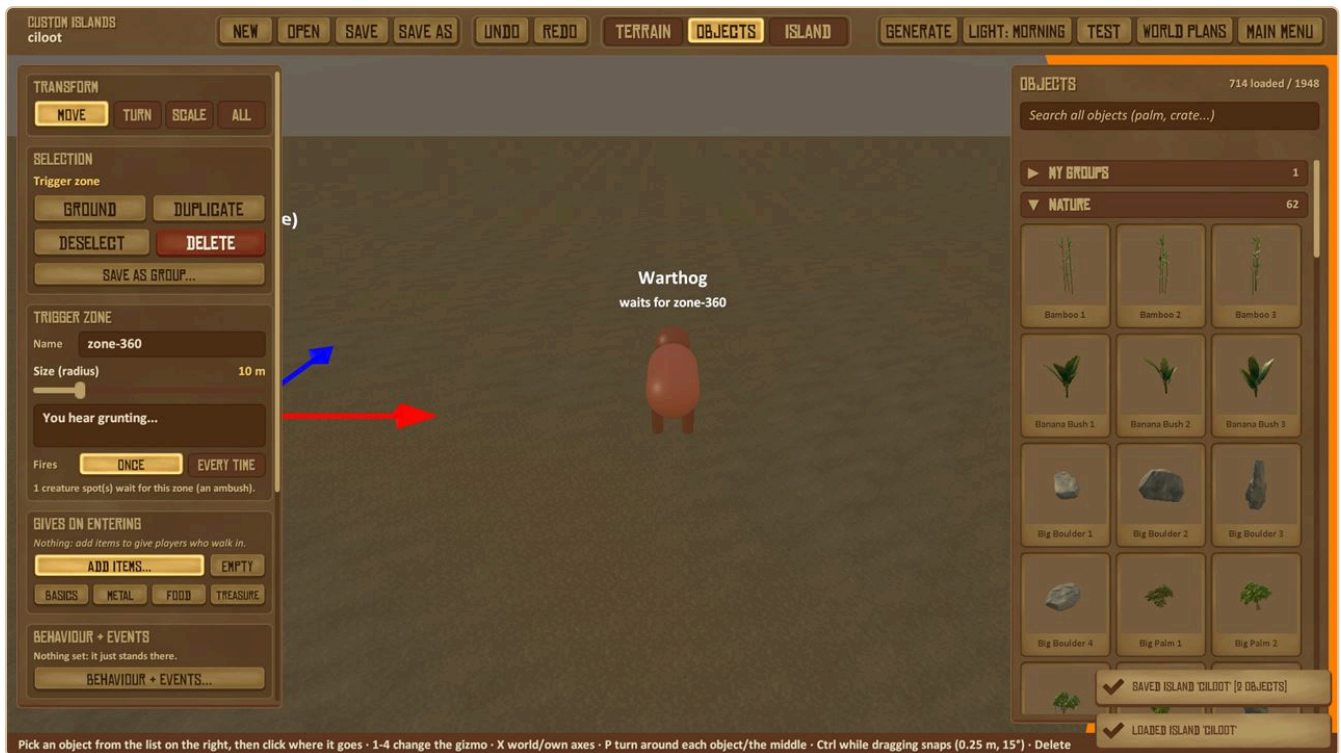


Add items...: every item of Raft with its picture and a search. Click an item to add one, again to add more.

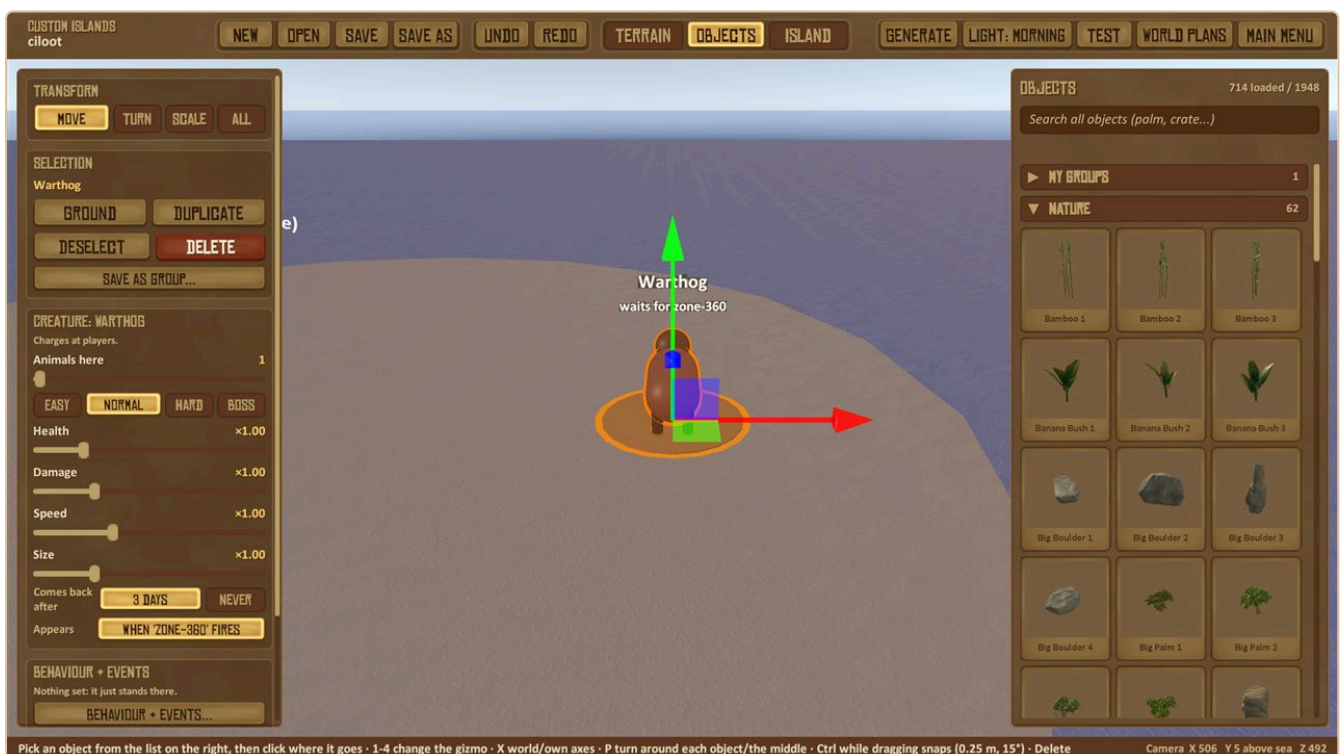
The abandoned raft crate. "Loot & chests" also has Raft's own **Abandoned raft crate**: the box you grab on the small abandoned rafts that drift by in Raft. In a world it works as there: a player takes it whole (look at it, **E**) and gets a handful of random items from Raft's own loot for those rafts - now and then a cooking recipe or a mystery package. Its contents **can't be chosen** (use a chest for chosen loot), and it **doesn't count for a quest's "Open a chest" step** - the editor says so too, in the object list's hint and on the crate's own panel when you select it, and Check tells you when a quest needs a chest and the island only has raft crates. Once taken it stays gone, and comes back after the island's regrow days like harvested things (4.4; 0 = never).

5.4 Trigger zones and ambushes

A **trigger zone** ("Zones & triggers") is an invisible sphere. When a player walks in it shows your **message**, **gives items**, and wakes the creatures that wait for it. **Fires: Once** (for the first player - and ready again after the island's regrow days, like loot), **Once ever** (never again in that world: for the story - an ambush, a bridge shown) or **Every time** (each time a player walks in, at most every half minute).



A trigger zone (the orange sphere): its name, size 10 m, the message "You hear grunting...", fires once, and one creature spot waits for it.



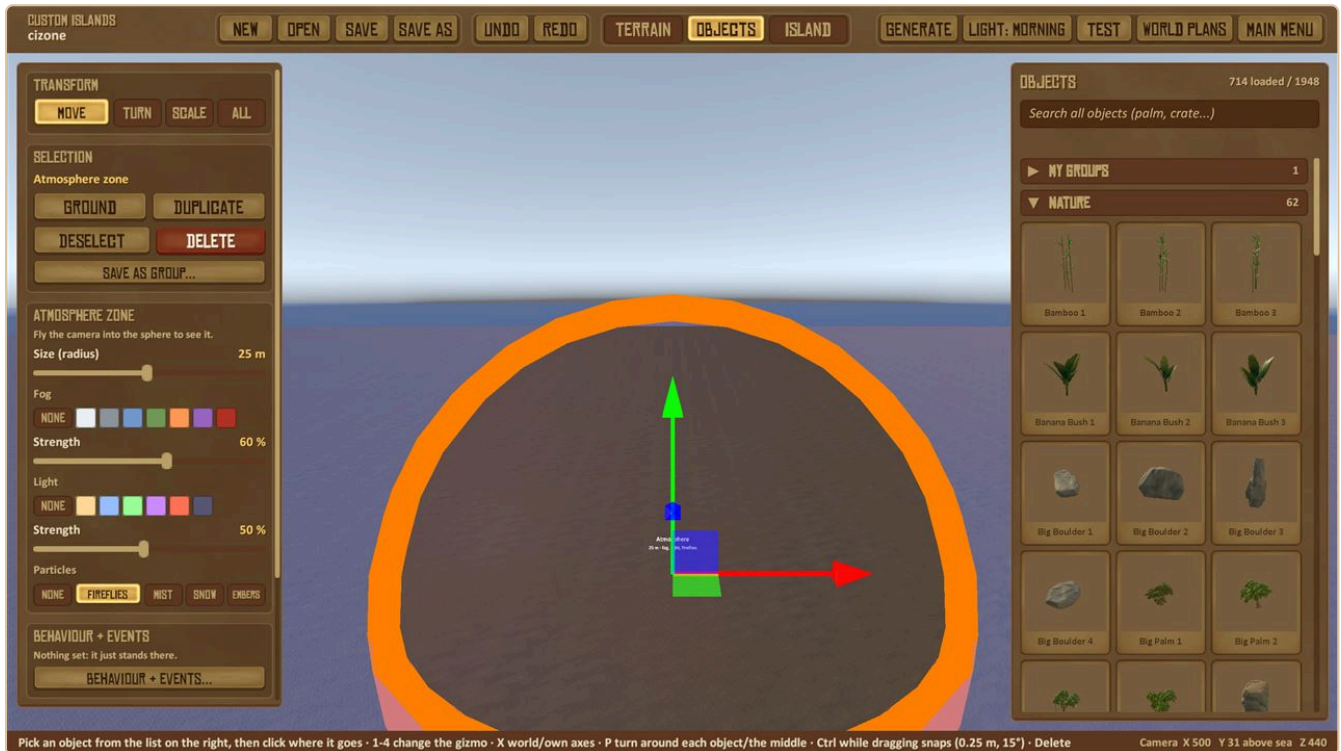
The warthog's **Appears** is set to "when zone-158 fires": its name tag says it waits. It appears the moment a player walks into the zone.

Air pockets. A trigger zone's **Air** row makes it an **air pocket**: a player inside it breathes - their breath is full again - as in Raft's air pockets under Caravan Town. Raft's own air-pocket objects (the shack, the gas tank and the container in Caravan Town's list) come without their air, so put an air-pocket zone on each, about as big as the object. A zone **hidden** by a behaviour gives no air until it is shown: *The Abyss* in the library keeps its three pockets empty until the air line's valve is opened (the valve's action shows them, with bubbles - 5.5).

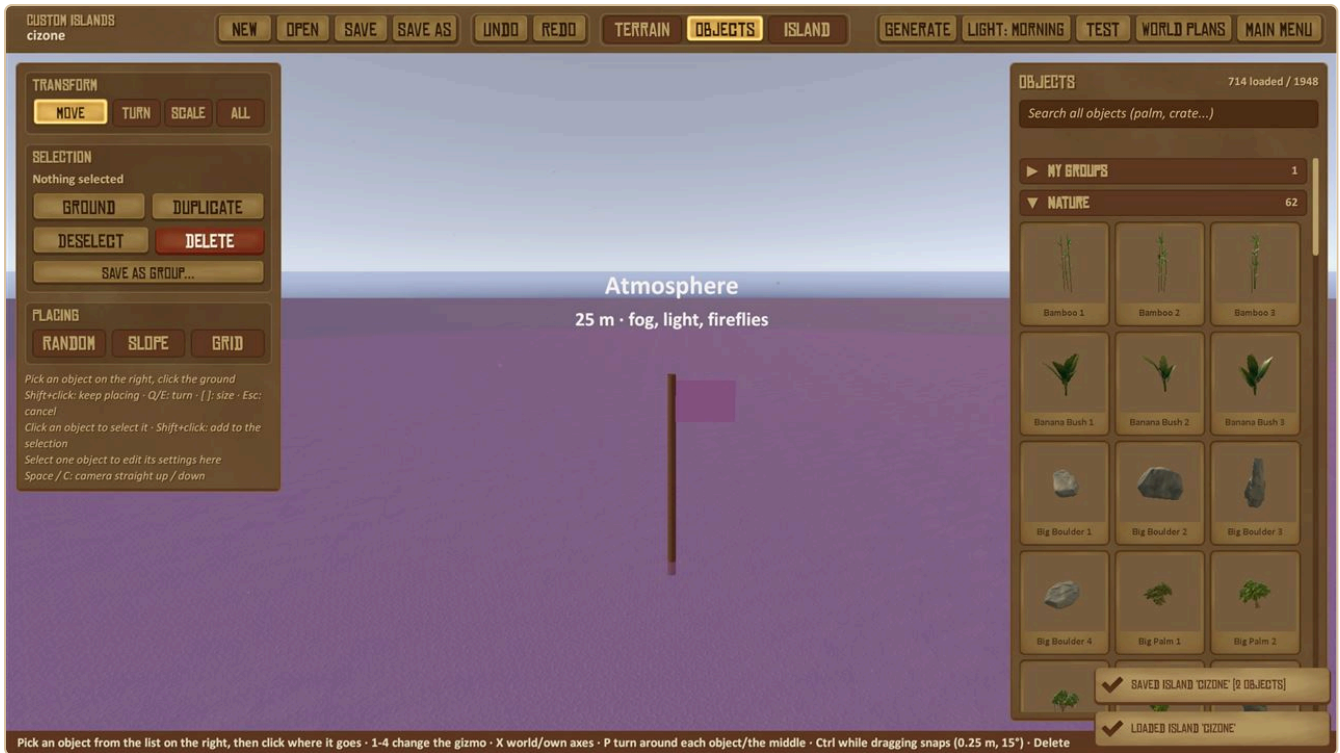
Invisible walls and ramps (also in "Zones & triggers") are solid in the world but not seen: block a path, fence an arena, or make a cliff climbable.

5.5 Atmosphere and sound

An **atmosphere zone** changes the fog colour, the light and adds particles (fireflies, mist, snow, embers, bubbles) around a spot; a **sound zone** plays one of Raft's 500+ sounds while a player is inside, or once on entering. **Bubbles** rise from the zone's middle in a column, about 14 m high - under water, for an air pocket filling or a vent; give the zone only bubbles (no fog or light) and it changes nothing else. A **dark light tint** makes the inside really dark: Raft's sun, the sky's light and its reflections all take the tint while you are in the zone - for a cave, a mine or a buried room (Old Mine Islet and Shelter Atoll in the library).



An atmosphere zone: its size, fog colour and strength, light tint and strength, and particles (fireflies).



Fly the camera into the zone to see it: purple fog and fireflies.



Choose sound...: Raft's sounds with a search. ► listens, Use picks it.

6. Stories: quests, behaviours, story items

6.1 Quests

Island tab → **Edit quest...**: a title, an introduction (shown when players arrive), up to 10 steps in order, a reward and a closing message.



The quest "The lost camp": go to the camp, read the diary, open the supplies, chase off 2 warthogs. The reward is planks and rope, and when the quest is done it brings a saved island "Old camp" 700 m north, with a message and a name on the Receiver.

Steps: **go to** a trigger zone, **read** a note, **open** a chest (one of the mod's chests - Raft's abandoned raft crate doesn't count), **defeat** or **catch** a number of animals, **collect** a number of a story item, **find** journal pages. Each step's kind is a ▼ **list** (each kind says what it asks). Steps point at things on the island by name: the small ▼ beside the name lists the names this island has for that kind - its trigger zones, note titles, chest titles or creatures - so you can pick one instead of typing it (place the zones, notes, chests and creatures first). **When the quest is done, bring a new island** chooses from a list too (nothing, a saved island, a new island of a map type), and so does its direction.

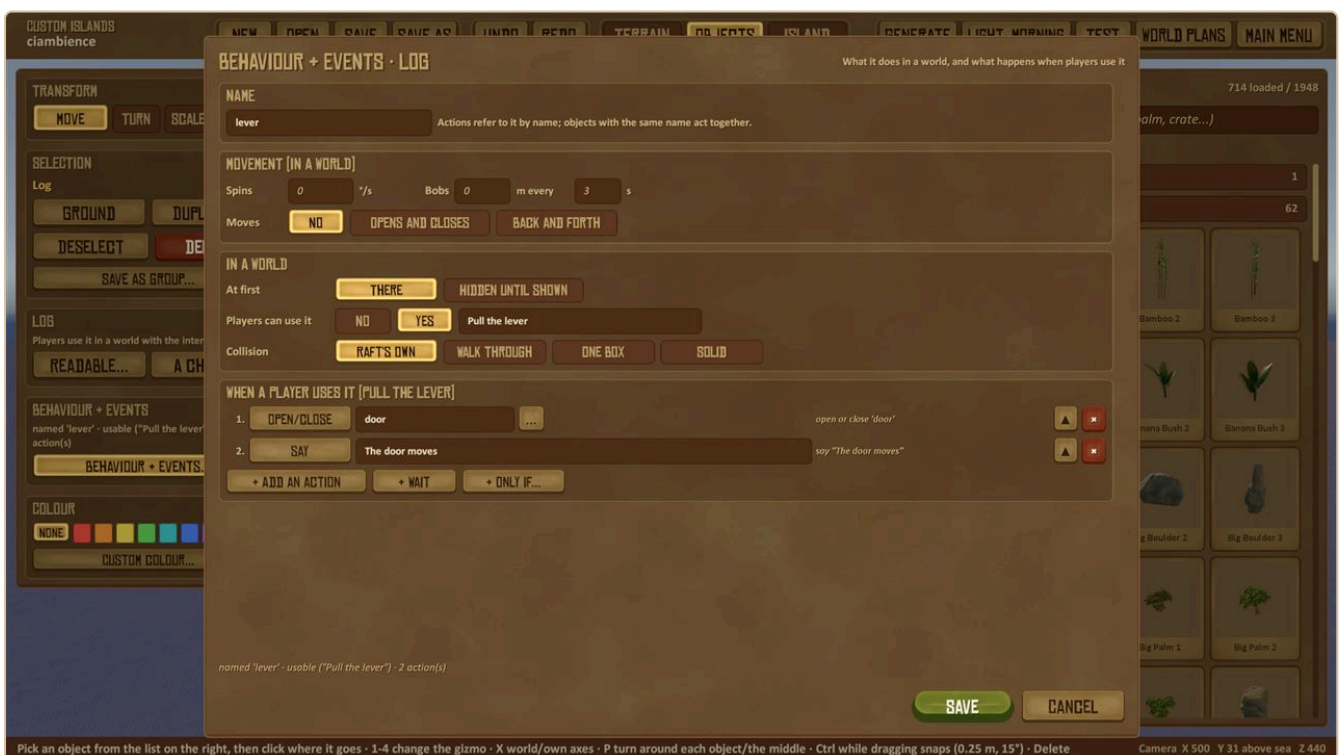
Steps done in another order count too: a chest opened or animals defeated before their step has come are remembered, and count the moment their step comes - the guide's camp quest done backwards (warthogs, supplies, then the diary) finishes when the diary is read. To keep the story in order anyway, hide a later step's chest or animals until the step before shows them (**Behaviour + events...** > **At first: Hidden until shown**, and a **show** action).

Collect and find-pages steps count what the whole crew holds, and finish while a player is at the island - so the reward reaches someone. **Traps to avoid** when you make a quest (toggles in events that happen again, keys, rewards): [12.4 Making quests and plans that work](#).

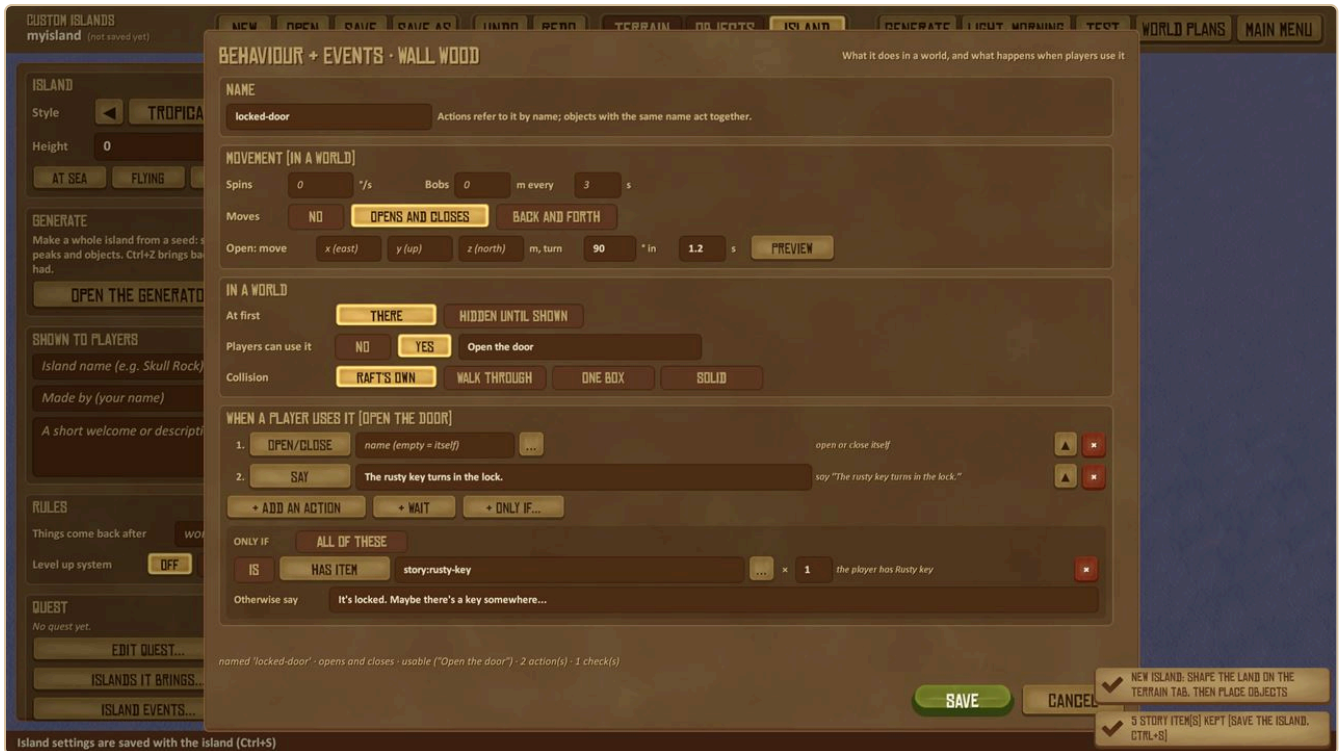
6.2 Behaviour and events

Select any object → **Behaviour + events....** No code needed:

- **A name** that actions refer to (objects with the same name act together).
- **Movement:** spin, bob, move back and forth, or **open and close** like a door, gate, bridge or lift (with a Preview in the editor). A spin turns around the vertical, or with **Own axis** around the object's own up axis: tilt it first - a water wheel, a windmill's blades, a fan (Tide Farm's wheel in the library).
- **At first:** there, or **hidden until shown** (a hidden creature spot is an ambush).
- **Players can use it:** Raft's "press E" hint with your own text ("Pull the lever").
- **Collision:** Raft's own, walk through, one box, or solid.
- **When ... then:** when a player uses it, walks into a zone, reads a note, opens a chest, or all the animals of a spot are defeated → show / hide objects, open / close doors, say a message, give items, play a sound, teleport the player, send a signal, write a journal page, or **wait** some seconds first. Each action is chosen from a ▼ **list** that says what it does; ... beside a name lists the names on this island. A note's "read" and the island's "first come" happen **once per world:** whoever reads the note again (anyone) gets its messages and sounds, not its items or teleports again. After a **wait**, what changes the island (show, open, a signal, a journal page) happens even when the crew sails away or the host saves and quits meanwhile: it happens when the island loads again. What is for the player (a message, items, a teleport) is left out for a player who died or left the island meanwhile.
- **Only if ...:** the player **has** an item or story item (or **uses one up**, like a key), an object is open, closed, shown or hidden, a signal was sent, the quest reached a step (a ▼ list too). Turn a check round with **not**; ask for **all** or **any** of them. **Otherwise** say a message.



A log named "lever" that players can use ("Pull the lever"): it opens or closes the door and says "The door moves".



A door that opens only if the player has the story item "rusty key"; otherwise it says "It's locked. Maybe there's a key somewhere..."

Island events (Island tab): actions for when players first come to the island and when its quest is done.



Island events: what happens when players first come to the island, and when its quest is done.

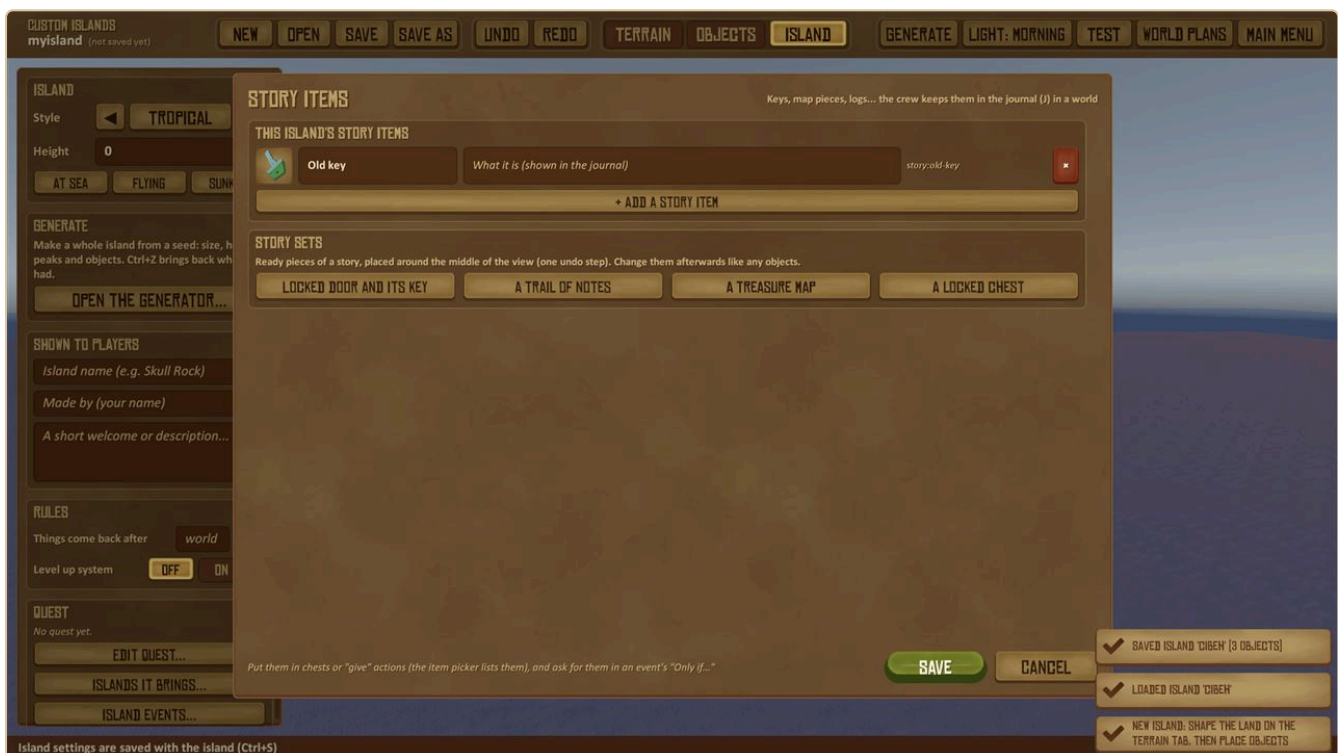
6.3 Story items and story sets

Island tab → Story items...: keys, map pieces, logs... with a name, a description and a picture (Raft's quest item pictures or any Raft item). Chests, zones, quest rewards and "give" actions hand them out; "only if" checks ask for them; players find them in the journal (J).

What ends up in the players' journal (3), so you can plan a story with it:

- Every note with text becomes a page the first time someone reads it, titled with the note's title (give notes clear titles: the page list shows them). A note with no text adds no page.
- An event's **write a journal page** adds a page with your title and text (once per world) - a clue, a diary entry, what the crew learned.
- Story items show with their picture, name and description; when a check **uses one up**, it leaves the journal.
- A quest step **Find a story item** or **Find pages** counts what the journal holds, also what was found before the quest.

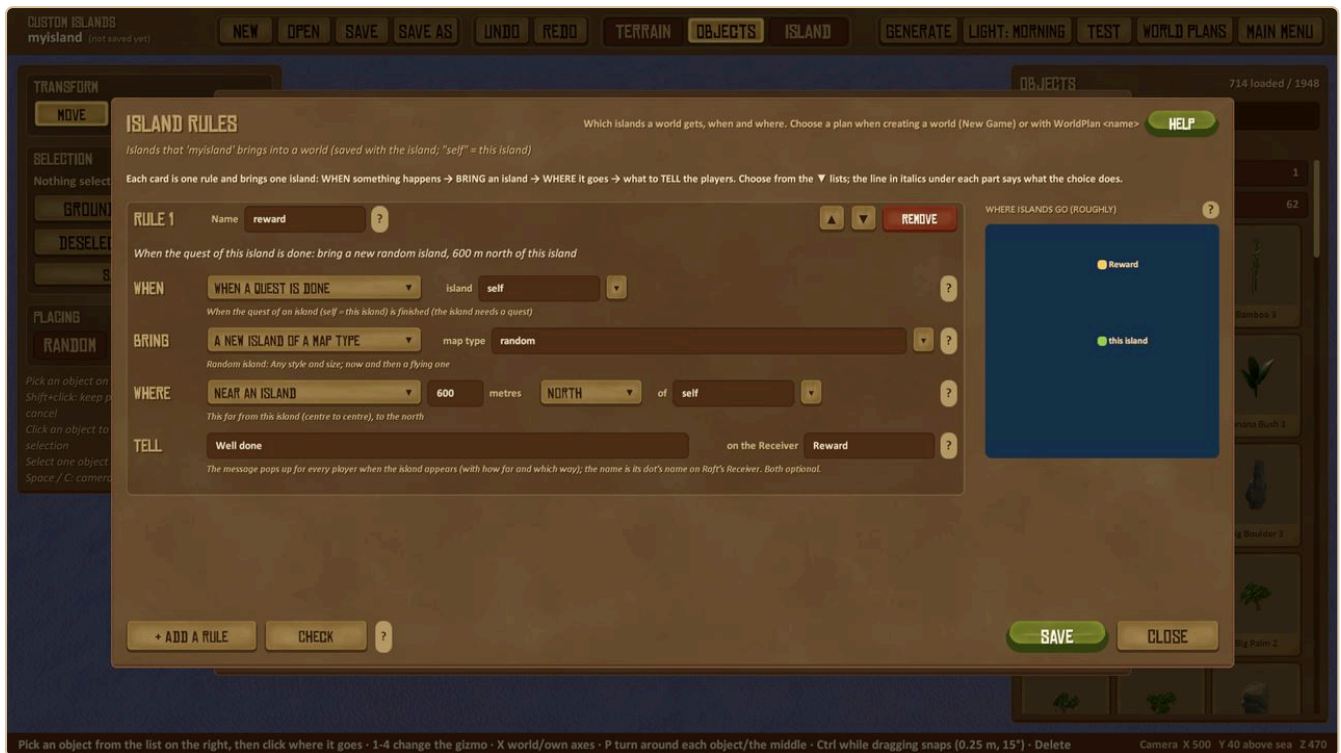
Story sets place a ready piece of a story in one step: **a locked door and its key** (in a chest with a note), **a trail of notes** leading to a hidden chest, **a treasure map** (a bottle gives the map; the X digs up a chest only for someone who has it), or **a locked chest** whose key is hidden in driftwood nearby.



The Story items window: the island's story items ("Old key") and the four story sets.

6.4 Islands that bring islands

Island tab → **Islands it brings...** gives the island its own rules: "when my quest is done", "when step 2 is done", "when zone X fires" or "when players first get here" → bring a saved island or a new island of a map type, how far and which way, with a message and a name on the Receiver. The cards work like a world plan's rules (7.3), but they travel with the island: a chain of shared island files is a story on its own, in any world where the first island turns up. A world plan is the better choice when you want to decide the whole world's story in one place.



An island rule: when this island's quest is done, bring a new island of a random type 600 m north, with the message "Well done" and the name "Reward" on the Receiver. The map on the right sketches where islands go.

6.5 Your islands in Raft's story (the Receiver)

Raft's own story is a chain. A note on each story island gives the **frequency** of the next one, and players find it by tuning the **Receiver** to it: Radio Tower, Vasagatan, Balboa, Caravan Town, Tangaroa, Varuna Point, Temperance and, last, Utopia, the ending. A world plan ([section 7](#)) can change that chain, in the editor's **World plans** window:

- **Raft's story islands: on/off.** On (the default) keeps Raft's story. **Off** leaves all of Raft's story islands out: the plan's own islands are the whole adventure. Raft's ordinary islands still turn up as in any world.
- **Leave out one story island:** click its name in the row next to the switch (it goes dark). The note before it then leads to the one after it. For example, without Balboa, Vasagatan's note gives Caravan Town's frequency.
- **Put your island into the story:** on a rule's card, the **STORY** list chooses its place:
 - **First:** before everything, unlocked from the start of the world;
 - **After** one of Raft's story islands, or after another of your islands in the story;
 - **In place of** a story island: that island is left out and yours takes its place. Its note leads to your island, and your island leads on to the one after.
- **Done when:** when your island counts as done, so the next step is unlocked:
 - by default, when its quest is done, or when players reach it if it has no quest;
 - or when players reach it, when N steps of its quest are done, when one of its zones fires, or when it sends a signal.
- **Where it appears, for any rule:**
 - **on the Receiver:** it gets its own 4-digit frequency, made for each world. When it is unlocked, every player sees a banner "Tune the Receiver to #4821", the journal gets a page, and the number on the note before it shows it. **Any player** can dial it on the Receiver; the island then comes up ahead of the raft, like Raft's story islands;

- **by chance while sailing:** it comes up ahead some time after it is unlocked;
- **ahead of the raft** or **near an island**, as soon as it is unlocked.



Check on the template "Balboa replaced" (a new forest island in Balboa's place): every rule can work, and two tips - the story in order (Radio Tower > Vasagatan > 'forest' > Caravan Town > ... > Utopia) and the blueprints Balboa held.

- A rule's own **when** still counts. A story island "after Vasagatan" with "after sailing 3 km" is unlocked by Vasagatan's note, but comes only once the raft has also sailed 3 km.

When one of your islands unlocks one of Raft's story islands, no note of Raft's told the players, so a banner does: "The Receiver picks up a new frequency: #1234", and the journal keeps it as a page ("A new signal").

Check shows the chain the plan makes (for example "Radio Tower > Vasagatan > 'forest' > Caravan Town > ..."), and gives tips. They are only recommendations; you can do what you want:

- Raft's story starts at the Radio Tower;
- Utopia is Raft's ending, so without it last the story has no ending;
- a left-out island may hold blueprints the story needs. Without Balboa there is no machete, fuel tank, fuel pipes or biofuel extractor, so put them in a chest or a quest reward of your own.

Templates... has three to start from:

- **Receiver adventure:** Raft's story off, four islands each found with the Receiver, each quest giving the next frequency;
- **Detour in Raft's story:** one of your islands after Vasagatan;
- **Balboa replaced:** an island in Balboa's place.

In a world, **StoryChain** (F10) shows the chain and where it stands. The chain belongs to the world: it is saved with it, the same for every player, and it comes along when another player hosts the world. If you edit your plan's story later (its islands, Raft's story on or off, the islands left out), the changed chain plays the next time the world loads, like any change to your plan (section 7): what is unlocked and done stays, and your Receiver islands keep their frequencies.

Raft's notebook and the journal in each kind of plan

The short answer:

- **Raft's notebook (T) never shows custom content.** It only ever holds Raft's own story: the notes found on Raft's story islands and Raft's quest items. A custom island's notes, story items, quests and pages never go into it - not even when your island takes a story island's place. The plan changes only two things there: **which of Raft's frequencies get unlocked**, and **the number written on a Raft note** - a note shows the frequency of what comes next in *this world's* chain (your island's, when it is on the Receiver, or "#----" when what comes next isn't found with the Receiver).
- **The journal (J) is only for custom content** - but not only for quests. It collects from every custom island, with or without a quest: notes read, pages events write, story items, and the frequencies the plan gives out. It never holds Raft's notes or quest items. Of quests it shows only how many of the custom islands' are done, and their list: a quest's steps show in the **quest panel** while you are at its island (3), the same in every kind of plan.
- **Custom islands outside the story** (by chance, or brought by an ordinary rule) work the same in every case below: their quest in the quest panel, their notes and story items in the journal.

Case by case. "Your islands in the story" means rules with a place in the **STORY** list (first, after, in place of); islands with quests that a plan brings in other ways count as "outside the story" above.

The plan keeps...	Without your islands in the story	With your islands in the story
All of Raft's story (on, nothing left out)	Notebook: exactly as in Raft without the mod. Journal: only what custom islands you meet give (empty if none have notes or story items)	Notebook: Raft's notes and quest items as usual, but the note before your island shows <i>your island's</i> number instead of the next Raft island's. Journal: your island's frequency (a page, with the banner), its notes and story items. When your island is done, the next Raft island's number comes as a banner and a journal page ("A new signal") - no Raft note gives it any more
Some of it (islands left out or replaced)	Notebook: the note before a left-out island shows the number of the one after it; a left-out island's notes and quest items never come (the island never does). Journal: nothing about the left-out islands	As in the row above, and an island in place of a story island takes that island's spot: the note before it shows your island's number, and after it the story goes on to the next Raft island (a banner and a journal page give its number)
None of it (Raft's story off)	Notebook: none of Raft's story notes, quest items or story frequencies - the Receiver finds nothing of Raft's. Journal: only what custom islands you meet give	Notebook: as on the left - it stays out of the adventure. Journal: the whole adventure is followed here: each Receiver island's frequency as it is unlocked, the notes and story items of your islands; each island's quest in the quest panel. The first island of the chain is unlocked from the start

The world option **Story islands in a new order** (9.4) works the same way for the notebook: the numbers on Raft's notes follow the world's order.

7. World plans: which islands a world gets

A **world plan** decides which custom islands a world gets, **when** they come and **where**. Without a plan, islands only turn up by chance while you sail. With a plan, you can tell a story: *"When the world starts, put an old camp ahead of the raft. When its quest is done, bring my island Skull Rock 800 m to the north-east. When players reach Skull Rock, bring a treasure island near it."*

A plan is a list of **rules**, and each rule brings **one island**. Every rule answers four questions:

Question	For example
When does the island come?	the world starts, after sailing 3 km, on day 5, when an island's quest is done, when players reach an island
What island?	one of your saved islands, a new island of a map type (a camp, a volcano, a wreck...), one from the spawn pool, one of a list
Where does it go?	ahead of the raft, near another island (how far and which way), on its own Receiver frequency, by chance while sailing
What are players told?	a message on screen ("Smoke rises from a small island ahead.") and a name on the Receiver

You make and change plans in the island editor's **World plans** window, and pick one for a world in Raft's **New Game** box. You don't need to have built any islands yourself: the mod's map types (4.6) are enough for a whole plan.

Before you share a plan or change one that running worlds use, see 12.4.

The three kinds of islands you meet at sea

Every custom island that turns up in a world came there in one of **three ways**. When you stand on them they are all the same - land, objects, maybe a quest - but they are set up in different places, they come at different times, they behave differently if you sail past them, and only one kind is part of a story. This part explains all three, with The Long Voyage (a plan of the island library, 16.4) as the example, because it has all three at once.

The short version:

- **Random islands** come **by chance** while you sail. Nobody planned them: which island, where and when is rolled as you go. A world gets them when its plan has **Random islands while sailing: on** (the plan called *Random islands*, the default, has nothing else).
- **Side trips** are islands a **plan** brings at a **set point of the voyage** - "after sailing 4 km, 450 m ahead of the raft" - with a message on screen. Every world of that plan gets the same island at the same point. They are extras: nothing else in the plan waits for them. In The Long Voyage: **The Stranded Gull** after 2 km, **Signal Rock** after 4 km (its quest is called "**Dead Air**"), Ranger's Rest after 7 km, and so on.
- **Main quest islands** are islands a plan puts **into a story chain** - here into Raft's own story, each found with the **Receiver** on its own frequency - and the story only goes on when their quest is done. In The Long Voyage: **Wreckers' Cove** after Raft's Radio Tower, **Thornwood** after Vasagatan, and five more.

A **quest** belongs to an island, not to the way it came. "Dead Air" is the quest of the island Signal Rock; Signal Rock would bring its quest along as a random island too. So "a quest island" can be any of the three kinds: what makes an island a *main* quest island is that a plan's story waits for its quest.

The three kinds side by side

	Random islands	Side trips	Main quest islands
What it is	An island picked by chance from the spawn pool : one of your saved islands, a brand-new generated island, or a new island of a map type (a sandbar, a wreck, an atoll...)	An island a plan rule brings at a set point: after a distance sailed, on a day, when the world starts	An island a plan rule puts into a story chain : after one of Raft's story islands (or in place of one, or first)
Example in The Long Voyage	Any island of your pool, a generated jungle island...	The Stranded Gull (2 km), Signal Rock - quest "Dead Air" (4 km), Ranger's Rest (7 km), Stilt Hollow (10 km)...	Wreckers' Cove (after the Radio Tower), Thornwood (after Vasagatan), Scrapyard Haven (after Balboa)...
When it comes	Any time while the raft sails: each km sailed has a 25 % chance (about one island every 4 km), never while the raft is at one of Raft's islands	When the rule's WHEN happens. The Long Voyage's side trips: when the raft has sailed that many km in this world (counted from the world's start)	When it is unlocked - the story island before it is done (for Raft's islands: when you read the note there that would give the next frequency) - and a player tunes the Receiver to its frequency
Where it appears	250-350 m ahead of the raft, a little to one side (10-35 degrees), at least 800 m from other custom islands	Where the rule's WHERE says. The Long Voyage's side trips: 450 m ahead of the raft	The rule's metres ahead of the raft when a player tunes the Receiver to it (700-1000 m in The Long Voyage), like Raft's own story islands
What tells you	Nothing when it appears: you see it. Near it, its banner with its name	The rule's message on every player's screen as it appears, with how far and which way ("A mast on a rock ahead - its light is dead."), and its name on its Receiver dot	When it is unlocked: a banner with the rule's message and "Tune the Receiver to #4821", a page in the journal (J), and that number on Raft's note. On the Receiver: its name and frequency
The same in every world?	No: different islands at different places every time	Yes: the same island at the same distance in every world of the plan (only the exact spot ahead depends on where you sail)	Yes: the same island at the same place in the story. Only the 4-digit frequency is made new for each world

	Random islands	Side trips	Main quest islands
Needed to finish the plan?	No	No: optional extras. Skip them and nothing is missing from the story	Yes (in a plan with a story): its quest done unlocks the next step of the story - in The Long Voyage, the next story island's frequency
If you sail past it	It stays where it appeared. Beyond 800 m it is unloaded and comes back when you return. If you reached it and its quest isn't done , it comes back ahead of the raft by itself about 12 minutes later (up to 3 times)	The same as a random island: stays where it appeared; if you reached it and left its quest unfinished, it comes back ahead of the raft about 12 minutes later (up to 3 times). One you never reached doesn't come back	It stays where it came up: its dot on the Receiver shows the way back. It doesn't come back by itself
Where you set it	The plan's switch Random islands while sailing (World plans window); <i>which</i> islands: World settings > Islands while sailing (9.5) and <code>spawnpool.txt</code> (10)	A rule in the World plans window: WHEN After sailing a distance , BRING One of my saved islands , WHERE Ahead of the raft , TELL a message and a Receiver name, STORY not in Raft's story	A rule in the World plans window: WHEN When the world starts , BRING One of my saved islands , WHERE On the Receiver , STORY After a story island, Done when its quest is done
In the plan file (7.7)	<code>random = on</code>	<code>rule = signal island:Signal Rock km:4 ahead:450 A mast on a rock ahead - its light is dead. Signal Rock</code>	<code>rule = cove island:Wreckers' Cove start receiver:700 Under the Radio Tower's signal hides another... Wreckers' Cove after:RadioTower quest</code>

Random islands, in detail

How a world gets them. In Raft's **New Game** box, the **Custom Islands plan** list (2):

- **Random islands** (the default): *only* random islands, no story of the mod's.
- **No custom islands**: none at all.
- **Any other plan**: random islands only if that plan has **Random islands while sailing: on**. The Long Voyage has it on, so you meet random islands *between* its side trips and quest islands; The Abyss Expedition too. A plan made for a tight story usually has it off: then the world has only the plan's islands.

You switch it for a plan in the editor's **World plans** window: the switch **Random islands while sailing** at the top of the plan (step 4 of 7.2); in the plan file it is the line `random = on` or `random = off`. In a running world the host can switch them with `CustomIslandsAuto on / off` (F10).

Which islands can come. The **spawn pool**: every island you have saved or downloaded (unless `spawnpool.txt` gives it weight 0), brand-new generated islands (`generated` in `spawnpool.txt`), and the

map types listed there. For each new world you can untick islands in **World settings > Islands while sailing > CHOOSE ISLANDS...** (9.5). A **plan's own islands never come by chance**: when you install a plan from the island library, its islands get weight 0 in `spawnpool.txt`, so Signal Rock can't turn up early as a random island and then again at 4 km. (Islands you built or saved yourself are in the pool unless you give them 0 - if a plan of yours uses one of your islands as a side trip or quest island, set it to 0 there, or untick it in the world's list.)

How often and where. `chancePerKm` (0.25: about one island every 4 km sailed), `spawnDistanceMin` / `spawnDistanceMax` (250-350 m ahead), `minSpacing` (800 m between custom islands) - all in `spawnpool.txt` (10). None appears while the raft is at one of Raft's own islands, and Raft won't put one of its islands on top of a custom one later.

Side trips, in detail

A side trip is one **rule** of a plan: "bring this island at this point of the voyage, here, and tell the players". To make one in the **World plans** window (7.2 shows every click):

1. Open your plan and click **+ Add a rule**. Give it a name, for example `signal`.
2. **WHEN**: choose **After sailing a distance** and type the km, for example `4`. The distance is what the raft has sailed in this world since it started (`WorldPlan` in F10 shows it). Other WHENs make side trips too: **On a day** (day 5), or **When the world starts** for an island right at the beginning.
3. **BRING**: **One of my saved islands** and pick the island with ▼ (`Signal Rock`). Or **A new island of a map type** (`wreck`, `camp`, `sunken` ...) for an island made new in every world, or **One island from a list** for a different one each time.
4. **WHERE**: **Ahead of the raft** and the metres (`450`). Raft draws about 400 m far, so at 450 m the island is just coming into sight. **By chance while sailing** instead makes it come up some time *after* the distance, like a random island.
5. **TELL**: the message every player sees when it appears (`A mast on a rock ahead - its light is dead.`) - the mod adds how far and which way - and the name on the Receiver (`Signal Rock`). Both are optional, but without a message players can't tell it from a random island.
6. **STORY**: leave it on **Not in Raft's story**. That is what keeps it a side trip: nothing waits for it.
7. **Check**, then **Save**.

As a line of the plan file:

```
rule = signal | island:Signal Rock | km:4 | ahead:450 | A mast on a rock ahead - its light  
is dead. | Signal Rock
```

Good to know:

- Each rule fires **once per world**. Sail on to 4 km a second time (in the same world) and nothing new comes.
- If the raft is far from where it was when the rule fired, the island is still there: the rule placed it once, ahead of the raft at that moment. Its Receiver dot (with the name from TELL) shows it.
- A side trip can have its own quest. If you reach it and leave before the quest is done, it comes back ahead of the raft about 12 minutes later, up to three times (3); `returnMinutes` in `spawnpool.txt` changes the minutes (0 = never).
- Another rule can wait for a side trip ("when Signal Rock's quest is done, bring...") - then it is no longer a mere extra: the plan waits for it, and it comes back every time until that is done.

Main quest islands, in detail

A main quest island is a rule with a **place in a story chain**. The Long Voyage puts one after each of Raft's story islands; your own plan can also make a story without Raft's (6.5: **Raft's story islands: off** and your islands **First, After** each other). To make one in the **World plans** window:

1. Make sure the plan has **Raft's story islands: on** (the switch at the top), unless your story replaces Raft's.
2. + **Add a rule**, name it (`cove`).
3. **WHEN: When the world starts**. That only means the rule doesn't wait for anything *else*: the **STORY** place below decides when the island is unlocked.
4. **BRING: One of my saved islands**, pick it with ▾ (`Wreckers' Cove`). It needs a **quest** (6.1).
5. **WHERE: On the Receiver**, and the metres it comes up ahead of the raft when a player tunes to it (`700`). The island gets its own 4-digit frequency, made new for each world.
6. **TELL**: a message (shown when the frequency is unlocked: `Under the Radio Tower's signal hides another: a lantern code, blinking over and over.`) and the name on the Receiver (`Wreckers' Cove`).
7. **STORY: After** and the story island (**Radio Tower**). **Done when: its quest is done** (the default).
8. **Check** shows the whole chain ("Radio Tower > 'cove' > Vasagatan > ..."); then **Save**.

As a line of the plan file:

```
rule = cove | island:Wreckers' Cove | start | receiver:700 | Under the Radio Tower's signal  
hides another: a lantern code, blinking over and over. | Wreckers' Cove | after:RadioTower |  
quest
```

What players see, step by step (The Long Voyage, first quest island):

1. On Raft's **Radio Tower** they read the note that normally gives Vasagatan's frequency. In this world it gives the **Wreckers' Cove** frequency instead: a banner says "Tune the Receiver to #4821" (each world has its own number), the journal (J) gets a page with it, and the note shows the number.
2. A player tunes Raft's **Receiver** to it. Wreckers' Cove comes up about 700 m ahead of the raft, and shows on the Receiver with its name.
3. They sail there and do its **quest** (the quest panel shows its steps while they are at the island).
4. The quest done, the story goes on: **Vasagatan's** frequency is unlocked ("The Receiver picks up a new frequency: #1234", and a journal page "A new signal"), and Raft's story continues as Raft has it - until Vasagatan's note unlocks the next quest island, Thornwood.

If you don't do the quest, the story stops there: the next story island's frequency never comes. `StoryChain` (F10) shows the whole chain, what is unlocked and done, and every frequency.

Other ways an island can come

The three above are what you meet in most worlds. A plan or an island can also bring islands in other ways - they work like side trips (a rule with a **WHEN**, a **WHERE** and a message), only the **WHEN** is something that happens on an island:

- **Quest chains**: "when Old Camp's quest is done, bring Skull Rock 800 m north-east of it" (7.2, 7.4). The Abyss Expedition is made of these: each island comes **near the one before** when its quest is done or

players reach it. The plan waits for them, so if one drifts out of reach before you've done what the plan waits for, it comes back every time.

- **Islands that bring islands:** an island's own rules, made in the editor (6.4) - for example a quest reward that brings a treasure island.
- **The world randomizer's islands** (World settings, 9.3): oddity islands, large islands and boss lairs while sailing - random islands of their own, not from your spawn pool.

How to tell them apart in a world

You see...	It is...
An island comes up with no message ; its Receiver dot has no name	A random island (or one of the randomizer's)
A message on screen as it appears ("A white hull glints on a sandbar ahead.") and a named Receiver dot	A plan rule's island: a side trip, or part of a quest chain
A banner " Tune the Receiver to #.... ", then the island comes when you tune to it	A main quest island in the story chain

In F10 (Raft's console):

- `WorldPlan` - the world's plan, whether random islands are on, the km sailed and the day, and **every rule** with **[done]** in front of the ones that have brought their island;
- `StoryChain` - the story in order (Raft's islands and the plan's), what is unlocked and done, and the frequencies;
- `ListSpawned` - every custom island in this world, with how far it is from the raft.

The Long Voyage from start to end

When	What comes	Kind
From the start, all voyage long	Now and then an island of your spawn pool	Random island
2 km sailed	The Stranded Gull , 450 m ahead: "A white hull glints on a sandbar ahead."	Side trip
4 km	Signal Rock (quest "Dead Air"): "A mast on a rock ahead - its light is dead."	Side trip
After the Radio Tower's note	Wreckers' Cove on the Receiver	Main quest island
7 km	Ranger's Rest	Side trip
After the Cove's quest	Vasagatan's frequency, as Raft has it	Raft's story
After Vasagatan's note	Thornwood on the Receiver	Main quest island
10, 13, 16 km	Stilt Hollow, Mayor's Wharf, Crane Yard	Side trips
...	the same after Balboa, Caravan Town, Tangaroa, Varuna Point and Temperance	Main quest islands

When	What comes	Kind
20, 24, 28, 32 km	Frost Hollow, Tide Farm, Old Mine Islet, Shelter Atoll	Side trips
After Temperance's quest island	Utopia, Raft's ending	Raft's story

The side trips come by distance and the quest islands by the story, so where they fall between each other depends on how fast you sail and play: a quick player may reach Vasagatan before 7 km, a slow one may have met five side trips by then. [16.4](#) lists every island of the plan.

Questions

- **"An island appeared - is it random or part of the plan?"** Look for a message when it appeared and a name on its Receiver dot (the table above), or type `WorldPlan` in F10: a plan island's rule is marked **[done]**.
- **"Do I have to do the side trips?"** No. They are there to explore; the story never waits for them.
- **"I sailed past a side trip - is it gone?"** It stays where it came up (its Receiver dot shows where). If you had reached it and its quest wasn't done, it comes back ahead of the raft by itself after about 12 minutes, up to three times. One you never reached stays where it is.
- **"A quest island drifted away before I finished it."** Main quest islands stay where they came up - follow their dot on the Receiver, which shows the way and the distance. Islands a plan waits for in other ways come back by themselves until you've done what the plan waits for ([3](#)).
- **"Can I have only the plan's islands, no random ones?"** Yes: in your own plan, set **Random islands while sailing** to off. For a plan someone else made, make a copy (**Copy...** in World plans) and switch it off there, or untick every island in **World settings > Islands while sailing** for that world.
- **"Can a random island be one of the plan's islands?"** Not for a plan installed from the library (its islands have weight 0 in `spawnpool.txt`). For your own plan with your own islands, give them 0 in `spawnpool.txt` or untick them in the world's list, or they can turn up by chance too.
- **"Where do I change the km, the message, or which island?"** In the editor: **WORLD PLANS**, open the plan, change the rule's card, **Save**. A world already playing that plan gets the change the next time it loads; rules that have already fired stay done.

7.1 The plans that come with the mod

Choose one in the New Game box (**Custom Islands plan**), or open it in World plans to see how it's made:

Plan	What happens
Random islands (the default)	Islands turn up by chance while you sail (section 3). No story
No custom islands	Plain Raft: no custom islands at all (the World settings still apply)
Island hopping	An old camp near the start; each island you reach shows the way to the next, further out
Adventure	A story: each quest leads to the next island (a camp, islets, a beast's plateau, a treasure), with a wreck and a sunken island on the way
Growing sea	Random islands, plus a special island every few km and days

Plan	What happens
Receiver adventure	A new adventure instead of Raft's story: each island is found with the Receiver, and its quest gives the next frequency

Island hopping, Adventure, Growing sea and **Receiver adventure** are ordinary plan files: open one in World plans and use **Copy...** to start your own plan from it.

7.2 Your first world plan, step by step

This walkthrough makes a plan called **Castaway trail** with four islands. It uses map types, so it works even if you haven't built an island yet. Step 6 shows where to use one of your own islands instead.



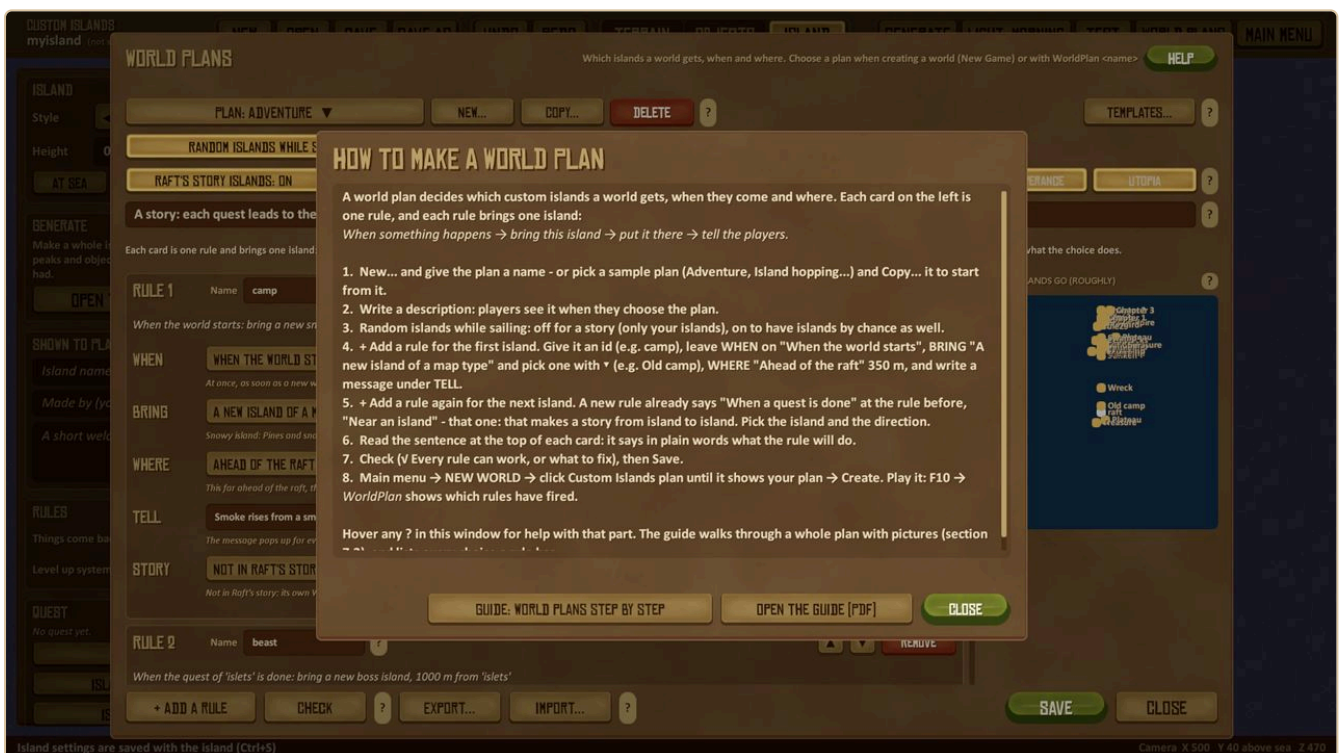
The World plans window with the Adventure plan open: the plan's buttons and switches at the top, one card per rule (WHEN, BRING, WHERE, TELL, STORY), the map on the right, and + Add a rule, Check and Save at the bottom.

1. Open the World plans window. In Raft's main menu click **EDITOR** and wait for the loading box to finish. In the editor's top bar, click **WORLD PLANS** (top right).

Help while you work: every part of the window has a small **?** next to it. Hover it (or click it) and a note explains that part: what each choice of **WHEN**, **BRING** and **WHERE** means, what Check looks for, and so on. The green **Help** button at the top right shows the steps below in short, with buttons that open this guide (the PDF, or this section online).



Hovering the ? after **When**: every choice it has, in a few words.



Help: how to make a plan, in eight steps, and the guide's buttons.

2. Start a new plan. Click **New...**, type a name (Castaway trail) and press **Enter** (or **OK**). The window now shows your empty plan: "No rules yet". The name is also the plan's file name, so it can't be the name of a plan you already have.

3. Describe it. Click the long field under the switches and write one line about the plan, for example Follow a castaway's trail across four islands. Players see it when they choose the plan in the New Game box.

4. Set the two switches.

- **Random islands while sailing: on / off.** On: islands from your spawn pool *also* turn up by chance, between your plan's islands. Off: the world has only the plan's islands. For a story, **off** is usually best - click it.
- **Raft's story islands: on / off.** On (the default): Raft's own story (Radio Tower, Vasagatan, ... Utopia) is still in the world, next to your islands. Off: your plan is the whole adventure. Leave it **on** for now; 6.5 explains the story row.

5. The first island: an old camp when the world starts. Click + **Add a rule** (bottom left). A card appears with one section per question (7.3). Each section has a ▼ **list**: click it and pick a choice - each choice says in a line what it does. Fill the card in:

- **Name** (top of the card, rule1): type `camp`. The name is how other rules say "the camp".
- **WHEN**: it already says **When the world starts**.
- **BRING**: pick **A new island of a map type**, then click ▼ after the **map type** field and pick **Old camp** (or type `camp`).
- **WHERE**: it already says **Ahead of the raft**. Set the metres to `350`.
- **TELL**: the message `Smoke rises from a small island ahead.`, and **on the Receiver** `Old camp`.

The sentence at the top of the card now reads: *When the world starts: bring a new old camp, 350 m ahead of the raft*. Read it after every change: it says in plain words what the rule will do. Under each section, a line in italics explains the choice you made.

6. The second island: your own island, when the camp's quest is done. Click + **Add a rule** again. A new rule already waits for the rule before it: **WHEN When a quest is done**, island `camp`; **WHERE Near an island**, 600 m. Fill in:

- **Name**: `cove`.
- **BRING**: pick **One of my saved islands**, then ▼ and one of your islands (for example **Skull Rock** from 4.8). No island of your own yet? Leave it on **A new island of a map type** and choose **Tropical island**.
- **WHERE**: **Near an island**, `800` metres, and in the direction list **North-east**. The field after **of** can stay empty: then it means "the island where the WHEN happened", the camp. (You can also type `camp` there, or pick it with the ▼ after the field.)
- **TELL**: `The camp's notes speak of a cove to the north-east.`, on the Receiver `Cove`.

The camp's map type has a quest (the notice board). "When a quest is done" at an island that has no quest never fires - use **When players reach an island** for those (next step).

7. The third island: a treasure island when players reach the cove. + **Add a rule**, then:

- **Name**: `treasure`.
- **WHEN**: **When players reach an island**, then the ▼ after the **island** field and pick `cove` (or type it). The list has the plan's other rules and your saved islands, and says which have a quest.
- **BRING**: **A new island of a map type** → ▼ → **Treasure island**.
- **WHERE**: **Near an island**, `900` metres, **Any way**, of `cove`.
- **TELL**: `From the cliffs you spot another island.`, on the Receiver `Treasure`.

8. A fourth island on the way: a wreck after 3 km. Not every rule has to follow another. + **Add a rule**, then:

- **Name:** `wreck`; **WHEN:** After sailing a distance, type `3` (km);
- **BRING:** A new island of a map type → **Wreck**;
- **WHERE:** Ahead of the raft, `300` metres; **TELL:** Something floats ahead: a wrecked raft.

9. Check the plan. Click **Check**. The box under the map says ✓ **Every rule can work.**, or lists what's wrong (see 7.5). The map on the right sketches where the islands will go.

10. Save. Click **Save**. The bottom of the screen says `Saved plan 'Castaway trail' (4 rules)`. Always save before you click **Close**: Close throws away changes since the last save.

11. Play it. Go back to the main menu (**MAIN MENU**, top right) → **NEW WORLD**. At the bottom right, click the **Custom Islands plan** list and choose **Castaway trail**, then click Raft's **Create**. In the world:

- the old camp is 350 m ahead of the raft right away, with the message on screen and "Old camp" on your Receiver;
- finish the camp's quest (the quest panel shows its steps) and the cove comes 800 m to the north-east;
- sail to the cove: when you reach it, the treasure island appears near it;
- after 3 km of sailing, the wreck comes up ahead, whatever else you're doing.

Press **F10** and type `WorldPlan` to see the world's plan and which rules have fired.

12. Change it later. Open **WORLD PLANS**, click the **Plan** button at the top left and pick your plan. Change what you want, **Save**. New worlds get the new version. A world that already uses the plan gets it the next time you load it on your PC; rules that already happened stay done (7.6).

The finished plan as its file (`Mods\DynamicIslands\plans\Castaway trail.plan`, see 7.7):

```
description = Follow a castaway's trail across four islands
random = off
story = on

rule = camp | type:camp | start | ahead:350 | Smoke rises from a small island ahead. | Old
camp
rule = cove | island:Skull Rock | quest:camp | near:camp:800:north-east | The camp's notes
speak of a cove to the north-east. | Cove
rule = treasure | type:treasure | visit:cove | near:cove:900:any | From the cliffs you spot
another island. | Treasure
rule = wreck | type:wreck | km:3 | ahead:300 | Something floats ahead: a wrecked raft.
```

Short cut: Templates... (top right) adds a ready-made set of rules to the open plan: the four sample plans, and **Detour in Raft's story**, **Balboa replaced**, **Sky chain** (flying islands, each appearing when players reach the one before), **Story chain** (three of your islands, each quest bringing the next: pick your islands with ▼) and **Quest reward island**. Then change what you like. An id that's already in your plan gets a `b` added.

7.3 A rule card, part by part

RULE 1

Name

camp

?

▲

▼

REMOVE

When the world starts: bring a new snowy island, 600 m ahead of the raft

WHEN

WHEN THE WORLD STARTS

?

At once, as soon as a new world begins

BRING

A NEW ISLAND OF A MAP TYPE

map type

snowy

?

Snowy island: Pines and snow drifts (Temperance)

WHERE

AHEAD OF THE RAFT

600

metres ahead

?

This far ahead of the raft, the way it sails

TELL

Smoke rises from a small island ahead.

on the Receiver

Old camp

?

The message pops up for every player when the island appears (with how far and which way); the name is its dot's name on Raft's Receiver. Both optional.

STORY

NOT IN RAFT'S STORY

?

Not in Raft's story: its own WHEN decides when it comes. Choose a place to make it part of the Receiver's chain of islands.

A rule card of the Adventure plan: its name and what it does in a sentence, then one section per question. Each section has a ▼ list of its choices and a line in italics saying what the chosen one does.

RULE 1

Name

camp

?

▲

▼

REMOVE

When the world starts: bring a new snowy island, 600 m ahead of the raft

WHEN

WHEN THE WORLD STARTS

?

At once, as soon as a new world begins

BRING

A NEW ISLAND OF A MAP TYPE

map type

snowy

?

WHERE

A NEW ISLAND OF A MAP TYPE

The mod makes a new island of this kind in each world (camp, volcano, wreck...): nothing to share, it always works

TELL

ONE OF MY SAVED ISLANDS

An island you built in the editor, exactly as you saved it

STORY

ONE ISLAND FROM A LIST

One of several saved islands, picked at random (ones not in the world yet first)

A RANDOM ISLAND (SPAWN POOL)

Any island of your spawn pool (spawnpool.txt), as random islands are

on the Receiver

Old camp

s dot's name on Raft's Receiver. Both optional.

in of islands.

The **BRING** list open: every choice, each with what it does. The chosen one is lit; click another to change it (Esc or a click outside closes the list).

Part	What it does
RULE 1 and Name	The rule's number and name (camp , beast). Other rules point at the island it brought with this name. Each name once per plan; no or :
▲ ▼ Remove	Move the rule up or down in the list (the order only matters for reading: each rule waits for its own WHEN), or remove it
The sentence	Under the name: the rule in plain words. If it doesn't say what you meant, change the card
WHEN	What the rule waits for - a ▼ list of nine choices (7.4). A choice that needs more shows named fields after it: island, zone, signal, steps, day, km sailed

Part	What it does
BRING	What kind of island: a new island of a map type, one of your saved islands, one island from a list, or a random one from the spawn pool. The field after it says which (map type, island, islands)
WHERE	Ahead of the raft, near an island, on the Receiver, or by chance while sailing; then the metres . For "near an island", also the direction (a ▼ list: Any way, North, North-east...) and of which island (empty = the island where the WHEN happened)
TELL	The message every player sees when the island appears (with how far and which way it is), and the island's name on the Receiver . Both optional
STORY	World plans only: the island's place in Raft's story (a ▼ list: not in it, first, after or in place of one of Raft's story islands...) and, when it's in the story, done when (6.5)
The lines in italics	Under each section: what the chosen option does, with the numbers and names you gave. For a map type, what kind of island it makes
?	At the end of each section: hover it for every choice of that section in a few words

The ▼ lists. A field that names something has a ▼ after it: the island a rule waits for, the zone, signal or quest step on that island, the island to put it near, the map type or saved island to bring, and a story rule's "done when" zone, signal or step. It lists what exists, so there is nothing to misspell: the plan's rules (with what they bring), your saved islands (with "quest, 4 steps" or "no quest"), and the zones, signals and quest steps saved in that island's file. Picking one fills the field; typing still works. A new map-type island is only made in the world, so its zones and signals can't be listed: its list is empty and says so - type the name.



The ▼ after the zone of "When a trigger zone fires" lists the zones of the island the rule waits for (here the saved island "shrine").

7.4 Everything a rule can do

When the island comes. "Island" below means a rule's id (the island that rule brought) or the name of an island:

When	Needs	The island comes...
When the world starts	-	as soon as the world starts
After sailing a distance	km	when the raft has sailed that far in this world
On a day	a day	on that in-game day
When a quest is done	an island	when that island's quest is done. The island must have a quest (6.1)
When quest steps are done	an island, steps	when that many steps of its quest are done
When a trigger zone fires	an island, a zone name	when a player walks into that trigger zone on it (5.4)
When players reach an island	an island	when a player first comes to that island
Right after another rule	a rule's name	right after that rule's island has come
When a signal is sent	an island, a signal name	when an object on that island sends that signal (a send a signal action, 6.2)

What it brings:

Bring	Which one	Good to know
One of my saved islands	one of your islands (<code>.island</code> files)	Every player gets it from the host; only the host needs the file
A new island of a map type	a map type: <code>random</code> , <code>sandbar</code> , <code>atoll</code> , <code>archipelago</code> , <code>stacks</code> , <code>boss</code> , <code>volcano</code> , <code>swamp</code> , <code>spire</code> , <code>treasure</code> , <code>camp</code> , <code>sunken</code> , <code>sky</code> , <code>wreck</code> , the styles <code>tropical</code> , <code>snowy</code> , <code>desert</code> , <code>forest</code> , <code>volcanic</code> , and the randomizer's <code>oddity</code> , <code>large</code> , <code>lair</code>	A new island is made for the world, different in every world. No file needed, so it always works when shared
A random island (spawn pool)	-	A random one of your islands that may turn up while sailing (<code>spawnpool.txt</code> , 10)
One island from a list	island names, separated by commas	One of them is picked, ones not in the world yet first

Where it goes:

Where	Metres mean	Good to know
Ahead of the raft	how far ahead	The simplest: players can't miss it
Near an island	centre to centre from that island	With a direction and an island (of). If WHEN has no island (the world starts, a distance, a day, another rule), you must name one in of
On the Receiver	how far ahead it comes when tuned	It gets its own 4-digit frequency; it comes when a player tunes Raft's Receiver to it (6.5)
By chance while sailing	how far ahead	Comes up ahead some time after the rule fires, like a random island

Ideas to start from:

- **A quest chain:** each island's rule waits for **When a quest is done** at the island before it, **Near an island** of it. Players follow the story from island to island. (Every island except the last needs a quest.)
- **Explore to find more:** **When players reach an island** instead of **When a quest is done**, for islands without quests.
- **Timed surprises:** **After sailing a distance** or **On a day** with **Ahead of the raft**, between the story's islands.
- **A secret:** a trigger zone in a cave (**When a trigger zone fires**) or a lever that sends a signal (**When a signal is sent**) brings a hidden island.
- **Something different every time:** **One island from a list** with a few of your islands, or a map type **random**.
- **Found by radio:** **On the Receiver**, with the message telling players the island is out there.

7.5 Check: finding and fixing problems

Click **Check** any time. It goes through the plan the way a world will play it, and looks **inside the islands** too: each island's quest step by step (is there a zone, a note, a chest or creatures with the name each step needs?), its trigger zones and signals, and - for new islands of a map type - a sample island of that type. Then a report opens:



Check's report: each finding with its level, the rule it is about, why, how to fix it, and **Show rule** to go to its card.

- **Problem** (red): the rule can't work - it never brings its island. Fix these first.
- **Warning** (yellow): it may not work as you mean (for example it waits for an island no rule of the plan brings).
- **Tip** (blue): good to know (no message, very far away, Raft's story...).

After the first Check, every card shows its own problems and warnings in red and yellow under its sentence, and they follow as you change the plan. The box under the map sums up. **Save** checks too, and opens the report when there is a problem. The report's **Check again** checks after you changed something.

What Check looks for:

	Problems (it can't work)	Warnings and tips
Names	a rule with no name, two rules with the same name	a rule named like a rule on one of the islands the plan brings (what waits for that name may take the other's island)
WHEN	no number for a distance or a day; a quest wait at an island without a quest ; a quest that can't be finished (a step needs a zone, note, chest or creatures the island hasn't, or more pages than it gives - a note gives a page only when it has text); more steps than the quest has; a zone or signal the island hasn't (Check lists the ones it has); an island or rule name that doesn't exist; a rule that waits for itself; rules that wait for each other in a circle	waits for a saved island no rule of the plan brings (a problem when random islands are off); waits for a rule that has a problem; needs more creatures than the island has (and they don't come back - by default they do, after the regrow days); creatures Raft leaves out of a game mode (screechers and puffer fish: none in Creative); a story item nothing on the island gives; a distance or day so large it's slow to test, or 0 (it comes at once)

	Problems (it can't work)	Warnings and tips
BRING	no island chosen, an island that isn't saved, a map type that doesn't exist, a list with no saved island, an empty spawn pool	some islands of a list aren't saved; a very big island (over 12 000 objects); the same island brought twice
WHERE	near an island nobody has; near "the island where it happened" when the WHEN happens at no island; near its own island	near a saved island no rule brings; near a rule it doesn't wait for (it waits until that island is there); very far away
TELL		no message; found by Receiver but no Receiver name
STORY	its "done when" can't happen (as WHEN above); after Utopia while Utopia ends the story (it never counts as done)	after an island that isn't in the story; Raft's story order and missing blueprints
The plan	no rules, random islands off and Raft's story off (a world gets nothing); an island's own rules using the story or the Receiver	nothing comes by itself (every rule waits for another island)

Check can't play the quests for you. Test your plan: create a world with it and play it through (F10 → `WorldPlan` shows which rules have fired). A map type's island is made new in each world, so Check looks at a sample of it: its names are the same every time, its exact places aren't.

7.6 Playing, changing and sharing a plan

- **Choose it** in the New Game box: click the **Custom Islands plan** list and choose your plan, then **Create**. The choice is remembered for the next new world. In a running world, the host can give it another plan: **Esc** → **CUSTOM ISLANDS** → **Plan** (a list of the plans; its islands come from now on, what is done or unlocked stays), or F10 → `WorldPlan <name>`; `WorldPlan` on its own shows the plan and which rules have fired.
- **Multiplayer**: only the host needs the plan and its islands. Players who join get every island as it appears (section 8).
- **The plan decides islands only**. Monster difficulty, build cost, the level up system, the randomizer and the extra options are chosen in World settings for each world, whatever plan it has (section 9).
- **Copy...** saves the plan under another name. **Delete** removes the plan file straight away (it doesn't ask); worlds that use it keep their own copy.
- **Share it: Export...** makes a pack (.zip) with the plan and every saved island it needs, to send to a friend or to put in the island library; **Import...** installs a pack someone sent you (4.7). Map type islands need no file, so a plan made only of map types always works for everyone.

A world keeps its own copy of its plan. When a world starts, the plan's rules are saved with the world:

- **you edit your plan** (in World plans, on the PC of the player who made the world): the next time the world loads, the changed plan plays - rules that already happened stay done, new ones come - and you're told so;
- deleting the plan file, an **update** of a library or pack plan, or **another player** hosting the world with a different plan of the same name never changes the world: it plays its own copy (to give a running world another plan on purpose, pick it under **Esc** → **CUSTOM ISLANDS** → **Plan**, or use `WorldPlan <name>` in it);

- the world's plan goes along when someone else hosts the world later ([section 8](#)), even if they never had the plan;
- worlds saved before this version get their copy the next time they're saved on a PC that has the plan file.

A plan can only bring islands that are on the host's PC. If one is missing, the host sees which island and where it came from (the pack or library entry, or "ask the player who made this world"), and the rule waits until the island is there.

7.7 The plan file

Plans are text files in `Mods\DynamicIslands\plans\<name>.plan`. The World plans window writes them for you, but you can also open one in a text editor (the file starts with a short help). One `rule =` line per rule, its parts separated by `|`:

```
rule = id | what | when | where | message | Receiver name
```

Part	Written as
what	<code>island:<saved island>, type:<map type>, pool, oneof:<island>, <island>, ...</code>
when	<code>start, km:<km>, day:<day>, quest:<island>, step:<island>:<steps>, zone:<island>:<zone>, visit:<island>, rule:<rule id>, signal:<island>:<signal></code>
where	<code>ahead:<m>, near:<island>:<m>:<direction>, receiver:<m>, sailing:<m></code>

Two more parts put an island into Raft's story: `| first / after:<story island or rule id> / instead:<story island>` and when it's done: `quest, visit, step:<n>, zone:<zone>, signal:<signal>`. Other lines: `description = ...`, `random = on/off`, `story = on/off`, `storyleaveout = Balboa, Tangaroa`. Save the file; the World plans window and the New Game box read it the next time they open.

8. Playing together

Up to eight players (Raft's maximum). **Every player needs the mod.**

- **The host decides, for everyone:** the islands, the plan, the World settings (world rules, randomizer, extra options, which islands turn up while sailing; [section 9](#)), and the host's `spawnpool.txt` settings that change what players see (regrow days, Receiver dots, unload distance). A player's own files and last New Game choices never change the host's world, and only the host can change its settings.
- **Players who join** (or join again, or after a restart) get all of it: the islands and any island files they don't have, what was chopped, picked, looted and fired, doors and levers, quests, the crew's journal, where they stood on an island, and the tough animals' health.
- **Shared:** harvesting and pickups, chests (when several players open one at the same moment, the first gets it), zones, doors, quests and their rewards, story items, the journal. Things that move follow a clock all players share, so everyone sees them in the same place.
- **What grows back** is the host's decision: things come back when the island loads on the host after the regrow days; a player who has the island loaded sees it the next time it loads there.
- **Joining:** use Steam's "Join Game" on a friend (Raft's own Join World list is empty in this Raft version).
- **Someone else hosts next time:** Raft keeps the world on the host's PC. Copy its folder (`%USERPROFILE%\AppData\LocalLow\Redbeet Interactive\Raft\User\User_<Steam id>\World\<world name>`) to the new host's PC, into their own `User_<Steam id>\World`. The custom islands, what was used, quests, the journal, everyone's levels, the world's rules and its plan come along: the folder carries the mod's copy (`CustomIslands.txt`), and every player who joined keeps one too. Islands you only have from joining are used from their downloaded copies. Islands the plan hasn't brought yet are the one thing the new host may not have - see the table below.
- **Levels** (with the level up system on): each player's own, kept by the host and back when they join again; the host works out everyone's EXP, and each player sees the others' levels under their names.

Before you swap hosts: read [12.1 Playing together over several days](#) - which copy of the world to host from, the same mod version for everyone, the PC clock, and what not to do.

Who needs what: every case

Only **the host's** islands, plan and settings count in a game. Players who join need **the mod, nothing else**: no islands, no plans, no packs. What they're sent is kept on their PC (islands as `<name>_<code>`), which is what lets them host the world later.

Case	What happens	What anyone has to do
A hosts, B joins (any number of players, joining and leaving any time)	B gets every island that has appeared, with what was chopped, looted and fired, the quests, the journal, levels and settings - also after leaving and joining again, or a crash	Nothing

Case	What happens	What anyone has to do
A adds islands while B plays (a plan's rule, a random island, a spawned one)	B gets each new island as it appears	Nothing
B hosts A's saved world later , A joins	B uses the world's own copy (it comes in Raft's world folder, and B kept one while playing): the islands that appeared (from what B was sent), what was used, quests, journal, levels, World settings, and the plan	Copy the world folder to B (below). If the plan still has islands to bring that never appeared, B doesn't have them: B sees which ones. A exports the plan (4.7) and B imports it, or B gets it from the island library
A world made from a pack or library plan hosted by someone who never installed it	As above; the message names the pack or library entry	Install that pack or entry
A world saved before worlds kept their plan (older versions), hosted by someone without the plan file	The plan's remaining rules can't run: the host is told when the world loads	The first host saves the world once with this version (the plan is then in the world), or gives the plan file
The world's maker edits the plan while worlds use it	The next time such a world loads on their PC, it plays the changed plan (they're told)	Nothing
The plan is updated (library or pack) or deleted , or another player hosts with a different plan of the same name	Worlds already started keep their own copy	Nothing (<code>WorldPlan <name></code> in a world to switch it on purpose)
An older save of the world is loaded (Raft's Load Game box keeps the last 8 saves)	The custom islands, what was chopped, looted and fired, quests, journal and settings go back to that save as well	Nothing
An installed island is updated while a world uses it	That world gets the new one when its objects keep their order; else it keeps the version it started with (new worlds get the new one)	Nothing
You remove a pack that a saved world uses	What the world uses is kept (you're told which world)	Nothing
A pack's island has the name of one of yours	Installed as <code>Name (Pack title)</code> ; yours is untouched	Nothing
A pack was made with a newer mod version	A warning; "Install anyway" may leave out what this version doesn't know	Update the mod if something's missing

Case	What happens	What anyone has to do
An island downloaded or imported later , in a world with random islands	Only turns up if you allowed it (import) - also in worlds already started; a plan's islands never do	Untick it for a new world in World settings (9.5)
Different players have different islands with the same name	The host's is used; others get the host's as a copy and keep their own	Nothing

Moving a world to another host: Raft keeps the world on the host's PC in

%USERPROFILE%\AppData\LocalLow\Redbeet Interactive\Raft\User\User_<Steam id>\World\<world name>. Copy that folder into the new host's own User_<Steam id>\World. It carries the mod's copy of the world (CustomIslands.txt), so the custom islands, the plan, what was used, quests, the journal, levels and settings all come along.

9. World settings: rules and extra systems

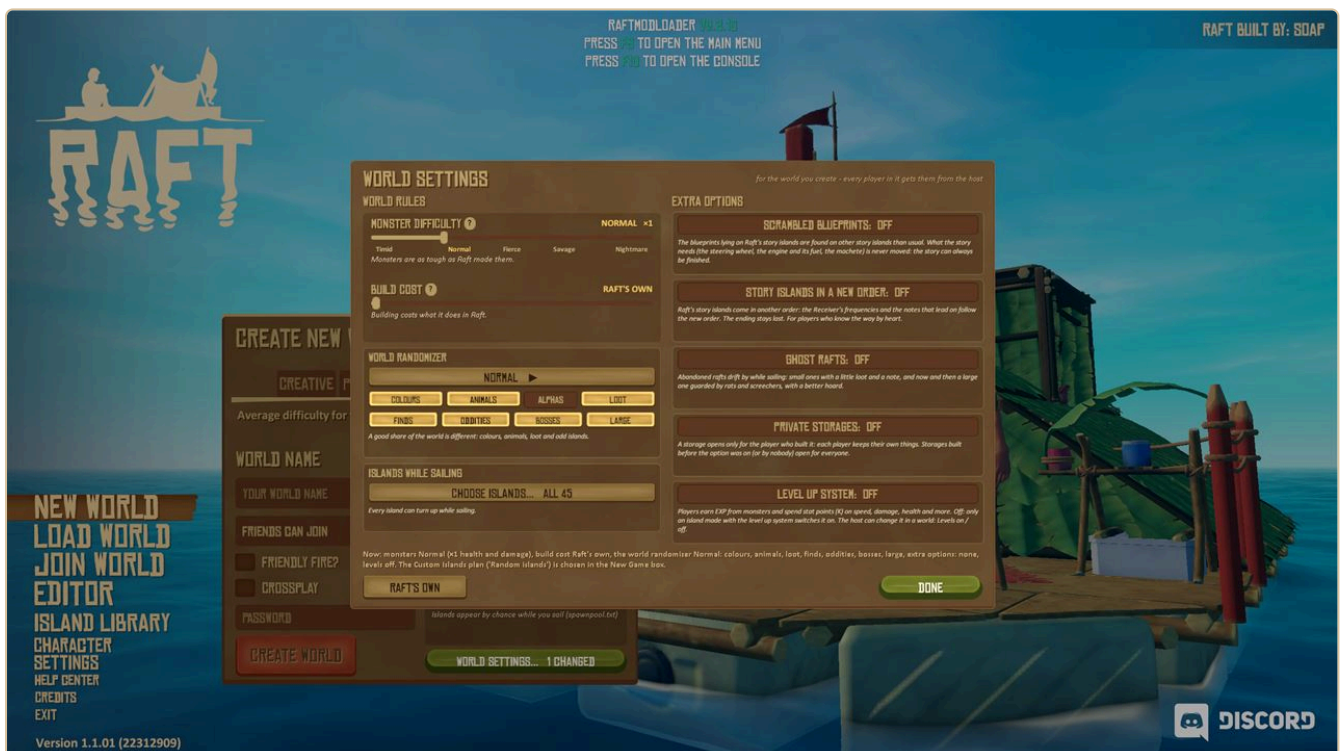
Everything in this section is **optional and separate from island building**: switches that change how a whole world plays, for players who know Raft well and want it different. None of them is needed to make or meet custom islands, and a world where they are all left alone plays as plain Raft plus your islands.

- **World rules** (9.2): tougher or softer monsters, a dearer build menu.
- **World randomizer** (9.3): a normal Raft world made different every time: colours, alphas, finds, odd islands, bosses.
- **Extra options** (9.4): scrambled blueprints, the story islands in a new order, ghost rafts, private storages.
- **Islands while sailing** (9.5): which of your islands a world may meet.
- **The level up system** (9.6): EXP and stat points - a switch in the window, or an island made with it.

All of them belong to the world: chosen when it is created, saved with it, the same for every player (the host's), and they come along when the world moves to another host ([section 8](#)).

9.1 The World settings window

Everything else the mod lets you choose for a new world is in one window, in four groups. Each part has a ? or an explanation. **Raft's own** puts every setting back to plain Raft; **Done** closes the window.



The World settings window: the world rules and the world randomizer on the left, the extra options on the right.

Group	What it does
World rules: monster difficulty	How tough monsters are in this world: Timid, Normal, Fierce, Savage or Nightmare (see section 9.2)

Group	What it does
World rules: build cost	How many more materials the build menu costs: Raft's own up to +100 %, rounded up
World randomizer	A normal Raft world made different: a ▼ list with Off, Light, Normal or Wild (each says what it means), and which parts take part (lit parts are on: click a part to switch it off; see section 9.3)
Extra options	More ways to play Raft again, for players who know it by heart: each switched ON or off with its own button (below)
Islands while sailing	Which of your islands (and which kinds of new islands) turn up by chance while you sail in this world: CHOOSE ISLANDS... opens the list (below)

Raft's own sets monsters to Normal, the build cost to Raft's own, the randomizer to Off and every extra option to off (it leaves the island list alone). The line at the bottom of the window sums up what the world will get. Nothing is final until you click **Create** in the New Game box.

In a world: press **Esc** → **Custom Islands** (a button in Raft's pause menu). The world's own settings window opens: monster difficulty, build cost, the world randomizer, the extra options, the level up system and the islands while sailing, plus the world's plan and story. The **host** changes them there, and every player gets the change at once. Players who joined see the host's settings, greyed out. (While you try an island from the editor, the same window has **Back to the editor**, [4.9.](#))



Esc → Custom Islands in a world: the same groups as the World settings window, changed for this world.

The host can also change every group with a console command (F10):

Group	Show it	Change it (host)
Monster difficulty	Monsters	Monsters savage
Build cost	BuildCost	BuildCost 25

Group	Show it	Change it (host)
World randomizer	Randomizer	Randomizer wild, Randomizer -alphas +bosses
Extra options	WorldOptions	WorldOptions +ghostrachts -privatestorage
Islands while sailing	WorldIslands	WorldIslands -<island>, WorldIslands +<island>, WorldIslands all

9.2 World rules: monster difficulty and build cost

Monster difficulty

Level	Monsters' health	Damage they deal to players
Timid	×0.75	×0.75
Normal	×1 (as Raft made them)	×1
Fierce	×1.25	×1.25
Savage	×1.5	×1.5
Nightmare	×2	×2

Monsters are the animals that fight players, on Raft's islands and custom ones: sharks, warthogs, bears, polar bears, screechers, puffer fish, rats, hyenas, bees, angler fish, the butler bots and the bosses. Left as Raft has them: puffer fish damage, and everything about Bruce and your raft (his bites on it, how often he comes, how soon he comes back). In Peaceful and Creative monsters can't hurt you, so only their health changes.

Build cost

Everything in the **build menu** (the hammer's foundations, floors, walls, roofs, stairs...) costs **0-100 % more**, always rounded up: at +50 % one plank becomes two, two become three, three become five. Removing a block gives back half of what it cost (as in Raft), and repairing and reinforcing cost more too. The crafting menu (Tab) costs the same as in Raft.

Both rules are the host's for every player, also players who join later. The host can change them in a world: `Monsters savage`, `BuildCost 25`. At the main menu the same commands set the choice for the next new world.

9.3 The world randomizer

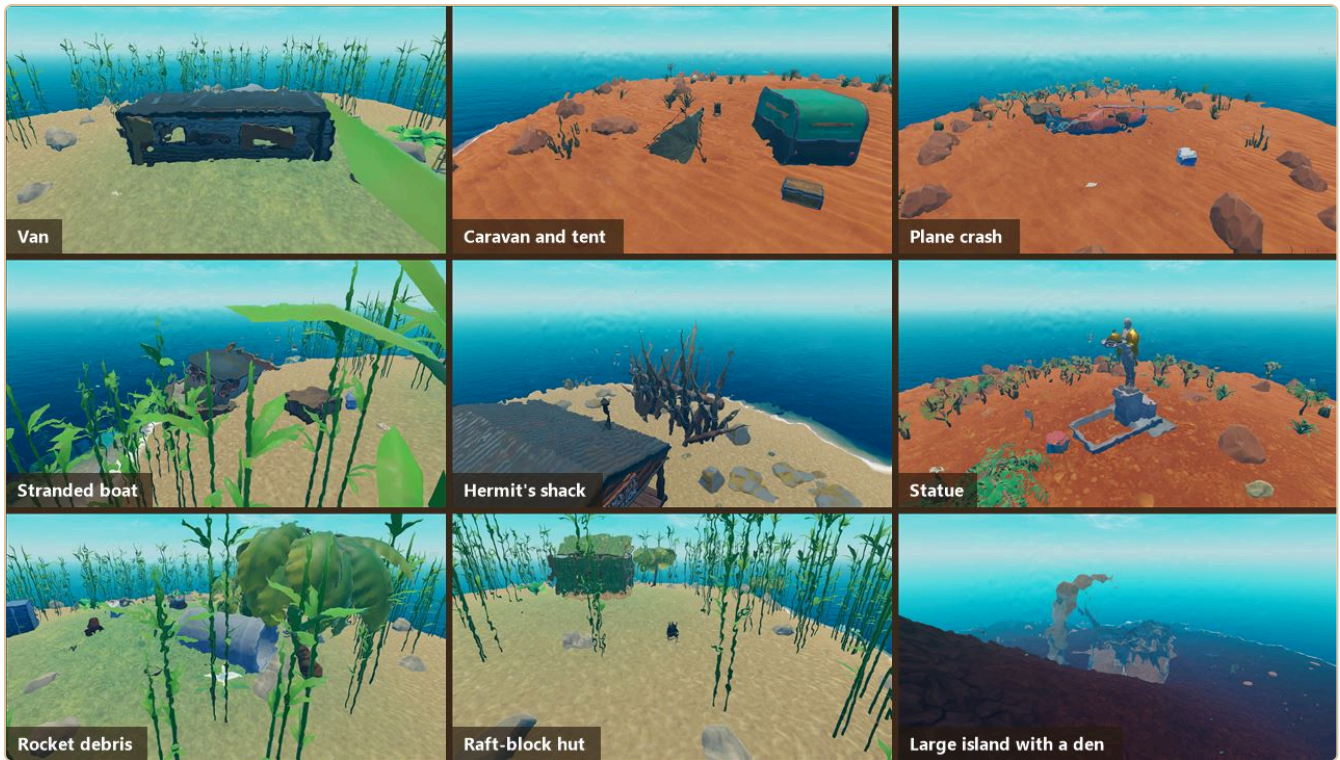
The randomizer makes a **normal Raft world** play out differently every time, with or without custom islands, and without touching Raft's story (the radio tower, Vasagatan, Balboa, Caravan Town, Tangaroa, Varuna Point, Temperance and Utopia stay as they are). Choose it in the World settings window (New Game box, **WORLD SETTINGS...**): **Off**, **Light**, **Normal** or **Wild**, and which parts take part. The level sets how often things happen:

	Light	Normal	Wild
Animals in another colour	about 15 %	about 30 %	about 55 %

	Light	Normal	Wild
Alpha fighters (sharks)	about 3 % (6 %)	about 6 % (12 %)	about 12 % (22 %)
An oddity island (after the first 1.5 km)	about every 12 km	about every 7 km	about every 4 km
A large island (after the first 3 km)	about every 20 km	about every 10 km	about every 7 km
A boss lair (after the first 4 km)	about every 40 km	about every 20 km	about every 12 km

The parts (all on unless you click one off):

Part	What you'll find
Colours	Animals and sharks (Bruce too) now and then in another colour: charcoal, ash, rust, moss, frost, night... and rarely a gold shark
Animals	More animals on Raft's islands, now and then puffer fish on the reef
Alphas	Rare bigger, darker alpha warthogs, bears, hyenas and screechers (3× health), and a huge Big Bruce . A banner warns you. Killed, they drop a trophy head , meat and leather
Loot	Some of the crates and giant clams on Raft's islands lie in other places; now and then extra crates and barrels
Finds	A treasure hunt (a map in a bottle on the beach leads to a buried chest), an abandoned camp , a castaway's stash , and on Raft's big islands a den with a guard and a hoard
Oddities	Small odd islands while you sail: a van, a caravan, a crashed plane, a stranded boat, a hermit's shack, a statue, rocket debris, a hut of raft blocks
Bosses	Now and then a boss lair : climb the plateau and a named beast (Old Ironhide, Frostfang, Ashmaw, the Tusk King, the Laughing One) wakes with two guards
Large	Now and then a large island as big as Raft's big ones, with a made-up name, animals, hidden loot, scenes from the quest islands and a den



The oddity islands. Each has loot, a note and a banner with its name when you arrive.



Large islands: tropical or snowy, with warthogs and animals to catch, a made-up name ("Coral Cay") and a den whose guard wakes when you walk in ("Something moves in the dark...").



Scenes on large islands, made from the props of Raft's quest islands, each with a chest and a note.



The Finds part can put a den on one of Raft's own big islands: a rock outcrop with a den inside, a guard and a hoard.

Changing it later: Randomizer (F10) shows what it does in your world; the host can change it, for example Randomizer wild or Randomizer -alphas. Everything follows from the world's seed, so every player sees the same colours, alphas and crates.

9.4 Extra options

More ways to play Raft again. Each option has its own button in the window's right column, switched **ON** or off, with an explanation under it. They can be combined freely.

Scrambled blueprints

The blueprints lying on Raft's story islands (Vasagatan, Balboa, Caravan Town, Tangaroa...) are swapped with each other, so each is found on another story island than usual. The pickup's name tells you which blueprint

you'll get. The pairs come from the world's seed: every player finds the same blueprint in the same place, and no blueprint stays in its own place. What the story needs is **never moved**: the Receiver and antenna, the steering wheel, the engine and its fuel, the machete, the zipline and the headlight, so the story can always be finished. Only what a pickup gives changes; which pickups there are, and which were taken, stays Raft's. Switching the option off (`WorldOptions -blueprints`) puts what is left in the pickups back to Raft's own.

Story islands in a new order

Radio Tower, Vasagatan, Balboa, Caravan Town, Tangaroa, Varuna Point and Temperance come in a shuffled order. Raft has no fixed places for them: each appears near the raft when the Receiver is tuned to a frequency a note unlocked. With the option on, the Receiver's first frequency leads to the new order's first island, and the note you find there to the next. The frequency numbers written on the notes follow; the notes' text still speaks of Raft's own order. **Utopia**, the ending, stays last. Each story island holds its own keys and parts, so any order can be finished.

Ghost rafts

Abandoned rafts of Raft's own blocks lie on the sea and come up ahead while you sail: none in the first 1.5 km of a world, then about one every 3 km. Three sizes:

Size	How often	What is on it
Small	about 6 in 10	A few foundations, a barrel and a message in a bottle
Medium	about 3 in 10	A hut of walls and a roof, a barrel and a box, a captain's log, sometimes a rat or two
Large	about 1 in 10	A wide raft with huts, pillars and a lookout, a hoard chest and barrels, guarded by rats on the deck and screechers circling above

You can walk on their decks (they float like a real raft, the deck just above the water) and loot what is on them. Every player sees the same ghost raft: the host brings it, as an island of the map type `ghostraft`.

Private storages

A storage opens only for the player who built it. Looking at someone else's shows whose it is instead of "Open", and **E** does nothing. Storages built while the option was off (or before this version of the mod) have no builder and open for everyone. The host keeps who built which with the world, so it stays after saving, loading and joining again.

For every player

Every player in the world gets the host's options, also when joining later. The host can change them in a world: `WorldOptions` (F10) shows them, `WorldOptions +ghostrafts -privatestorage` switches them.

9.5 Islands while sailing

With the plan **Random islands** (or a plan with random islands on), islands turn up by chance while you sail: every island you have saved or downloaded, plus brand-new generated ones and the map types listed in `spawnpool.txt` (section 10). The group **Islands while sailing** in the World settings window chooses which of them this world may meet. Its button, **CHOOSE ISLANDS...**, says how many take part (all 42, or 30 of 42) and opens the list:

- one row per island or kind of island, each with a **tick box**: your own islands by name (with their size and date), **New ... islands** for each map type (a new sandbar, wreck, atoll... each time) and **Brand-new generated islands**;
- untick the ones this world shouldn't have;
- the **search** field narrows the list (type part of a name), and **Tick shown** / **Untick shown** do every row shown, for example all your test islands at once.

Only what you untick is kept, so islands you make or download later join older worlds too, unless you untick them when you make a new world. The choice belongs to the world (saved with it, so it stays when another player hosts the world later), and the next new world starts from it. In a world the host can change it with `WorldIslands -<island> / +<island> / all`; `WorldIslands` alone shows the list.

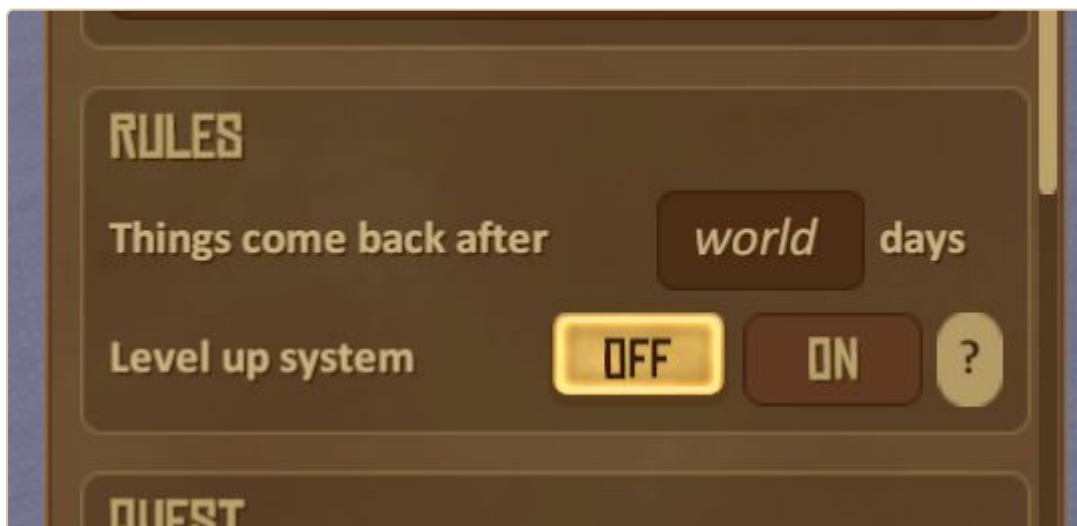
Islands that a quest, an island's rule or a world plan brings (section 6.4, section 7) come anyway: the list is only about islands by chance.

9.6 The level up system

Levels come to a world in two ways:

- **World settings** (New Game box): the **Level up system** switch among the extra options - on for the world from the start (the choice is remembered for the next new world);
- **an island made with Level up system: On** (the editor's **Island** tab, Rules, or the generator's **Level up** choice): once such an island appears in a world, levels come on there, for every player.

The host can switch it in a world with `Levels on / Levels off` (F10). **Off keeps everyone's levels** (they come back when it is on again), and an island made with levels doesn't switch it back on after the host switched it off. A world without it plays as Raft always does.



The switch in the Island tab's Rules.

Earning EXP

Hit a monster and the EXP it gave you floats up over it. Each hit gives the share of the monster's EXP that it took off its health, so killing it gives all of it. If you fight it together with a friend, each of you gets your own share. Chickens, goats, llamas, turtles, stingrays, dolphins, whales and people give nothing.



A hit on a warthog: +2 EXP.

Tougher monsters that bite harder are worth more, measured against Bruce the shark, who is worth **40 EXP**:

Monster	EXP	Monster	EXP
Bruce (shark)	40	Bear	27
Warthog	25	Polar bear	29
Screecher	23	Hyena	13
Puffer fish	19	Rat	13
Mama bear (Balboa)	133	Hyena boss	80

An island's own Hard or Boss animals are worth more than Raft's plain ones.

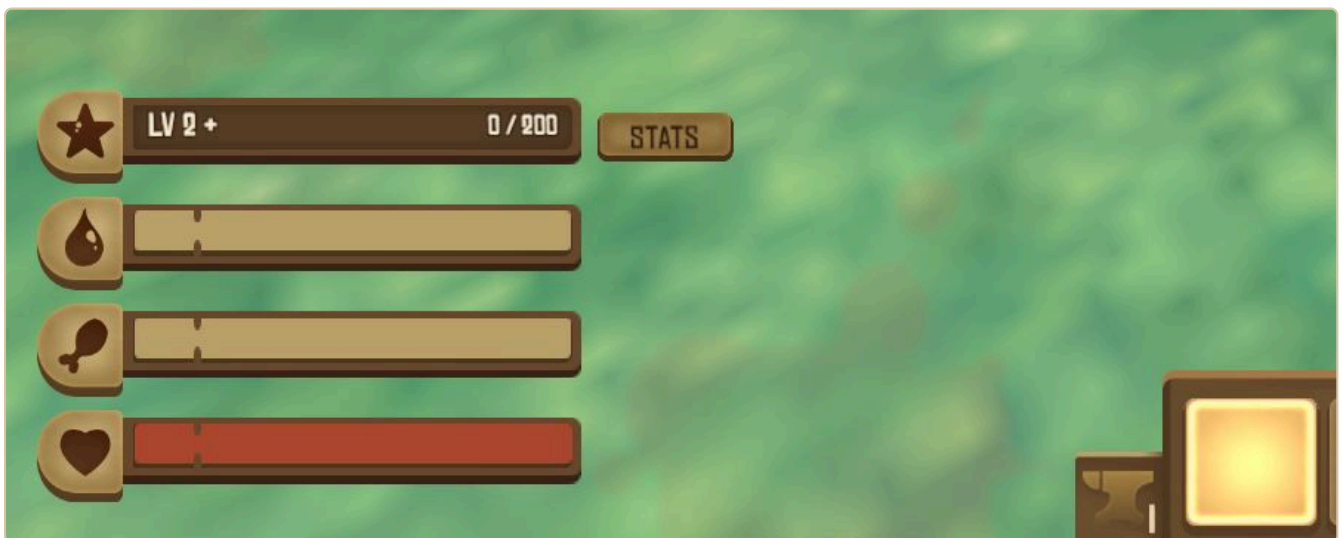
From level	EXP to the next	About
1 → 2	100	3 sharks
2 → 3	200	5 sharks
3 → 4	400	10 sharks
4 → 5	600	15 sharks
then	200 more each level	5 more sharks each level

Levelling up and spending points

A box shows when you reach a new level. **Click it** (in a menu, where the mouse is free) or press **K** to spend your points. The **EXP bar** is one more of Raft's own stat bars, above thirst, hunger and health: a gold star on its badge, a gold fill, the level on the left and the EXP to the next level on the right. It glows for a moment when you earn EXP. A **+** after the level means points are waiting. While Raft's inventory (**Tab**) is open, a **Stats** button sits next to the bar.



Level 2: two stat points to spend. The EXP bar is at the bottom left.



The EXP bar with its star, styled like Raft's thirst, hunger and health bars, and the Stats button while the inventory is open.

Every level gives **2 stat points**. Each point makes a stat **1% better**, and a stat takes at most 10 points (+10%):

Stat	A point makes it
Walk speed, Run speed, Swim speed	1% faster
Jump height	Jump 1% higher
Damage	1% more damage to monsters, with every weapon
Health	1% more maximum health
Hunger, Thirst	Drain 1% slower
Oxygen	Breath lasts 1% longer under water



The stats page (K): the level, the EXP, the monsters you defeated, and the nine stats. + puts a point in, – takes it back while the page is open.

All 90 points are there at level 46. After that the levels go on, without points.

Playing together: each player has their own level, and the host keeps it with the world. A player who joins again gets theirs back. The host works out everyone's EXP, so a monster is worth the same to everybody. Other players see a small gold **Lv 5** under your name.

10. Settings files

In `<Raft>\Mods\DynamicIslands\`. Text files: open them with Notepad. They explain themselves, and changes are picked up while the game runs.

`spawnpool.txt` (islands that appear on their own; the host's counts):

Setting	Default	What it does
<code>chancePerKm</code>	0.25	Chance that an island appears for each km the raft sails (0 to 1)
<code>minSpacing</code>	800	Metres kept between custom islands
<code>spawnDistanceMin</code> , <code>spawnDistanceMax</code>	250, 350	How far ahead of the raft an island appears
<code>unloadDistance</code>	800	Islands further away are unloaded (and come back when you return)
<code>returnMinutes</code>	12	An island the players still need (its quest begun and not done, or one a plan waits for) that the raft left behind comes back ahead of the raft after this many minutes (0 = never; 3)
<code>regrowDays</code>	3	In-game days until harvested things grow back (0 = never)
<code>showOnReceiver</code>	1	Custom islands as green dots on Raft's Receiver (0 = no)
<code>defaultPlan</code>	Random islands	The plan new worlds get when none is chosen
<code>generated</code>	1	How often a brand-new generated island is picked (0 = never)
<code>generatedStyles</code>	all five	The styles generated islands can have
<code>generatedFlyingChance</code>	0.1	The chance a generated island flies
<code><island name> <weight></code>	<code>* 1</code>	Which of your islands take part (<code>*</code> = every island not listed; weight 0 leaves one out)
<code>type:<map type> <weight></code>	sandbar, wreck, atoll, sunken	Map types that take part

Other files:

File	What it holds
<code>*.island</code>	Your islands (and the ones you installed from packs)
<code><name>_<hash>.island</code>	Islands downloaded from a host, or a version a saved world keeps after an update

File	What it holds
autosave\	Unsaved editor work (4.7): offered when the editor opens, removed when the island is saved
exports\	Packs you exported (<name>.zip), and exports.json (what you filled in, so the next export is the next version)
import\	Put packs you got here to install them (Import...)
library\installed.json	What each installed pack wrote (so it can be updated and removed)
library.txt	The island library: online = on/off , and its address (where its list is)
library\cache\	The library's pictures, kept so they needn't be downloaded again
plans*.plan	World plans
world_rules.txt , randomizer.txt	Your last World settings choices (monsters, build cost, extra options, islands left out; the randomizer), the start for the next new world
worlds\<world>.txt	Each world's custom islands and their state (what was used, quests, journal, levels, settings); the world's own folder carries a copy, CustomIslands.txt
groups\ , stamps\	Your saved object groups and terrain stamps
generator_presets\	Your generator presets (Save these settings...)
notice.txt	That you folded the alpha box, for this version of the mod
editor_light.txt	The editor's time of day (the Light button)
deleted\	Islands you deleted in the editor (move one back to get it back)
catalog_index.txt , placeables*.txt	Where the editor finds Raft's objects (made again after a Raft update)
Custom-Islands-Guide.pdf	This guide, written out of the mod when the alpha box's Guide (PDF) opens it
raft_*.txt , island_thumbs\ , island_heights\	Measurements of Raft's islands the generator uses (they come with the mod; a copy here is read first)

11. Console commands

Press **F10** for RML's console.

Command	Where	What it does
<code>SpawnIsland <name> [distance] [height]</code>	World, host	An island ahead of the raft (default 250 m)
<code>RemoveIsland <name> / RemoveIsland all</code>	World, host	Removes custom islands
<code>ListIslands / ListSpawned</code>	Anywhere / world	Your saved islands / the world's custom islands with their distance
<code>SpawnPool</code>	World	Which islands appear on their own, and how often
<code>CustomIslandsAuto on / off</code>	World, host	Automatic islands on or off for this world
<code>WorldPlan / WorldPlan <name></code>	World	The world's plan and its rules / give it another plan (host)
<code>StoryChain</code>	World	The world's story chain: Raft's story islands and the plan's own in order, what is unlocked and done, and the plan islands' Receiver frequencies
<code>Randomizer / Randomizer <off/light/normal/wild> [-part] [+part]</code>	World	What the randomizer does here / change it (host)
<code>WorldOptions / WorldOptions +option -option</code>	World	The world's World settings / change them (host; blueprints, storyorder, ghotrafts, privatestorage)
<code>Levels / Levels on / Levels off</code>	World or main menu	The level up system in this world / switch it (host; off keeps everyone's levels; at the main menu: for the next new world)
<code>Resync</code>	World, joined player	Ask the host for its custom islands again (the list, and any island file that hasn't come)
<code>WorldIslands / WorldIslands - <island> / +<island> / all</code>	World	Which islands turn up by chance while sailing in this world / leave one out, let it take part again, all of them (host)
<code>Monsters / Monsters <level></code>	World or main menu	The monster difficulty / change it (host; at the main menu: the next new world)
<code>BuildCost / BuildCost <0-100></code>	World or main menu	The build cost / change it (host; at the main menu: the next new world)
<code>LoadEditor</code>	Main menu	Opens the editor

The editor's own commands (`SaveIsland`, `GenerateIsland`, `SetStyle` ...) are in the [README](#).

12. Known issues: what to avoid until they are fixed

Custom Islands is an alpha. Most of it just works, but a few things can lose progress, break a quest or confuse the players when they are done in a certain way. This chapter lists them: **why** each one matters and **exactly what to do** instead. **Every one of them is a known issue that is being fixed** - each is on the project's roadmap, and this chapter gets shorter as they are fixed. Until then, following these steps keeps your worlds and adventures safe. What can't be changed (Raft's own limits) is in [chapter 13](#).

12.1 Playing together over several days

The world lives on the host's PC. When someone else hosts the next day, the mod works out which copy of the world is the newest, and every player who joined keeps a copy too. These rules make sure the right copy is played.

Host from the folder of whoever hosted last

Why: the mod can't tell "an older copy on purpose" from "an older copy by mistake". If you host from your own older copy, it simply continues that one - and your first save then replaces the newer copy the other players kept. Everything done in the sessions you missed is lost, without a warning.

What to do:

1. The player who hosted last session presses **Esc** and chooses Raft's **Main menu** (this saves the world), then waits for the main menu. Only then is the folder complete.
2. They open the world's folder: paste `%USERPROFILE%\AppData\LocalLow\Redbeet Interactive\Raft\User` into the address bar of Windows Explorer, open their `User_<Steam id>` folder (the long number), then `World`. Each world is a folder with its name.
3. They right-click that world's folder > **Send to > Compressed (zipped) folder**, and send the zip to the next host (Discord, a cloud drive, a USB stick).
4. The next host opens their own `...\User\User_<their Steam id>\World` folder. **If a folder with the same world name is already there, rename it first** (for example `My world - old`) or delete it - never paste over it: merging two copies of one world into one folder mixes their saves.
5. They unzip the received folder into `World`, start Raft, and load the world from **Load Game** as usual.

Also:

- Copy the **whole** world folder: the `CustomIslands.txt` in it and every dated save folder. A single save folder or only the `.rgd` files are not enough.
- Don't keep and play two folders of the same world (a "backup" you also play in): they share one set of custom-island progress on your PC and get mixed up.
- The copy a player keeps from joining is not a backup on its own: it goes with a Raft world folder.

Everyone runs the same version of the mod

Why: joining with another version only shows a warning ("things may not match"), and then the game goes on. But an older version doesn't know the newer parts of a world - the story chain, levels, the plan's own

copy, private storages - and **drops them**. When the player with the older version hosts and saves, the world loses those parts for good, for everyone.

What to do:

1. Each player looks at the **EXPERIMENTAL ALPHA RELEASE** box on Raft's main menu: it says "(version 3.0)" or similar. The versions must be the same.
2. To update: close Raft, replace `DynamicIslands.rmod` in Raft's `mods` folder with the new one (don't unzip it - see 12.5), start Raft again and check the box.
3. Update everyone **before** the next session, not in the middle of an adventure.

Everyone's PC clock and date are right

Why: the newest copy of a world is recognised by the time it was saved. A PC whose clock or date is wrong makes its copies look newer or older than they are, and players in far-apart time zones who swap hosts can confuse it too - an older copy of the world can win, and the progress in between is gone.

What to do:

1. On every PC: Windows **Settings > Time & language > Date & time**: switch on **Set time automatically** and **Set time zone automatically** (or pick the right time zone), and click **Sync now**.
2. With friends in other time zones: let one person host a shared world when you can; if you swap hosts, the next host always uses the folder the last host sent (above) - never their own older one.

The group agrees on the regrow setting

Why: how many in-game days until harvested things, looted chests and used trigger zones come back follows the **current host's** `spawnpool.txt` (an island whose builder set its own "Things come back after" keeps that). If one host played with "never" and the next host has the default 3 days, chests that were looted long ago fill up again and used zones fire again - a key can be found twice, an ambush comes back.

What to do:

1. Close Raft. Open `<Raft>\Mods\DynamicIslands\spawnpool.txt` with Notepad (`<Raft>` is Raft's game folder: in Steam, right-click Raft > **Manage > Browse local files**).
2. Find the line `regrowDays = 3`. The number is the in-game days; `0` means never.
3. Every player who will host the world sets the **same** number, and saves the file.
4. While you're there, the group can also agree on `showOnReceiver` (green dots on the Receiver) and `unloadDistance`
 - the host's values are the ones every player sees.

The next host has no own island named like one in the plan

Why: islands a plan still has to bring are looked up **by name** on the host's PC. If the next host has an island of their own with the same name ("Camp"), that one is brought instead of the plan's - with other content and quests, and nobody is told. If the host has no such island at all, the rule waits and the host is told which island is missing.

What to do:

1. In the world, press **F10** and type **WorldPlan**: it lists the plan's rules and the islands they bring.
2. In the editor, click **Open** and compare with the host's own saved islands. An island of your own with one of those names: open it, **Save as** a new name (for example **Camp - mine**), then **Delete** the old name (it is moved to the **deleted** folder, not erased).
3. If the host is missing an island of the plan: get it from the plan's maker - their pack (**Import...**), or the island library entry the message names - before playing on.

Other things to know

- **Don't press Tidy up** (island library > Installed) right after handing a world to someone else if you may host it again: it removes copies of islands that only that world uses on your PC.

12.2 Saving and quitting

Quit to the main menu, not with Alt+F4

Why: Raft saves the world now and then (and when you leave to the main menu). The mod writes some of its progress **at once** - when a story step is done, a Receiver frequency unlocked, or a setting changed. If Raft is closed without saving (Alt+F4, the window's X, Task Manager, a crash) after such a moment, the mod's progress is newer than Raft's save: chests show as opened and quests as done, while the loot and rewards are missing from the inventories - and they can't be earned again.

What to do:

1. To stop playing: press **Esc** and choose Raft's **Main menu** (it saves), wait for the main menu, then **Exit**.
2. After a quest step, a story step or a change in **Esc > Custom Islands**, don't close Raft right away: leave to the main menu as above (the host - players who joined can quit any time).
3. After changing a setting during play, let Raft save before you stop.

Other things to know

- **Raft's Load Game box** (the last 8 saves) takes the custom islands back to each save only for saves made with this version of the mod - not the very first save of a new world, and not saves from before this feature.
- **Back up worlds you care about** (copy the world folder, see [12.1](#)) before updating the mod or trying a new plan on them.

12.3 During a session

Take turns with the crew's last key

Why: the crew's **last key** (a story item that is used up) can open two different doors when two players use it at the same moment: each player's game checks the key before the host has heard of the other.

What to do: let one player use a key at a time; say it on voice ("I'm opening the vault").

(Fixed since 2026-10-01: a chest gives its loot once and a once-zone fires once even when the host is busy and answers late; a lever pulled by several players in the same second moves once; quest steps that count add up everyone's.)

Don't switch these in a running world

Why: two settings in **Esc > Custom Islands** (and the F10 commands) don't handle being changed while the game runs:

- **Story islands in a new order:** Raft's Receiver list is rebuilt; the island you were sailing to may be gone from it.
- **The build cost:** removing blocks gives back materials by the **new** cost, not by what you paid.

What to do:

1. Choose these in **World settings** when you **create** the world, and leave them.
2. If you must change one: do it when nobody else is connected, then let Raft save (leave to the main menu once).

(Fixed since 2026-10-01: switching the level up system off and on keeps everyone's levels, and changing the world randomizer no longer makes alphas tougher again or heals them.)

Other things to know

- **Big islands over the internet** take a while to arrive, and many at once can make the host's game lag. Let players join one at a time and stay near the raft until the islands have arrived.
- A second player can see an **alpha** weaker or dying early now and then (when it turned alpha while they were connected), and a Raft shark near a custom island can look different on their screen. Nothing is lost: fight on until it is dead on the host's screen.

12.4 Making quests and plans that work

These are the traps island builders run into. Always play your adventure once with **Test (4.9)**, doing things in the wrong order on purpose.

No toggles in events that happen again

Why: a trigger zone set to fire **Once** is ready again after the regrow days, a chest that fills up opens again, and a creature spot's **defeat** event fires again when the animals come back: a **show/hide** or **open/close** action there flips the bridge or door back.

What to do:

1. For a zone the story needs only once (an ambush, a bridge shown): **Fires: Once ever** - it never fires again.
2. In events that can happen again (zones set to Once or Every time, defeat, chests that fill up), use **show**, **open**, **journal page** and **say** - not **show/hide** or **open/close**.

(Fixed since 2026-10-01: a chest that holds a story item never fills up again - no second key or log.)

Use story items for keys and what the story needs

Why: Raft items (a metal ingot, a plank...) are in one player's inventory: they leave with that player, and on the island's "when its quest is done" event (**Island tab > Island events...**) and a creature spot's **defeat**

event the **has item / uses up item** checks look at the **host's** inventory, not the player who did it. Story items belong to the whole crew, stay with the world and work in every event.

What to do:

1. **Island tab > Story items...** > add the key (a name, a picture, a line of text).
2. Hand it out: put it in a chest (**Add items...** lists the story items too), or a **give items** action, or the quest's reward.
3. On the door: **Behaviour + events...** > + **Only if...** > **uses up item** (or **has item**) > pick the story item.
4. A note's actions run once, for its first reader (reading it again shows its messages only): for something every player should get, use the quest's reward or a chest per player.

Don't edit islands or plans that running worlds use

Why: a saved world remembers its progress on an island by the order of things: its objects, its quest steps, its bring rules. Some edits reach saved worlds and change what those numbers point at: a rule that already brought its island brings it again (or a new rule counts as done and never comes), the quest jumps to another step or waits for a note that was renamed. In a plan, worlds remember rules by their **id**: a rule renamed after it fired brings its island again. (A new rule that gets a fired rule's old id - World Plans numbers new rules `rule3`, `rule4` ... - is fine: when it brings another island it comes as a new rule.)

What to do:

1. **Safe** on an island worlds use: moving things, changing settings, adding objects, painting and shaping the ground.
2. **Not safe:** deleting or reordering its **Islands it brings...** rules, adding, removing or reordering **quest steps**, renaming a note, zone or object a step points at. For these: **Save as** a new name (`Camp v2`) and use the new island in new worlds and plans.
3. In a plan that worlds play: don't rename a rule's id after it has fired (its island would come again). Adding and deleting rules is fine, and so is changing a fired rule's words, WHEN or WHERE; changing what a fired rule **brings** makes it a new rule - that island comes too.
4. When the editor says which saved worlds use the island you are saving, stop and think whether the change is safe.

Other things to know

- **Rewards in Raft items** go only to players within about 150 m of the island when the last step is done; players who come later get nothing. Story items go to the whole crew.
- **"Collect N story items" and "find journal pages"** count what the crew already has, and finish when a player comes to the island (so the reward reaches them).
- **Give "near an island" rules open sea.** A rule that finds no room (close to one of Raft's big islands, for a big island) waits without telling anyone; the host's log says "waits: no free spot".
- **Avoid two copies of the same island in one world** when its quest counts journal pages.
- **A lock that uses up story items before the quest has counted them** (a chest that takes the key, a machine that takes three parts) leaves the quest's "collect" step for them waiting for ever: the items are gone before it counts. Give such a lock an **Only if** the quest reached that step, before the check that uses the items up (The Frontier in the library does it for each of its locks).
- **Raft's door walls** (the Wall door blocks) **can't be walked through** on an island yet: Raft's own helper box for building fills the doorway. For a doorway, leave a gap between two walls (the library's buildings

do).

- **Varuna Point's spotlight shoots** on an island: placed from the Objects tab it keeps its own behaviour and fires at any player it can see. For a searchlight or a beacon use the radio tower's floodlight instead (the library's islands do).

12.5 Names, files and your PC

Install the .rmod file as it is - don't unzip it

Why: an `.rmod` is a zip file, and unzipping it into `Mods\DynamicIslands` looks harmless - but the mod reads its own files (its version, Raft's object lists, the blueprint list) from that folder **first**. The unzipped copies then win over the ones in every future update: the mod reports an old version, and players can get different results.

What to do:

1. Put the file `DynamicIslands.rmod` itself into Raft's `mods` folder (`<Raft>\mods\`), next to the other mods.
2. If you unzipped it before: delete `modinfo.json`, `raft_*.txt` and any `.cs` files from `<Raft>\Mods\DynamicIslands` (keep your islands, plans and settings files). Restart Raft.
3. Don't keep the original **Dynamic Islands** mod (Franz's) in the mods folder next to this one: they use the same folder and patch the same parts of Raft.

Don't edit the mod's files while Raft runs

Why: the mod reads some files again when they change and rewrites others itself (the files in `worlds\` at every save). Changes made while Raft runs can be lost or mixed in half-way.

What to do:

1. Close Raft first, then edit `spawnpool.txt`, `world_rules.txt`, `randomizer.txt` or `library.txt` with Notepad.
2. Write decimals with a dot (`0.5`, not `0,5`), even on a PC set to another language.
3. Don't edit the files in `worlds\` at all - and leave their first lines alone: Tidy up and host swap read them.

Keep Raft out of OneDrive and Program Files

Why: the mod writes its files next to Raft (`<Raft>\Mods\DynamicIslands`): islands, plans, the world lists. In `C:\Program Files` Windows may not allow that, a synced folder (OneDrive, Dropbox) can lock a file while it syncs, and an antivirus with "controlled folder access" can block it. Then a save fails, and for the world's progress the mod may only say so in the log.

What to do:

1. Check where Raft is: in Steam, right-click Raft > **Manage** > **Browse local files**.
2. If it is under `Program Files` or a synced folder: Steam > **Settings** > **Storage** > add a drive or folder elsewhere (for example `D:\SteamLibrary`), then Raft > **Properties** > **Installed Files** > **Move install folder**.
3. With Windows Security's **Controlled folder access** on: allow Raft (`Raft.exe`) under **Allow an app through controlled folder access**.

Names that break

- **Island names:** the editor refuses names that start with `#` or `@` or hold `=`, `,` or `;` - the mod's own lists use them. An island saved under such a name by an older version: **Save as** a new name (an island "#1 Base" disappears from saved worlds, "@home" counts as unused, "Rock, big" can't be used in "one of these").
- **World names:** avoid an apostrophe (`Bob's raft`) for now - Tidy up can take such a world for a deleted one. If Tidy up lists a world that still exists, don't press it.

Other things to know

- **Don't delete `gen-...` island files by hand** while a saved world uses them. A generated island is a file like any other: without it the world simply lacks that island, for you and everyone who joins (the log says "Could not read island"). Remove unused ones with **Tidy up** in the island library, which leaves the ones worlds use.
- **Don't use the mod loader's Unload / Load (F9)** on Custom Islands during a session - restart Raft instead.
- **Island packs from people you don't know:** a damaged pack can install and fail later. Prefer the island library (every entry is looked at), and report a pack that fails ([chapter 15](#)).

13. Limitations: what can't be changed

These come from Raft itself, from the game engine (Unity), or from a choice made on purpose. They are not bugs and are not planned to change. Everything that can be fixed is in [chapter 12](#) instead, and on the project's roadmap.

Raft and its mod loader

- **Every player needs the mod** (and the Raft Mod Loader): Raft can't show custom islands to a player without it.
- **Up to eight players**, Raft's own maximum.
- **Raft's own Join World list is empty** in this Raft version: join friends through Steam ("Join Game").
- **Levels, the place a player stood and private storages belong to a Steam account**: Raft knows players by their Steam id. A player who comes back with another Steam account starts over there.
- **Raft has no pets**: "catchable" animals are Raft's domestic ones (chicken, goat, llama), caught with the net launcher.
- **Story items live in the crew's journal, not in Raft's inventory**. Raft's items are a fixed list; a new item would break the save for anyone who opens the world without the mod.
- **Objects from Raft's other islands and Raft's buildable items are decoration** in custom islands: a chest from Tangaroa doesn't store anything, a character doesn't move. Their game code belongs to Raft's own islands. The mod's own chests, notes, zones and creature spots, and the harvestable trees, rocks, ores and plants, have their gameplay.
- **The screecher's stone look can't be tinted** (it is not a normal texture).
- **Atmosphere zones** change Unity's fog and light plus a faint tint: how strong they look depends on Raft's own sky at that moment.

The land

- **One sea level**. Raft has one ocean: lakes and lagoons go down to sea level, and there is no water above it.
- **No caves or overhangs from the terrain**. An island's ground is one height map (one height at each point): build caves and arches from objects (rocks, Raft's big island pieces) instead.
- **Flying islands**: reaching one is up to the players (stairs or pillars from the raft) - that's the idea.
- **At most 12 000 objects per island** from the generator: more makes Raft stutter when the island loads.

Versions

- **An island saved with a newer version of the mod can't be opened by an older one** (the file says so). Update the mod.
- **Islands built with Unity (.assets, version 2)** are no longer read: rebuild them in the editor.

Sharing

- **Text inside islands** (notes, quests) is shown as its builder wrote it: a pack from someone you don't know can hold words you'd rather not see. The island library's entries are looked at before they go in.

14. Questions and problems

No islands appear while I sail. Run `SpawnPool`: are automatic islands on, and is the pool empty? The plan may be "No custom islands" (`WorldPlan`). Islands appear only where there is room: near Raft's own islands they wait until the sea is clear. `SpawnIsland <name>` places one right away.

K does nothing, and there is no level bar. The level up system is off in this world: switch it on in World settings for a new world, or with `Levels on` (host, F10) in this one; an island made with **Level up system: On** switches it on too (see [section 9.6](#)).

A friend's storage won't open. The world has **Private storages** on (9.4): a storage opens only for the player who built it. The host can switch it off with `WorldOptions -privatestorage`.

The Receiver led me to the wrong story island / the blueprint isn't where the wiki says. The world has **Story islands in a new order** or **Scrambled blueprints** on (9.4); `WorldOptions` shows which.

A note's frequency leads nowhere, or a story island never comes. The world's plan may leave that island out of Raft's story, or put one of its own islands in its place (6.5). `StoryChain` (F10) shows the chain and the plan islands' frequencies; a plan island on the Receiver comes only after the island before it is done.

One of my islands never turns up. It may be unticked for this world (9.5): run `WorldIslands`, and `WorldIslands +<island>` lets it take part again. Its weight in `spawnpool.txt` may also be 0.

A story item isn't in my inventory, or Raft's notebook has no page for a custom island's note. They are in the journal (J): custom islands keep their story items and notes there, for the whole crew (3). Raft's notebook (T) only has Raft's own story.

A note I read isn't in the journal. Notes with no text add no page, and each note adds one page once per world (someone else may have read it first: look for its title).

Load World is greyed out. Raft is offline from Steam. Check that Steam is online and restart Raft.

"The host has Custom Islands 3.x - you have 3.y". You and the host have different versions of the mod: islands, quests and settings may not match between you. Both of you update to the same version (raftmodding.com).

My island can't be saved under that name. Windows keeps some names for itself (CON, PRN, AUX, NUL, COM1-9, LPT1-9 - also with anything after a dot) and doesn't allow a name ending with a dot or a space, or `\ / : * ? " < > |`. Names can be up to 60 characters. The message says what is wrong; choose another name.

I loaded an older save of my world, and a chest I emptied is full again. That's on purpose: Raft's Load Game box keeps the last 8 saves of a world, and the mod's islands, chests, quests and journal go back with the save you pick, so the world fits together (the items you took went back with Raft's save too). Leaving that world saves it as it is now, so it becomes the newest save; to go back to where you were, load the **first older save** in the Load Game box - the save you came from (the mod's islands and quests come back with it too).

Raft closed while I was building an island. Open the editor again: it offers the unsaved work it kept (4.7). Open it and **Save**.

My island is far away / I can't find it. Build Raft's Receiver: custom islands are green dots with their distance.

I can't get onto a flying island (or a cliff island). Build stairs or pillars up from the raft. The generator's reach line tells a builder beforehand.

A friend can't see my island. Every player needs the mod, and the host's islands are the ones that count. Island files are sent to players who join; they appear as `<name>_<hash>.island` in their folder. If the host was busy or a message got lost, the mod keeps asking (it says "Waiting for the island..."); press F10 and type `Resync` to ask again at once.

"Some parts of Custom Islands are off". A Raft update changed something the mod relies on: the box names the parts that won't work until the mod is updated; everything else works and your islands and worlds aren't changed. Please report it ([section 15](#)).

Red boxes on my island in the editor. Objects this Raft version doesn't have (after a Raft update): they are kept as they were and saved back unchanged ([4.7](#)).

Where are my islands? In `<Raft>\Mods\DynamicIslands\` as `<name>.island`. To give one to a friend, **Export...** it ([4.7](#)): the pack has the islands it brings too.

The story stopped: the next island never came. The host is told on the screen when a plan (or an island's rule) needs an island that isn't on the host's PC - usually after someone else started hosting the world. Install the pack or library entry the message names, or ask the player who made the world to export the plan. For a world saved before worlds kept their own plan, the plan file itself must be on the host's PC (see the table in [section 8](#)).

An installed island has an odd name like "Harbor (First Voyage)". You had a different island called "Harbor", so the pack's was installed under that name instead of replacing yours.

A pack won't install. The Import window says why: it may be made for a newer version of the mod, broken, or not an island pack at all.

How do I change a world's settings after it has started? In the world: **Esc** → **Custom Islands**. The host changes them there for every player ([9.1](#)).

Test in the editor didn't get to the world. The mod says why on the screen: the island needs a name (Save as first), or Raft's Load button is off because Steam is offline. The test world **Custom Islands test** can also be loaded by hand from Load Game; if it is broken, delete it there and Test makes a new one.

"... is in use by another program". Another program has the file open (a text editor, 7-Zip, a cloud folder syncing it). Close it there and save (or delete, remove) again - nothing was changed meanwhile.

Mods\DynamicIslands is full of old files. The island library's Installed tab: **Tidy up** (see [4.7](#)).

The editor takes a moment to open. The first time after starting Raft it loads about 700 objects from Raft's islands; the loading box shows how far it is. After a Raft update it also scans Raft's other islands once, in the background (about half a minute; the object browser's status line says so).

Something went wrong. Press F10: the mod's messages start with `[CUSTOM ISLANDS]`. Raft's log is `%USERPROFILE%\AppData\LocalLow\Redbeet Interactive\Raft\Player.log`. To tell us about it, see [section 15](#).

More: the [README](#) (every feature, file and command, the known issues being fixed, the limitations and what has been tested).

15. Reporting a problem

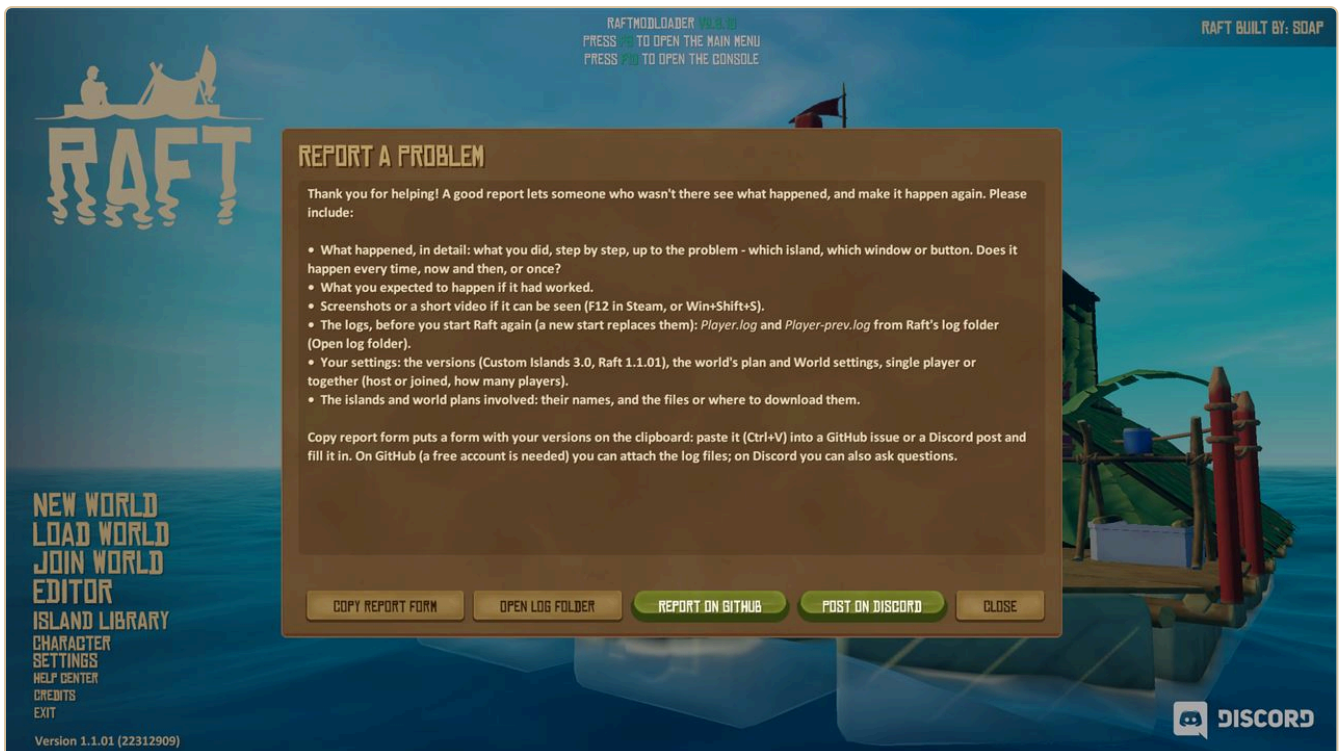
This is an alpha, and your reports are how it gets better. A good report lets someone who wasn't there see what happened, and make it happen again on their own PC. Please include:

1. **What happened, in detail.** What you did, step by step, from starting Raft or loading the world up to the problem: which island, which window or button, what you pressed or where you walked. Does it happen every time, now and then, or only once? Did it start after something (a new version of the mod, joining a friend, loading an older world)?
2. **What you expected** to happen if it had worked.
3. **Screenshots**, or a short video, if the problem can be seen: Steam's screenshot key (**F12**) or Windows' **Win+Shift+S**. If the console (**F10**) shows red messages, a screenshot of it helps too.
4. **The logs**, taken right after the problem and **before you restart Raft** (a new start replaces the log):
 - `%USERPROFILE%\AppData\LocalLow\Redbeet Interactive\Raft\Player.log`: Raft's log, with the mod's messages (`[CUSTOM ISLANDS]`). Paste the folder part of the path into the address bar of Windows Explorer to open it.
 - `Player-prev.log` in the same folder, if Raft crashed or you have started it again since: the previous start's log.
 - If Raft doesn't start with the mod at all: the mod loader's own log, `%APPDATA%\RaftModLoader\logs\hloader.log`.
 - **Playing together**: the logs of every player, the host's first, and who was the host.
 - The logs may show your Windows user name (in file paths) and your Steam name and id.
5. **The settings you used**:
 - **the versions**: Custom Islands (the box at the top right of the main menu says, for example, 3.0), Raft (bottom left of the main menu, for example 1.1.01), the mod loader (top of the main menu, for example v2.8.10), and which other mods you have;
 - **the world's settings**: Raft's game mode, the Custom Islands plan, and what you chose in World settings. In the world, press **F10** and run `WorldOptions`, `Monsters`, `BuildCost`, `Randomizer`, `WorldPlan`, `WorldIslands`, `StoryChain` and `SpawnPool`, then copy what they print (it is also in `Player.log`);
 - your settings files from `<Raft>\Mods\DynamicIslands\`: `spawnpool.txt`, and `world_rules.txt` and `randomizer.txt` if the problem is with a new world;
 - **single player or together**; if together: were you the host or did you join, and how many players were there.
6. **The islands and world plans involved**: their names, and the files or where to download them. Islands are `<Raft>\Mods\DynamicIslands\<name>.island`, world plans `<Raft>\Mods\DynamicIslands\plans\<name>.plan`. If the problem is in one world, add that world's island list, `<Raft>\Mods\DynamicIslands\worlds\<world>.txt`, and if you can, the world itself: zip its folder from `%USERPROFILE%\AppData\LocalLow\Redbeet Interactive\Raft\User\`.

The quick way: Report a problem. The alpha box on the main menu ([section 1](#)) has a **Report a problem** button. It opens a box with the list above in short, and buttons that do the work for you:

- **Copy report form** puts the form below, with your versions filled in, on the clipboard (paste it with Ctrl+V);
- **Open log folder** opens the folder with `Player.log` and `Player-prev.log`;

- **Report on GitHub** opens a new issue on the mod's GitHub page with the form already in it;
- **Post on Discord** opens the Custom Islands Discord server.



Report a problem: what to include, and the buttons for the form, the logs, GitHub and Discord.

Where to send it (either is fine):

- **GitHub:** open an issue on the mod's GitHub page, github.com/SwedenJohansson/DynamicsIslands/issues (**New issue**). Give it a short title that says what went wrong ("A chest on my island is empty again after loading"), write the report, and attach the files (zip them if there are many).
- **Discord:** post it on the mod's Discord server, discord.gg/U7DfKY9tN, with the same details and the files attached.

A template to copy into the issue or the post:

What happened:

Steps to make it happen:

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.

What I expected:

How often: every time / now and then / once

Versions: Custom Islands 3.0, Raft 1.1.01, mod loader v2.8.10, other mods:

Single player or together: (host / joined, how many players)

World settings: (what WorldOptions, Monsters, BuildCost, Randomizer, WorldPlan, WorldIslands, SpawnPool print)

Islands and world plans used: (names, files or download links)

Attached: Player.log, Player-prev.log, screenshots, ...

16. Learn from the library: example islands and plans

The **island library** (ISLAND LIBRARY in the main menu) has islands and world plans made with this mod's own editors - every hill, door, quest and rule in them was made with the buttons this guide shows. Play them, then **open them in the editor** and take them apart: they are the quickest way to learn how a quest island or a whole adventure is put together.

16.1 Opening an example in the editor

1. **ISLAND LIBRARY** → **Islands** (or **World plans**) → **Download** the one you want (a plan downloads with every island it needs).
2. **EDITOR** → Island tab → **Load...** → pick the island. Everything is there as its builder left it.
3. Click any object to see its **inspector**: a chest's loot, a note's text, a creature's toughness, a zone's message, and **Behaviour + events...** for doors, winches, valves and levers (what happens on use, the checks, the signals).
4. **Edit quest...** shows the quest's steps and reward; **Story items...** the keys and logs it uses.
5. A plan: **WORLD PLANS** → **Plan ▼** → pick it: one rule card per island, and **Check** explains the whole story.

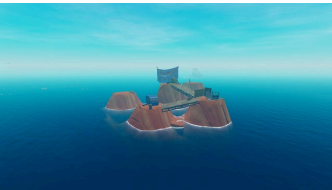
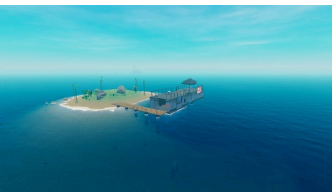
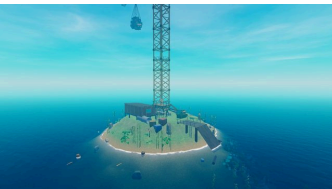
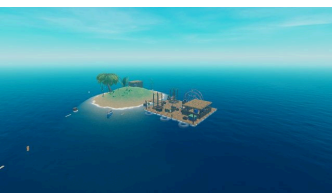
Change anything and **Save as** a new name: the original stays as downloaded.

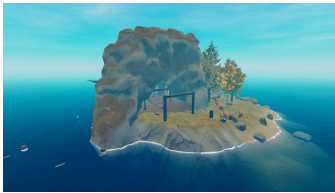
The examples were built step by step by a script that clicks the editor's own buttons (the "recipe player"), so they test the editors too. The scripts are in the mod's source (`content\recipes`), one line per editor action - readable as a building diary of each island.

As thick with things as Raft's own islands. Every example starts from the generator with its nature at **Like Raft** - trees, bushes, rocks, things to pick up and the corals as thick on the ground as on Raft's own islands of the style (see 4.5). Where an island's theme asks for more (Thornwood's jungle) or less (a sandbar, a snowfield), its script says so in a line starting `# (nature: .` To see the difference, generate an island with **Like Raft** and with **Dense**, and dive at both. The themed islands (16.6) also have Raft's finds in the **shallow sea round them** - sand, clay, stones, metal and copper ore, scrap and a giant clam to gather just off the shore, as every one of Raft's islands has.

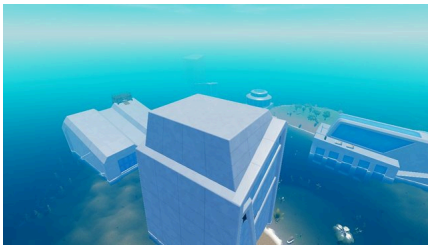
16.2 The small and medium islands

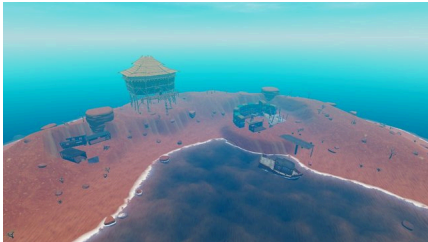
Island	What it is	What it shows you how to build
 Signal Rock	A rock with a radio relay station: climb the station, dive for the lost transmitter coil, put the radio on the air and light the beacon (Raft's Radio Tower)	A building from Raft's radio tower pieces on pillars, ladders, a story item from a sunk crate, an object that is "used" with a story item (the transmitter), things shown and hidden by a behaviour (the beacon)

Island	What it is	What it shows you how to build
 The Stranded Gull	A motor yacht aground on a sandbar, the crew's camp, the yacht's stern on the reef - with an angler fish in it (Raft's Vasagatan)	A wreck from Raft's stranded boat, a camp of Vasagatan's furniture, a creature under water guarding a safe
 Ranger's Rest	A jungle hill: a ranger's cabin, a watchtower and the den of Old Scar, the bear that stole the supplies (Raft's Balboa)	A boss (a bear made bigger and tougher, tinted), a watchtower to climb, a cave den
 Stilt Hollow	Trailers on sandstone stacks joined by scaffold walkways; follow the red pipe to the valve, start the pump (Raft's Caravan Town)	Walkways between heights (scaffolding as ramps), a pump started with a story item, a white screecher
 Mayor's Wharf	A drowned city block: City Hall's flooded floors, the mayor's office at its wharf, a cafe on a roof (Raft's Tangaroa)	Rooms under water, a keycard in a flooded locker, a vault, a pier of Raft's planks
 Crane Yard	A construction islet under a giant crane; the spotlight's parts went down with the pier's end (Raft's Varuna Point)	Three story items to collect under water, angler fish, a spotlight that is fixed and points to the reward
 Frost Hollow	A snowy islet with igloos, a telescope and a dark lab; three cables, a power box, a polar bear (Raft's Temperance)	A power box that takes three story items, a sliding lab door that opens on a signal
 Tide Farm	A floating farm of Raft's foundations: crop beds, a glasshouse, a water wheel jammed by a crate (Raft's Utopia)	An island of only building blocks over water, a turning wheel, animals to catch as a quest step

Island	What it is	What it shows you how to build
 Old Mine Islet	An old mine in a rock mound: timbered tunnels, rails, ore carts - dark further in, where something has dug in	A cave from Balboa's cave pieces set into the land, darkness (an atmosphere zone) and lanterns, a head lamp in a locker
 Shelter Atoll	A bomb shelter under an atoll's islet: seven dark rooms, rats, a dry generator, a blast gate	Rooms under the ground (a pit under a concrete roof), a hatch and a ladder down, a generator that lights the rooms and opens doors

16.3 The very large islands

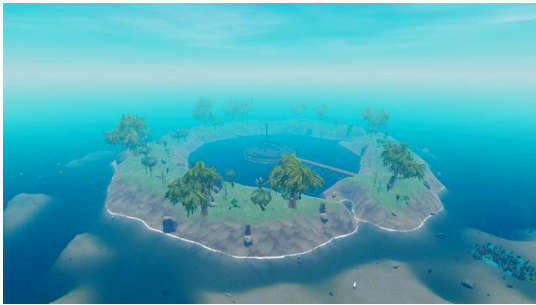
Island	What it is	What it shows you how to build
 Ironreef Caverns	A jungle mountain over four caves: a mine, a vine crawl, a flooded shaft and the Bear Hall behind a rockfall	Several caves in one mountain, a plank road up a flank, a rockfall blown with charges (an object hidden by a behaviour), a boss in its hall
 The Drowned Metropolis	Meridian, a city the sea took: tower crowns over the water, a ferry, a penthouse, offices on the sea floor, the Lantern Lord	Buildings standing in the sea, a penthouse on legs, three keycards, an angler fish boss in deep water
 Thornwood	A jungle split by a river gorge: a rope bridge, three shrines, a stone circle where the Warthog King guards the idol	A gorge cut with the terrain brushes, a rope bridge, trails through dense jungle, a boss and its guards

Island	What it is	What it shows you how to build
 Glacier Station	A station on a glacier: glowing domes, an observatory on the peak, a crevasse with the Polar Bear Queen, a reactor	A reactor that, once running, sends a signal that opens its vault; a crevasse cut into the ice
 Scrapyard Haven	A junk town in a ring of stacked caravans: a gate trailer on a winch, a hyena pit, the scrap king's fortress on stilts	A gate that a winch lifts (moving objects), a stilt house set level on a ridge, a pack with an alpha

16.4 The world plans

The Long Voyage - Raft's whole story, twice as long. After every story island but Utopia, a big quest island of the library comes on its own Receiver frequency (the story island's radio picks it up); its quest done, the story goes on as Raft's. The smaller library islands turn up as side trips while you sail (one every few km).

After	The plan's island	What it is
Radio Tower	 Wreckers' Cove	A cove with a wreckers' hamlet, the schooner Marigold on the reef, a smugglers' den in a sea cave and the false lantern that lured her there
Vasagatan	Thornwood	(16.3)
Balboa	Scrapyard Haven	(16.3)
Caravan Town	Ironreef Caverns	(16.3)
Tangaroa	The Drowned Metropolis	(16.3)

After	The plan's island	What it is
Varuna Point	 Coral Observatory	A research platform moored in an atoll's lagoon, coral samples in cases on the lagoon floor and a giant angler fish at the reef's edge
Temperance	Glacier Station	(16.3)

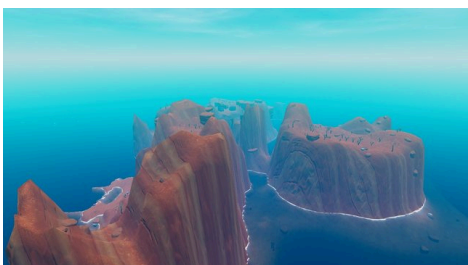
The **side trips** - every one 450 m ahead of the raft, with its message on screen and its name on the Receiver:

Sailed	Island	The message
2 km	The Stranded Gull	A white hull glints on a sandbar ahead.
4 km	Signal Rock (quest "Dead Air")	A mast on a rock ahead - its light is dead.
7 km	Ranger's Rest	A jungle hill with a watch tower comes up ahead.
10 km	Stilt Hollow	Trailers on stilts over a reef - someone lived out here.
13 km	Mayor's Wharf	Rooftops stick out of the sea ahead: a sunken city block.
16 km	Crane Yard	A crane rises from the sea ahead.
20 km	Frost Hollow	A snowy islet with a hut - it's getting colder.
24 km	Tide Farm	Water wheels turn on a floating farm ahead.
28 km	Old Mine Islet	A headframe stands over an old shaft on the islet ahead.
32 km	Shelter Atoll	A quiet atoll ahead - and a hatch in the middle of it.

The **main quest islands** are each on the Receiver, 700 m (Wreckers' Cove), 900 m (Thornwood, Scrapyard Haven, Ironreef Caverns) or 1000 m (the rest) ahead when tuned, and each is done when its quest is done. The plan also has **Random islands while sailing: on** and **Raft's story islands: on** (all eight).

What it shows: all **three kinds of islands** in one plan - rules with a **story place** ("after" a story island) and a **Receiver** frequency, "done when its quest is done", and side trips brought **after a distance sailed**, ahead of the raft.

Raft Remade - Raft's story as you know it, but every story island is made anew. Each of Raft's eight story islands is replaced on the Receiver by a remade version of itself: its land made by the generator **like** Raft's own island (4.5 - its shape and style, something new each time it is built), then rebuilt with new set pieces, new missions, other monsters and a boss. Each hands out the blueprints the original island has, so the raft still gets its steering wheel, engine, fuel, machete and everything the story needs; the last island's quest is the ending.

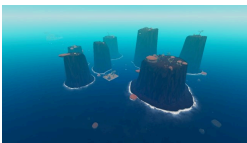
Instead of	The plan's island	What it is
Radio Tower	 Radio Tower Remade	A three-deck tower on a steep rock, a battery bank in the old shark cage, Old Beak on the roof
Vasagatan	 Vasagatan Remade	A ship broken in two on the reef - her bow on a sandbar full of rats, her stern sunk in the bay, her crew's camp in the dunes
Balboa	 Balboa Remade	A forest of pine and maple round a mountain: the rangers' station, the Mama bear's den behind a vine-grown barricade (cut with the machete), a radio mast on the summit
Caravan Town	 Caravan Town Remade	Red sandstone stacks: a market in the inlet, a lift of ladders, a bridge slid across by a winch to the mayor's pillar - and a white screecher on his roof
Tangaroa	 Tangaroa Remade	The floating city on a hill of its own: a harbour deck on one of the old ring pontoons, the pump house, the square with the founder's statue, the generator and the council's vault (three key cards)

Instead of	The plan's island	What it is
Varuna Point	 Varuna Point Remade	A construction site on a long rocky point: the half-built tower in its scaffolding, the floodlight's four parts on the sea floor, the floodlight tower, a giant angler in the deep
Temperance	 Temperance Remade	An igloo village, Selene's station whose reactor opens its inner doors (three cable drums - one under the ice), the telescope on the peak, the polar bear mother
Utopia	 Utopia Remade	The end of the voyage: docks with Utopia's market, the warden's prison house on its stilts, and his yard on the summit behind a palisade - a gate with two keys, his hyena pack and their alpha

Each island is on the Receiver at its story island's place (600 to 1200 m ahead when tuned), and each is done when its quest is done; the plan also has **Random islands while sailing: on** and **Raft's story islands: on**.

What it shows: rules that take a story island's place (**instead of, 7.4**), islands made from Raft's own islands with the generator's **like**, and on each island a different way to lock the reward: a story item used on an object (a battery, a crank, cables, floodlight parts), a key card count (Tangaroa's vault takes three), a signal (Varuna's strongbox opens only once the floodlight burns), two keys at once (Utopia's gate).

The Abyss Expedition - an expedition downwards beside Raft's story: each island comes **near the one before** when its quest is done or players reach it - an old mine, a buried shelter, a **sunken island** and a **wreck** made new for every world (map types), caverns, a drowned city - and at the end **The Abyss**.

The plan's last island	What it is	What it shows you how to build
 The Abyss	A ring of black sea stacks around a trench 42 m deep: the expedition's raft moored over its edge, its air line running down to three air pockets (a container on a shelf, a gas tank on a ledge, a shack on the floor) and, on the floor, the lair of the Abyssal Angler and its brood	A raft of Raft's foundations, a trench cut with the brushes (a bowl, a shaft, a shelf and a ledge flattened into its walls), air pockets - trigger zones with Air, hidden until the valve shows them, with rising bubbles (5.4)

What it shows: rules brought by **quests and visits, near** another island in a direction, and map types mixed with your own islands.

Raft 2: The Drowned Frontier - a sequel with a story of its own: years after Utopia the sea is rising again, and a trail of the old Frontier Corps' stations leads across the storm belt to the last high ground. Raft's story islands are off; the plan's ten quest islands come one after the other - the first comes into sight by itself, and each quest done gives the next station's frequency on the Receiver. Raft's key blueprints are found along the way in Raft's order, so the raft can still be steered, driven and fuelled; the tenth island's quest is the ending.

Station	The plan's island	What it is
1	 Frontier Beacon	A black volcanic spike: the keeper's hut on the ash flats, a ramp of fill up to the beacon's terrace, a spare cell in a sunk supply boat, stone birds and their sentinel (the Receiver's and the antenna's blueprints)
2	 Saltmarsh Ferry	A salt marsh cut by a tidal channel, the Corps' ferry beached at its end - pump her dry, clear the rats out of her hold (the motor wheel's and the steering wheel's)
3	 Cinderfall	A volcano with a geothermal plant at its foot - three relief valves on its flanks, the stone birds' matriarch, roaches in the turbine hall (the machete and the fuel blueprints)
4	 The Sunken Archive	An archive standing in the sea between five palm islets, its stacks flooded - catalogue cards, an air pocket, an angler at the vault (the engine controls', the metal detector's, the firework's and the zipline's)

Station	The plan's island	What it is
5	 Hightide Harbor	A fishing town on stilts round a bay - bears in the fish hall, the water works on the hill, a lamp tower of Raft's blocks to light (the water blueprints)
6	 The Iron Graveyard	A ship breakers' yard on a red mesa's beach - beached hulls to climb, a barge sunk off the beach, a crawler crane, the turbine on the mesa (the power blueprints)
7	 Storm Spire	A weather station on a needle of rock in the storm belt - a short climb, three conductor rods, the storm bird; six steps, short on purpose (the electric smelter's, the advanced biofuel extractor's and anchor's)
8	 Whiteout Reach	The Corps' winter camp on a snowy hill - a supply ship frozen into the shore ice, the polar bear matriarch in a crevasse, the radio hut on the summit
9	 The Drowned Gate	A sea wall across a strait between two hills - its lock of two steel gates that sink to open, the pump house's flooded hall with an angler in it, the gate office's vault (the titanium tools', the big backpack's and the electric zipline's)
10	 The Frontier	The last high ground: a harbour town under a great mesa, farm terraces climbing its face, the upper town and the Corps' hall on the rim, the Corps' lift down the cliff to a vault sunk in a cove - thirty-two steps in six chapters

The first island comes into sight 450 m ahead by itself; each one after it is on the Receiver (800 to 1300 m ahead when tuned) once the one before is done, and each is done when its quest is done. The plan has **Random islands while sailing: on** and **Raft's story islands: off**.

What it shows: a plan with a story chain of its own (**first** and **after**, 7.4) and no island of Raft's; quests of every length - six steps on Storm Spire, thirty-two in six chapters on The Frontier; story items an object only uses up once the quest has counted them (an **Only if** the quest reached that step before the check that **uses them up**, so a player who finds things early can't lock the quest); a lift that moves the player (**teleport the player**); doors that slide aside when three seals are set.

16.5 Where to look for...

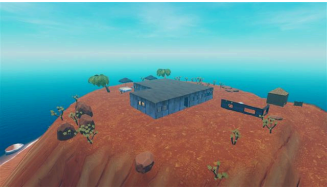
To learn how to make...	Open
Ladders up a building or a rock	Signal Rock, Scrapyard Haven (its fortress), Wreckers' Cove (the lantern)
A door, gate or bridge that opens (moves)	Shelter Atoll (the commander's door), Scrapyard Haven (the gate on a winch), Frost Hollow (the lab door), Caravan Town Remade (a bridge slid across by a winch), Tangaroa Remade (a shutter the generator slides aside), Temperance Remade (the reactor's inner doors), Utopia Remade (a gate with two locks), The Frontier (the hall's sliding doors)
Something that opens only after something else (a signal)	Glacier Station (the reactor and its vault), Wreckers' Cove (the doused lantern and the hoard), Coral Observatory (the analyzer and the safe)
An object used with a story item (a key, a fuse, samples, a wrench)	Signal Rock (the coil), Stilt Hollow (the valve), Coral Observatory (three samples at once), The Abyss (the air valve), The Frontier (three valve wheels, the horn's reed, the seal press - each used up only once the quest has counted it)
A lift or anything that moves the player	The Frontier (the Corps' lift: teleport the player to its other end), The Safe Room (a hatch down an escape shaft and back)
Roads and terraces up a steep slope (the terrain brushes)	The Frontier (two farm terraces and three wide ramps up a 35 m mesa), The Iron Graveyard (a ramp cut up the mesa's cliff), The Safe Room (a driveway cut along a cliff face)
A town	Hightide Harbor (a fishing town on stilts), The Frontier (a harbour town and an upper town of four quarters)
Caves	Old Mine Islet, Ironreef Caverns (four), Wreckers' Cove (a sea cave)
Rooms under the ground	Shelter Atoll
Darkness and light (atmosphere zones, lamps that come on)	Shelter Atoll, Old Mine Islet, Ironreef Caverns, The Abyss (its lair)
Things under water to dive for	The Stranded Gull, Mayor's Wharf, Crane Yard, The Drowned Metropolis, Coral Observatory, The Abyss

To learn how to make...	Open
Air pockets for a long dive	The Abyss
A boss (bigger, tougher, tinted)	Ranger's Rest (Old Scar), Thornwood (the Warthog King), Glacier Station (the Polar Bear Queen), The Drowned Metropolis (the Lantern Lord), Scrapyard Haven (the alpha), Coral Observatory (the giant angler), The Abyss (the Abyssal Angler), and one on each of Raft Remade's islands (the Mama bear, the white screecher, the giant angler, the polar bear mother, the hyena alpha...)
Animals to catch	Tide Farm, The Frontier (the grower's goats), Tiki Lagoon (the petting zoo's runaway goats)
Buildings from Raft's pieces	Signal Rock and Wreckers' Cove (radio tower pieces), Shelter Atoll and Coral Observatory (Selene rooms), Mayor's Wharf (City Hall), Hightide Harbor and The Frontier (Raft's own wooden walls with hip roofs on their pillars)
A raft or a deck of Raft's foundations	Tide Farm, The Abyss
Land shaped with the brushes	Thornwood (a gorge), Glacier Station (a crevasse), Coral Observatory (a blue hole), Scrapyard Haven (a pit and a terrace), The Abyss (a trench with a shelf and a ledge)
An island in Raft's story	The Long Voyage (after each story island), Raft Remade (instead of each story island)
An island made from one of Raft's own (the generator's like)	Raft Remade's eight islands
A chain of islands that bring each other	The Abyss Expedition

16.6 The themed islands

Islands built round a theme the movies love - a pirate cove, a beach club, a desert villa with a safe room and more - each with its own island type and its own quest. Most are the normal size; some are two, three, five or even ten times as big (the island's **Radius** in the generator, [4.5](#)). Like the other examples, each one's script is in `content\recipes` and the island opens in the editor.

Island	What it is	What it shows you how to build
 Gilded Skull Cove	Two jungle peaks over a cove like the brows of a skull: a pirate captain's camp, her ship sunk in the cove's mouth, her map torn in three and her hoard under three standing stones	A map of three story items laid together on a table, a stilt lookout to climb, stones to push in a verse's order (each one moves only after the one before it: a chain of signals), feral hogs

Island	What it is	What it shows you how to build
 Tiki Lagoon	A beach club on sandy keys, left in a hurry before a storm: a tiki bar, bungalows on stilts over the lagoon, a deep pool with a sunken pedal boat, two runaway goats	A bar of Raft's floor blocks under a thatch hip roof (roof), huts on stilts and walkways over water (stilt_hut , boardwalk), a generator that switches lights and music on (things shown by a behaviour) and opens a safe (a signal), animals to catch
 Sun Atoll	A ring of sun-baked islets round a lagoon after a weapons test: an observation blockhouse buried in a dune, the tower's stumps round a crater at ground zero, measuring posts behind wire	Rooms in pits under concrete slabs (on the terrain's 1.95 m grid), a trench, a crater dive, a story item that turns a zone on (the dosimeter), three films for a projector that opens a safe
 The Safe Room	A concrete villa on a red desert bluff, broken into one night: the owner and her daughter hid in the steel room behind the study's bookshelf, and the men's dogs still guard the garden	A driveway cut up a cliff face, rooms of the radio tower's pieces, a keypad that wants three story items, a bookshelf that slides aside (a mover) and shows hidden dogs, a hatch that teleports down an escape shaft
 Keeper's Light	Sea stacks in a grey sea joined by rope bridges: a lighthouse dark for three nights, the keepers' cottage, and a flooded cistern under a concrete slab where something with a lamp on its head waits	Buildings on three sea stacks joined by rope bridges (lanes of floor blocks with rope rails), a lighthouse of concrete pipes with ladders up its outside, a cistern dug into the rock and a hatch down into it, a lamp lit with a story item
 Highmoor Lodge	A mountain lodge on a snowy hill, closed for the winter: the caretaker's typed pages all over the house, music in the empty ballroom, a maze of young firs with a white bear at its heart, a boiler to vent	A two-storey house of Raft's solid wooden walls with a stair and a hip roof, wings with their own roofs, a maze (evergreen runs with invisible walls, Helper_Wall), a Find pages step, three valves in order (signals), a door that slides aside on a key
 Crater Lair	A black volcanic cone with a great dish humming in its crater and a hangar hidden in its west bluff: a seaplane, a control room, a pet's pool behind bars and a getaway jetty	A slab of the mountain that a hidden panel lifts (a door that moves), rooms dug into a bluff, a keycard dived for in a pool behind bars, a timed escape - a blast door that shuts 45 seconds after the codes burn

Island	What it is	What it shows you how to build
 The Rock Pen	A prison on a flat granite rock in the fog: the yard, a guard tower, cell block B, the mess hall - and the drain inmate 1147 dug from his cell's vent down to the sea	Cells with fronts of bars that slide open on a key, a tower of thick legs with a ladder, a vent that teleports you into a tunnel at the cliff's foot, a kit shown only once you are in the tunnel, an outer rock raised from the sea floor
 Embers Isle	A black volcanic crescent round a bay: a whalers' village of stilt huts round a fire that never goes out, a captured botanist's journal - and her boat hidden in a vine-hung sea cave under the headland	A village of stilt huts round a fire, a chest that blows a horn and shows hunters with trained boars (a chase, with music), Balboa's vine cave set into a cliff at the waterline
 Camp Blackwater (twice the size)	A summer camp on a forest lake, empty since the season ended early: cabins, canoes, an archery range, a radio still playing - and the Ridge Bear the head counselor stayed behind to lure away	A lake dug down to the sea's level inland, a camp of Balboa's log house and relay-station cabins, a bait pile that shows the bear, a fire lookout with a ladder, a flare that gives a key
 The Step Pyramid (twice the size)	A jungle plateau with sheer cliffs and the Rain Kings' stepped pyramid on top: a staked shrine, a sacred well straight down to the sea, a moat of stakes and three jade tablets for the summit altar	A pyramid raised from the ground in square tiers with walls of stone blocks and Raft's stairs, a well dug past the sea's level with a gorge out to sea, stepping stones shown when a tablet is taken, stakes that sink on a hidden lever

This guide describes Custom Islands 3.0, the Experimental Alpha Release. It is kept up to date with the mod: every change to a feature updates this guide, the README and the PDF copy of this guide ([docs/Custom-Islands-Guide.pdf](#)) together.